

The Architecture of *Grace*

Book 2 · The Framework

*A Complete Year-Long SEL Curriculum in Forgiveness, Grace, and
Self-Compassion*

GRADES 3 · 4 · 5 · TEACHER MASTER EDITION

SECULAR · RESEARCH-GROUNDED · TRAUMA-INFORMED · CASEL-ALIGNED

James Anthony Ramsden, FOUNDER

BOOK TWO

The Framework

Teacher Master Edition

Secular · Research-Grounded · Trauma-Informed · CASEL-Aligned
Tier 1 Universal SEL · 28 Lessons across 4 Units · Plus 4 Regulation & Repair Strand Lessons

CONFIDENTIAL · FOR DISTRICT REVIEW AND EDUCATOR USE ONLY

INSIDE THIS BOOK

Four Sections

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USE · COLOR & ICON KEY · SAFETY PROTOCOLS · PACING CALENDAR · COUNSELOR SCHEDULE · YEAR-START SCRIPT · CLASSROOM COMPACT		UNITS · 4 REGULATION & REPAIR STRAND LESSONS · IN-LESSON SCANS · ANCHOR CHARTS · SCENARIO CARDS · WORKSHEETS
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Daily-use materials at the front · occasional reference at the back

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SECTION ONE

Teacher Launch Pack

Daily-Use Materials · Read Before Lesson 1

1.1 How to Use This Master Document

This document is your single source of truth for delivering Architecture of Grace, Book 2: The Framework to Grades 3–5. Everything you need — lesson scripts, worksheets, safety protocols, assessment tools, reference materials, and printable visual anchor charts — is in one place, organized so that the materials you use daily are at the front, and the materials you reference occasionally are at the back.

WHAT IS IN EVERY LESSON

Opening Review — a 2-minute structured bridge from the previous lesson activating prior knowledge.

Direct Instruction — scripted instructional sequence with timed steps.

Anchor Charts — described at each lesson. Print and post on the day indicated. Keep posted all year.

Scenario Cards — two per lesson, embedded directly where they are used.

Worksheets — embedded at the end of the lesson where distributed. Reproducible for students. Never collected unless student chooses.

Exit Ticket & Teacher Reflection — closing formative check and private teacher prompt at every lesson.

In-Lesson Scan — embedded inline at the precise activity where observation matters. Watch for specific student behaviors. Note privately.

Safety Check — appears at every elevated and highest-risk lesson. Complete BEFORE delivering.

Regulation & Repair Strand — four full-length strand lessons (one per unit) provide explicit instruction in self-regulation and relationship repair — the practical infrastructure that supports the unit content.

GRADE-BAND NOTE · GRADES 3–5

The Framework grade band introduces the Heavy Backpack metaphor. This physical prop appears in Unit 2 and remains the central visual anchor for the unit. The other metaphors that organize this curriculum — the Identity Web (U1), the Inner Critic vs. Inner Coach (U1), the Window of Tolerance (Strand), the Three-Part Accountability Map (U2), the Recovery Arc (Strand), and the Repair Protocol (Strand) — live on anchor charts and in student journals. Every lesson begins with a brief, predictable opening — 2 minutes of grounding before any new content. **This ritual is not optional.** It is the threshold between the social world of school and the interior work of this class.

1.2 Color & Icon Key

Each visual cue in this curriculum has a consistent meaning. Read this key once and return to it as needed.

Opening Review	TEAL	2-minute structured bridge activating prior knowledge from the last lesson.
Direct Instruction	TEAL	Scripted step-by-step instructional sequence with timed steps. Placed after Opening Review.
Anchor Chart	TEAL	Described at each lesson. Print and post on the day indicated. Keep posted all year.
Scenario Cards	PURPLE	Embedded at point of use. Two per lesson. Print and laminate before Unit 1.
Worksheet	GOLD	Reproducible student worksheet, embedded at end of distributing lesson. Never collected unless student chooses.
Exit Ticket & Teacher Reflection	GREEN	Closing formative check and private teacher prompt. Every lesson.
In-Lesson Scan	AMBER	Placed inline at the specific activity it monitors. Watch for named behaviors. Note privately. Do not intervene publicly.
Safety Check	RED	Pre-lesson checklist. Complete before delivering any risk-flagged lesson. Non-negotiable.
★★ HIGHEST RISK	RED BANNER	Counselor must be on-site or immediately available, full lesson. No exceptions.
★ ELEVATED RISK	AMBER BANNER	Counselor on-site or co-facilitating. Minimum one week advance notice. No pre-break scheduling.
Regulation & Repair Strand	GOLD	Full-length strand lessons placed within each unit. Build practical regulation and repair skills.

1.3 Safety Protocols — Quick Reference

Read before Lesson 1. Return before every risk-flagged lesson.

★★ **HIGHEST RISK · COUNSELOR PHYSICALLY ON-SITE, FULL LESSON · NO EXCEPTIONS**

U2 L6 · When Self-Forgiveness Feels Impossible **U3 L3** · Forgiveness Is Not the Same as Trust

★ **ELEVATED RISK · COUNSELOR ON-SITE OR CO-FACILITATING**

U2 L4 · Talking to Yourself Kindly — Counselor available **U2 L5** · Letting Go — A Practice — Counselor available **U3 L5** · Holding Your Story Without Being Held by It — Counselor available **U4 L7** · Community Charter & Year-End Celebration — Counselor on standby

DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL · APPLIES TO ALL LESSONS

1. Stop the lesson immediately. 2. Activate your school's mandatory disclosure protocol. 3. Contact the counselor now — not after class. Not after the lesson. Now. **4. Do not leave the student alone.** 5. Do not attempt to assess risk yourself. 6. Document in writing the same day. See Section 4 — Legal & Clinical Compliance · Student Disclosure Protocol for the complete protocol.

CRISIS RESOURCES · POST BEFORE U2 L6 · KEEP POSTED THROUGH YEAR-END

988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline · Call or text **988 Crisis Text Line** · Text **HOME** to **741741**

1.4 Year-at-a-Glance Pacing Calendar

KNOWING
ACCEPTING YOURSELF
AUGUST — OCTOBER

SELF-COMPASSION
SELF-FORGIVENESS
OCTOBER — DECEMBER

EMPATHY
FORGIVING OTHERS
JANUARY — MARCH

GRACE
GENEROSITY MARCH
— MAY

ASSESSMENT TIMING

Pre-Assessment · Administer Instrument B in the first week of the year — before Unit 1 Lesson 1. **Post-Assessment** · Administer after Unit 4 Lesson 7. **Family Surveys** · Distribute Instrument G at the end of Unit 2 (mid-year) and end of Unit 4 (year-end).

1.5 Counselor Coordination — Scheduling Summary

BLOCK THESE DATES ON THE COUNSELOR'S CALENDAR BEFORE UNIT 1 LESSON 1 IS DELIVERED. NO EXCEPTIONS.

U2 L4 — Talking to Yourself Kindly	★ Elevated	Advance notice 1 week; reachable on day	No pre-break scheduling
U2 L5 — Letting Go: A Practice	★ Elevated	Advance notice 1 week; reachable on day	No pre-break scheduling
U2 L6 — When Self-Forgiveness Feels Impossible	★★ Highest	ON-SITE or immediately available, full lesson	No pre-break · No sub · AFSP-aligned
U3 L3 — Forgiveness Is Not the Same as Trust	★★ Highest	ON-SITE or immediately available, full lesson	No pre-break · No sub · No exception
U3 L5 — Holding Your Story	★ Elevated	Advance notice 1 week; reachable on day	No pre-break scheduling
U4 L7 — Community Charter & Year-End	★ Elevated	Counselor on standby recommended	Mon–Wed of final week only

STANDING COORDINATION REQUIREMENTS

Before Unit 1 Lesson 1 • Counselor attends PD day. Disclosure protocol reviewed. Communication channel established. Calendar blocked. **Before Unit 3 Lesson 1** • Counselor and teacher review Unit 2 bridge exit tickets. Identify students entering Unit 3 with the highest emotional load. **January mid-year** • Virtual coaching session — counselor attends. Delivers debrief on student wellbeing patterns across Semester 1. **After Unit 4 Lesson 7** • Counselor and teacher year-end debrief. Review post-assessment data. Identify students who may benefit from continued counselor contact.

1.6 Year-Start Student Introduction Script

Use on the first day of **Unit 1 Lesson 1** — before distributing any materials. Read it aloud or say it in your own voice. Do not skip it.

"Once a week, for about 40 minutes, we are going to work on the inside of your life — not your grades, but the part of you that decides how you treat yourself when things go wrong, and how you treat other people when they hurt you." "This is not a class where you will be graded on your feelings. Your journal is private — I will never read it without your permission. You will never be forced to share more than you choose. And nothing you say in this room gets repeated outside of it." "There are three things I want you to know before we begin: Feelings are information, not weaknesses. Every person in this room is more than their worst moment. And this is a space where that is true."

After this opening — proceed directly into **Unit 1 Lesson 1**. Students will understand what this is by experiencing it.

1.7 Classroom Compact Guide

Co-create with students at the end of Lesson 1. Ensure these four agreements are always included. Post permanently — this is the behavioral contract for the full year.

THE FOUR NON-NEGOTIABLE AGREEMENTS

1. What is shared here stays here. 2. You never have to share more than you choose. 3. Feelings are information — not weaknesses. 4. The Inner Coach standard applies to how we speak to each other.

Ask students: "What do you need this space to feel like to be honest here?" Write responses on chart paper. Add any missing agreements. Post the final compact where every student can see it.



SECTION TWO

The Lessons

28 Lessons across 4 Units · 4 Regulation & Repair Strand Lessons

UNIT 1

Knowing & Accepting Yourself

“Who am I — and can I hold that honestly, without shame and without pretending?”

DURATION	August – October · 7 Lessons + 1 Strand · 35–40 min each
CASEL PRIMARY	Self-Awareness: personal strengths, emotional vocabulary, growth mindset
CASEL SECONDARY	Self-Management: self-talk and reframing
MENTOR TEXTS	Mistakes That Worked (Jones) · Beautiful Oops! (Saltzberg) · The Dot (Reynolds) · Each Kindness (Woodson)

Unit 1 lays the interior foundation. Students cannot extend compassion outward until they have an honest, stable sense of who they are. The sequence matters — do not reorder.

Who Am I?

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 1
OBJECTIVE	Students identify at least three personal strengths or values and articulate why each student is uniquely worthwhile.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness: identifying personal strengths and self-perception
VOCABULARY	identity, strength, value, character
MATERIALS	Journals · Drawing supplies · WS1 Identity Web · Character strengths list · Index cards

LESSON AT A GLANCE: The goal is not content coverage — it is trust and safety. Go slowly. Prioritize the opening story. Every student must leave with their name on the class display.

1 Opening Story 0–3 MIN

Before you hand students anything, tell them what you are building: “Once a week, for about 40 minutes, we are going to work on the inside of your life — not your grades, but the part of you that decides how you treat yourself when things go wrong.” Promise the journal privacy contract. Establish: feelings are information, not weaknesses. Every person is more than their worst moment.

2 Classroom Compact 3–8 MIN

Ask: What do you need this space to feel like to be honest here? Write student responses on chart paper. Ensure these four are included: (1) What is shared here stays here. (2) You never have to share more than you choose. (3) Feelings are information. (4) The Inner Coach standard applies to how we speak to each other. Post permanently.

ANCHOR CHART · IDENTITY WEB — TEACHER DISPLAY MODEL

Post your completed example BEFORE distributing WS1. Five branches: Things I Love · Good At · Matter to Me · People Don't Know · Still Figuring Out.

3 Identity Web (WS1) 8–18 MIN

Distribute WS1. Students write name in center and branch out. Grade 3: Drawing is a full response. Grades 4–5: Push toward values, not just interests.

4 Strengths Inventory 18–26 MIN

Display the character strengths list. Students circle three that feel most true and write one sentence for each. Grade 3: Circle only. Grades 4–5: Which strength required the most work to build?

5

Partner Share

26-32 MIN

Students tell one partner one thing from their identity web. Listen without commenting. Switch. "What did it feel like to just be heard?"

6

Index Card + Class Display

32-36 MIN

Students write one true thing about themselves that often goes unseen. Post voluntarily. "Look at this wall. This is who we are." No student leaves without a card on the wall.

IN-LESSON SCAN

As students write their index cards: watch for prolonged blank staring, erasing repeatedly, or a student who writes and immediately crumples the card. These students may be carrying a strong internal voice that says nothing about them is worth posting.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During partner share: scan for any student who sits silently while their partner speaks, or who says "I don't know" to every prompt. A student unable to name a single thing about themselves is giving you early, significant data about self-perception.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 1-A · WHO AM I?

THE SITUATION Marcus shared on his identity web that he loves drawing comics. A classmate said, "That's babyish." Marcus feels embarrassed and wishes he had said something else. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is Marcus's love of comics part of who he truly is? Why does a classmate's comment make him want to hide it? What would you say to help Marcus hold his identity with confidence?

SCENARIO CARD 1-B · WHO AM I?

THE SITUATION Amara is filling out her strengths inventory and cannot think of a single thing to write. She keeps crossing things out. "I'm not really good at anything," she tells her partner. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Why might Amara struggle to name her own strengths? What is the difference between a born strength and one developed through effort?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: "One true thing about me that I want to carry into this school year is ____." **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students struggled to identify strengths — defaulting to "I don't know" or minimizing? This is early data about self-perception that will matter all year.

ANCHOR CHART · IDENTITY WEB — DISPLAY MODEL

Print this page · Post in classroom at the moment indicated · Keep posted for the remainder of the year

Post this completed teacher model BEFORE distributing WS1. Build one branch at a time. Students fill in their own web while yours is displayed.

WORKSHEET · WS1

My Identity Web

Unit 1, Lesson 1

Architecture of Grace · Grades 3–5 · Reproducible for classroom use · School of Life Foundation

In the center circle, write your name. Fill in each branch with your own words or drawings.

BRANCH 1 · THINGS I LOVE	BRANCH 2 · THINGS I'M GOOD AT
BRANCH 3 · THINGS THAT MATTER TO ME	BRANCH 4 · PEOPLE DON'T KNOW THIS ABOUT ME
BRANCH 5 · THINGS I'M STILL FIGURING OUT	

STEP 3 — STRENGTHS INVENTORY

Circle THREE that feel most true:

STRENGTH 1:

STRENGTH 2:

STRENGTH 3:

EXIT TICKET

One true thing I want to carry into this year:

Emotions Are Information

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 2
OBJECTIVE	Students name at least five emotions and describe feelings as useful messengers rather than problems to avoid or hide.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness: identifying and labeling emotions; emotional expression
VOCABULARY	emotion, feeling, messenger, regulate, identify
MATERIALS	Journals · Emotions anchor chart · Emotion thermometer worksheet · Drawn face images

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Show the identity web from L1. "Last week we mapped who we are. Today we add something — our emotions. What is one emotion you felt since last week?" Take 4–5 responses. "Every one of those feelings — we're going to learn what it's trying to tell you."

1

Hook — Faces Activity

2–7 MIN

Show 4–5 drawn faces. "What might this person be feeling? What might have happened right before?" "Emotions don't appear randomly. They are always a response to something."

ANCHOR CHART · EMOTIONS ARE MESSENGERS

Build WITH students — co-construction increases ownership. Add each emotion as students name it. For each: what message does it carry? This chart stays posted all year.

2

Direct Instruction

7–16 MIN

Every emotion exists for a reason: FEAR = something feels dangerous. SADNESS = something I care about was lost. ANGER = a boundary was crossed. JOY = I am in alignment with what matters. EMBARRASSMENT = I care about belonging. LONELINESS = I need connection. "Emotions are not problems. They are data."

3

Co-build Anchor Chart

16–25 MIN

Push beyond happy/sad/mad: frustrated, proud, embarrassed, relieved, confused, hopeful, lonely, overwhelmed, curious. For each: What might this emotion be trying to tell us?

4

Emotion Thermometer

25–32 MIN

Students fill in their thermometer — from lowest intensity to highest. Name what each level feels like in the body AND what it tells them. Personal — not collected.

5

Journal

32-38 MIN

Write about a time this week when you felt a strong emotion. What was it? What was it telling you? Drawing accepted. Private.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the faces activity: any student who consistently assigns negative emotions to every face, or who goes very still at a specific face, may be projecting something real. Note which emotion triggers the strongest reaction in the room.

IN-LESSON SCAN

While students complete the emotion thermometer: watch for a student who fills in only the very top or very bottom — indicating they may be experiencing emotional flooding or emotional numbness. Neither extreme is neutral. Note for reflection.

GRADE 3**GRADES 4 — 5****SCENARIO CARD 1-C · EMOTIONS ARE INFORMATION**

THE SITUATION During a math test, Jayla's mind goes blank. She panics. After the test: "I hate when that happens — my feelings always ruin everything." **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What message was Jayla's panic actually trying to send? Is the emotion the problem — or is it a messenger pointing at a different problem?

SCENARIO CARD 1-D · EMOTIONS ARE INFORMATION

THE SITUATION Deon says "Fine" when asked about his day — but he actually felt lonely, left out, and invisible. He didn't have words for it. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What emotions was Deon actually feeling? Can you name them more precisely than "fine"? Why might it be hard to share emotions, even when we do have words?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: Name one emotion you felt today and what it was trying to tell you. **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students showed the broadest emotional vocabulary? Which defaulted to "fine" or "mad"? Emotional vocabulary is strongly correlated with emotional regulation.

ANCHOR CHART · EMOTIONS ARE MESSENGERS

Print this page · Post in classroom at the moment indicated · Keep posted for the remainder of the year

FEAR

Something feels dangerous or unsafe.

SADNESS

Something I care about was lost or hurt.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 2 · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

ANGER

A boundary was crossed.

JOY

I am in alignment with what matters to me.

EMBARRASSMENT

I care about belonging.

LONELINESS

I need connection.

OVERWHELM

Too much is happening at once.

ANXIETY

Something uncertain feels threatening.

WHEN YOU FEEL AN EMOTION · ASK

"What is this feeling trying to tell me?"

Build this chart WITH students — add each emotion as they name it. Keep posted all year.

Everyone Makes Mistakes

DURATION	30–35 min · Week 3
OBJECTIVE	Students articulate that mistakes are universal and identify the difference between a mistake and a character flaw.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness: growth mindset; accurate self-perception
VOCABULARY	mistake, failure, growth, learning, normal
MATERIALS	Mentor text (Mistakes That Worked or Beautiful Oops!) · Journals · Sticky notes

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"We said emotions are messengers. What emotion do you feel when you make a mistake?" Take 3 responses. "Today we look at mistakes themselves — not the emotion, but what a mistake actually IS."

1

Mentor Text Read-Aloud

2–8 MIN

Read a page or two from the selected text. "Was this person bad because they made a mistake? Or were they just a person making a mistake? What is the difference?"

2

Mistake vs. Flaw

8–15 MIN

A mistake is something you DID. A flaw is something you ARE. "I got the answer wrong" = mistake. "I am stupid" = flaw. Run 4–5 examples — students call out: mistake or flaw? "The inner critic turns mistakes into flaw statements."

3

Mistake Gallery

15–22 MIN

Students write or draw on sticky notes: a mistake they made and something they learned. Anonymous. Post on the board. "Look how much learning is in this room."

4

Private Journal

22–30 MIN

Think of a mistake you are still hard on yourself about. Write: The mistake was _____. What I learned was _____. What I would do differently is _____. "You just gave it a learning frame instead of a shame frame."

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the private journal: any student who writes for only 10–15 seconds, or conversely who writes intensely and then covers the page, may be carrying something significant. Do not press. Note for Unit 2 watch list.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 3 · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the read-aloud: watch for students whose posture shifts or who look down at the word “mistake.” Physical cues of shame — clenching, withdrawing, covering the face — can signal that mistakes at home carry much heavier consequences than this lesson assumes.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 1-E · EVERYONE MAKES MISTAKES

THE SITUATION Priya forgot her part of a group project. That night: “I always ruin everything. I am so irresponsible. I am a bad friend.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Which of Priya's self-statements are about the MISTAKE, and which about her IDENTITY? Inner Critic: “I always ruin everything.” Inner Coach: “I forgot something important. I need to apologize and be more reliable.”

SCENARIO CARD 1-F · EVERYONE MAKES MISTAKES

THE SITUATION Jaylen missed the winning penalty kick. His older brother says: “Messi missed penalty kicks. Jordan missed shots. That doesn't make them bad players.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is the missed kick evidence Jaylen is a bad soccer player — or evidence that he is a soccer player? Why do we hold onto worst moments as if they define us?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: Complete this sentence: “Making mistakes means I am ___, not that I am ___.” **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students seemed to genuinely believe a mistake means they are bad? Note these students for closer attention in Unit 2.

My Inner Critic vs. My Inner Coach

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 4
OBJECTIVE	Students identify the inner critic voice, contrast it with the inner coach, and practice reframing one critical thought.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · Self-Management: self-talk and reframing
VOCABULARY	inner critic, inner coach, self-talk, reframe, voice
MATERIALS	Journals · WS3 Two Voices · Anchor chart · Scenario cards

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

“Who made a mistake this week?” (Most hands.) “Who was hard on themselves about it?” “Today we meet the voice that turns a mistake into a flaw statement. It has a name.”

1

Introduce the Inner Critic

2–10 MIN

Do you have a voice that makes things about who you ARE, not just what you did? Examples: “You always mess up.” / “You’re not as good as everyone else.” Pattern: the inner critic ATTACKS identity. It is global. It catastrophizes.

2

Introduce the Inner Coach

10–17 MIN

The inner coach is honest AND kind. Three questions: WHAT happened? WHAT can I learn? WHAT is one next step? Post these permanently.

ANCHOR CHART · INNER CRITIC VS. INNER COACH — PERMANENT ANCHOR CHART

Build WITH students — both columns. Color-code: red for Critic, green for Coach. Post permanently. Students will use this language spontaneously by Week 8.

3

Build the Anchor Chart

17–22 MIN

Two columns: INNER CRITIC language / INNER COACH language. Students help generate both sides.

4

Scenario Card Reframes (WS3)

22–32 MIN

Distribute WS3. For each scenario: (1) Write what the inner critic says. (2) Write what the inner coach says. (3) Which helps them do better next time? Debrief: “Was the coach softer? Did it ignore what happened?” [No — honest AND kind.]

5

Personal Reframe Practice

32–38 MIN

Journal + WS3 Part 2: Write one recent inner critic statement. Rewrite in the inner coach voice. “Which would you say to your best friend?” Private.

IN-LESSON SCAN

As you introduce the inner critic: students who immediately and emphatically say “yes” or who name very specific critic phrases without hesitation are telling you the critic is loud and very familiar. These students need Unit 2 most.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During personal reframe practice: a student who cannot write a single inner coach response — who genuinely cannot find a kinder voice — may have no internal model of kind self-talk. This is significant. Note for individual follow-up.

GRADE 3**GRADES 4 — 5****SCENARIO CARD 1-G · INNER CRITIC VS. INNER COACH**

THE SITUATION Sofia failed her science test. “I’m just not smart. There’s no point trying harder because I’m always going to fail.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Which voice is speaking? Rewrite Sofia’s inner monologue as if the Inner Coach were speaking. Inner Critic: “I’m just not smart.” Inner Coach: “That didn’t go the way I wanted. What did I not understand? I can study differently.”

SCENARIO CARD 1-H · INNER CRITIC VS. INNER COACH

THE SITUATION During his presentation, Theo’s voice cracked and the class giggled. Inner voice: “Everyone thinks I’m so weird. I’m never doing a presentation again.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is the Inner Critic saying? Is it actually true? What would the Inner Coach say instead? Inner Critic: “Everyone thinks I’m weird.” Inner Coach: “That was embarrassing. Voices crack — it happens. Next time will be easier.”

EXIT TICKET

Journal: “One thing my inner critic says: _____. One thing my inner coach would say instead: _____.” **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students identified the inner critic voice quickly and clearly — suggesting it is very familiar? These students need Unit 2 most urgently.

ANCHOR CHART · INNER CRITIC VS. INNER COACH

Print this page · Post in classroom at the moment indicated · Keep posted for the remainder of the year

 **INNER CRITIC** **INNER COACH**

UNIT 1 · LESSON 4 · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

ATTACKS YOUR IDENTITY "You ARE bad"	ADDRESSES YOUR BEHAVIOR "That didn't go well"
GLOBAL · CATASTROPHIC "You ALWAYS mess up" "You'll NEVER get it right"	SPECIFIC · HONEST · KIND "What can I learn here?" "What is one next step?"
POINTS TOWARD HIDING & SHAME	POINTS TOWARD REPAIR & GROWTH

THE INNER COACH ASKS THREE QUESTIONS

1. WHAT happened? 2. WHAT can I learn? 3. WHAT is one next step?

Build WITH students — both columns. Color-code red/green. Post permanently. Reference every lesson for the rest of the year.

WORKSHEET · WS3

Two Voices — One Choice

Unit 1, Lesson 4

Architecture of Grace · Grades 3-5 · Reproducible for classroom use · School of Life Foundation

ANCHOR TABLE · REFERENCE THIS ALL YEAR

INNER CRITIC SAYS...	INNER COACH SAYS...
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PART 1 · SCENARIO PRACTICE

SITUATION A: YOU FAIL A TEST YOU STUDIED HARD FOR.

INNER CRITIC SAYS:	INNER COACH SAYS:
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SITUATION B: YOU GET CUT FROM THE SCHOOL PLAY.

INNER CRITIC SAYS:	INNER COACH SAYS:
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SITUATION C: YOU SAY SOMETHING THAT ACCIDENTALLY HURTS A FRIEND'S FEELINGS.

INNER CRITIC SAYS:	INNER COACH SAYS:
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UNIT 1 · LESSON 4 · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

PART 2 · YOUR PERSONAL REFRAME

Private — not collected.

My Inner Critic recently said:

My Inner Coach says instead:

Reflection: Which voice would you say to your best friend? What does that tell you?

My Regulation Toolkit

DURATION	35–40 min · Unit 1 Week 5 (after Lesson 4, before Lesson 5)
OBJECTIVE	Students name their three regulation strategies — one body-based, one cognitive, one relational — and record them on WS-R1 (My Toolkit), which they will carry and reference all year.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: emotional regulation and self-monitoring · Self-Awareness: recognizing internal states
NEW ANCHOR CHART	Window of Tolerance (WOT-1) — introduced in this lesson. Must be posted before class begins.
WORKSHEET	WS-R1: My Regulation Toolkit — completed and owned by student. Not collected.
VOCABULARY	regulation, window of tolerance, activated, settled, strategy, toolkit

PLACEMENT NOTE

This lesson is delivered between Unit 1 Lesson 4 (My Inner Critic vs. My Inner Coach) and Lesson 5 (Guilt vs. Shame). Placement here is intentional: students have now met the inner critic — they know the voice that attacks identity after a mistake. This lesson gives them the physical and practical infrastructure to regulate the activation that the critic produces before it overwhelms them. The guilt/shame distinction in Lesson 5 will be significantly more accessible to students who have this toolkit in hand.

SAFETY NOTE

This is a standard-risk lesson. No counselor co-facilitation is required. However: some students have learned to be disconnected from their body as a protective response to trauma or chronic stress. For these students, body-awareness prompts can feel disorienting or activating. Monitor during the body strategy section. If a student appears distressed during any body-awareness activity, offer the option to observe rather than participate. Note for counselor awareness — this student may benefit from individual support before the deeper emotional content in Units 2 and 3.

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Display all Unit 1 anchor charts simultaneously. "In Unit 1 we have been building something together — a more honest map of who we are. We named our strengths. We said emotions are information. We learned about the inner critic and what it does." Pause. "Today is different. Today is not a concept. It is a toolkit. And this toolkit is going to be on your desk in some form for the rest of this year — because everything we do in Units 2 and 3 gets easier when you have it."

ANCHOR CHART · WINDOW OF TOLERANCE · WOT-1

This chart must be posted before students enter. Do not reveal it at the start — let students see it already on the wall when they walk in. This communicates: this is permanent, this matters, this belongs here.

1

Open the Question

2-4 MIN

"Have you ever been so activated — so upset or flooded — that you couldn't find words, couldn't think straight, couldn't make a good decision?" Take 3-4 responses. Then: "Has anyone ever been in the opposite direction — kind of numb, checked out, like you had left the building?" Take 2-3 responses. "Both of those are real states. They have names."

2

Introduce the Window

4-8 MIN

Walk students through the three zones on the chart using their own words from the previous discussion. "Too much — flooded — is up here. Too little — numb, checked out — is here. And in the middle is what researchers call the Window of Tolerance." Build each column WITH student input — ask them to name the body cues before you confirm. Do not pre-fill the chart.

3

The Key Teaching

8-10 MIN

"You cannot do the hardest work in this class — repair, accountability, forgiveness — from outside your Window. When you're flooded, the brain literally cannot do those things well. Which means: regulation is not a soft skill. It is the prerequisite for everything else we do here. Regulate first. Then do the work."

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE — A student who disengages or looks uncomfortable during the body-cues discussion — looking away, seeming distracted when others are enthusiastically naming physical sensations. **MAY**

MEAN — Some students have learned to disconnect from their body as a protective strategy — particularly students with trauma histories. Body awareness can feel threatening rather than

informative for these students. **ACTION** — Do not press for participation. After class, note privately.

This student will need extra care during the body-based strategy section. Offer: "You can observe and notice in your journal rather than out loud."

DIRECT INSTRUCTION · STEPS 1 — 3 · 20 MINUTES TOTAL

STEP 1 · THE THREE STRATEGY DOMAINS · 5 MINUTES

"A regulation strategy is something you do that reliably helps move you back toward your Window. The key word is reliably — it actually works for you, not just in theory."

There are three domains of regulation strategy:

STEP 2 · TEACH THE 4-COUNT BREATH · 5 MINUTES

Before students choose their strategies, give them concrete practice with the most accessible body-based strategy: the 4-count breath. This is not optional — it establishes a shared baseline tool the whole class has practiced together.

UNIT 1 · LESSON STRAND · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

PRACTICE SCRIPT — DELIVER VERBATIM OR VERY CLOSE TO IT

"Put both feet flat on the floor. Sit up slightly — not rigid, just upright." "We are going to breathe together. In for 4 counts — slow, into your belly, not your chest. Out for 4 counts. Nothing complicated. Just this." Count out loud: breathe in together — 1, 2, 3, 4 — breathe out together — 1, 2, 3, 4. Do this three times as a class. "Notice anything? Did your body do something? That is the nervous system responding to a signal. You just gave your body a signal that said: you are safe. It is quick. It is portable. You can do it in a hallway, during a test, before a hard conversation."

STEP 3 · BUILD THE PERSONAL TOOLKIT · WS-R1 · 10 MINUTES

Distribute WS-R1. Students will complete this worksheet now and keep it all year. It is not collected. It lives in their journal or folder as a personal reference.

"You are going to build your own personal toolkit right now. Not someone else's toolkit — yours. The rule is: choose strategies that actually work for you. Not strategies that sound impressive. Not strategies you've heard about. Strategies that, when you use them, you actually feel yourself moving back toward your Window."

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE — A student who leaves Section 4 (relational strategy) completely blank — who cannot name a single person they could go to. **MAY MEAN** — Social isolation, family difficulty, or limited experience of being supported by another person. A student with no trusted person in their relational world is carrying a significant risk factor. **ACTION** — Do not press during class. After class, approach quietly: "I noticed Section 4 was harder. The school counselor is always an option — they don't need to know everything, they just need to know you." Note for counselor awareness before Unit 2 begins.

SCENARIO CARD R1-A · PRIYA — TEST PANIC

THE SITUATION Priya is sitting down for her math test. The moment the paper is placed in front of her, her heart starts racing, her mind goes blank, and she can feel her hands shaking. She knows the material — she studied — but right now her brain feels like it has shut down. She has 45 minutes. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Which zone of the Window of Tolerance is Priya in right now? How do you know? Which of Priya's strategies from her toolkit could she use in the next 60 seconds — without leaving her seat? What would she do first? Second? Walk through it specifically. What is the difference between Priya using a strategy and Priya just trying to push through and hope for the best? This scenario targets the most common Over-arousal context students face. Keep the discussion concrete — not 'she should calm down' but specifically what she would do with her body in the next 60 seconds.

UNIT 1 · LESSON STRAND · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

SCENARIO CARD R1-B · MARCUS — THE SHUTDOWN

THE SITUATION Marcus got a 58 on his history test. He opens the paper, sees the grade, and immediately feels a wave of heaviness — like he has sunk into the floor. He stops talking. He doesn't raise his hand for the rest of the day. At lunch he sits alone even though his friends are at a nearby table. His teacher notices he seems very far away. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Which zone of the Window of Tolerance is Marcus in? What makes this harder to recognize than Priya's situation? Why might someone in the Too Little zone be harder to help than someone in the Too Much zone? Which strategies from the toolkit could help Marcus come back up toward his Window? What is the relational strategy that might matter most for Marcus right now? Card R1-B targets the under-arousal zone, which students are less practiced at recognizing than the over-arousal zone.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

EXIT TICKET

Journal: "My three strategies are: (1) ___ [body-based], (2) ___ [cognitive], (3) ___ [relational]. The one I think I will actually use most is ___ because ___." Student writes privately. Not collected. Not graded. **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students chose concrete, specific strategies that sound genuinely usable — versus students who wrote what they thought the correct answer was? Specificity is the signal of real engagement. A student who writes "4-count breath in my seat before I look at a test grade" is doing something different from a student who writes "breathe." Which students left **Section 4** (relational) blank or wrote something generic? Note these students for counselor awareness before Unit 2 begins.

POST-LESSON SAFETY CLOSE-OUT

Any student whose body appeared to disconnect during the breath practice or body-awareness discussion — note for a quiet individual check-in before the next class. Any student who could not name a relational strategy or person — note for counselor awareness before Unit 2 begins. **Did anything arise today requiring counselor follow-up?** ☐ No ☐ Yes — **contact counselor today**

ANCHOR CHART · WINDOW OF TOLERANCE · WOT-1

Print this page · Post in classroom BEFORE the lesson · Keep posted all year

* "YOU CANNOT DO HARD EMOTIONAL WORK — REPAIR, FORGIVENESS, ACCOUNTABILITY — FROM OUTSIDE THE WINDOW. REGULATE FIRST. THEN DO THE WORK."

*

WORKSHEET · WS-R1

My Regulation Toolkit

Unit 1 Strand Lesson

Architecture of Grace · Grades 3-5 · Reproducible for classroom use · School of Life Foundation

PRIVACY NOTE

This worksheet belongs to you. Your teacher will not collect or read it. Keep it in your journal or folder and bring it to class all year. It is your reference — not a grade.

SECTION 1 · MY WINDOW

What does it feel like in your body when you are settled and inside your Window?

What most often takes you OUTSIDE your Window? (Not a weakness — just honest data.)

SECTION 2 · MY BODY-BASED STRATEGY

Choose one strategy that works for your body. Be specific — not just 'breathe' but exactly how.

Options: 4-count belly breath · move my body · cold water on face · squeeze and release hands · feet flat on floor · walk / go outside

SECTION 3 · MY COGNITIVE STRATEGY

Choose one strategy that helps your thinking mind interrupt the state.

Options: name the feeling out loud or in writing · name 5 things I can see · ask: what is ACTUALLY happening? · remind myself: this will pass · write it down

SECTION 4 · MY RELATIONAL STRATEGY

Name one person you can go to when you need to regulate. They don't need to fix anything. You just need their presence or their voice.

Sentence I can actually say: "I'm having a hard moment. Can you just ___?"

SECTION 5 · MY COMMITMENT

I commit to using at least one of these strategies when I notice I am outside my Window — before I try to do any hard emotional work.

Signature _____ Date _____

MY THREE STRATEGIES AT A GLANCE

BODY · _____ COGNITIVE · _____

_____ RELATIONAL · _____

_____ Cut out and keep inside your journal cover.

Guilt vs. Shame

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 5
OBJECTIVE	Students clearly distinguish between guilt (behavior-level, productive) and shame (identity-level, destructive) and explain why guilt leads to growth while shame leads to hiding.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness: distinguishing guilt from shame · Self-Management: reframing
VOCABULARY	guilt, shame, behavior, identity, repair, hide, grow
MATERIALS	Journals · WS2 Sorting Cards · Anchor chart · Exit ticket sentence frames posted large

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"Last lesson we learned about the inner critic. Today we meet two feelings the inner critic confuses — and once you know the difference, you can never un-know it." Brief: "Have you ever felt bad in a way that made you want to FIX something? And in a way that made you want to HIDE?" That is today's lesson.

1

Define Guilt

2–10 MIN

Guilt says: I did something that doesn't fit who I want to be. Specific. Behavior-level. Useful. Points toward repair. "Fix it. Do better. Try again."

2

Define Shame

10–18 MIN

Shame says: I AM bad. Global. Identity-level. Destructive. Points toward hiding, withdrawal, or aggression. Grade 4+: shame activates the same threat response as physical danger.

ANCHOR CHART · GUILT VS. SHAME — THE MOST IMPORTANT DISTINCTION

Post this BEFORE the sorting activity. Students reference the chart as they sort. Keep posted all year. When a student uses shame language, point to the chart: "Which column is that in?"

3

Sorting Card Activity (WS2)

18–28 MIN

Students sort 8 statements into GUILT or SHAME columns. "Does this attack the behavior or the person? Does it point toward fixing or toward hiding?"

4

Anchor Chart + WS2 Part 2

28–35 MIN

WS2 Part 2: Take two shame statements and rewrite as guilt statements. Build the anchor chart: GUILT + about what I DID · points toward repair. SHAME = about who I AM · points toward hiding.

UNIT 1 · LESSON 5 · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

As students rewrite shame into guilt: watch for students who are unable to make the conversion — who keep landing back on identity statements even when trying to correct them. This rigidity is important data. These students are living inside shame, not just describing it.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the sorting activity: students who sort nearly everything into the SHAME column — or who struggle to recognize guilt statements as distinct — may be living primarily in shame. Chronic shame responses are a significant risk factor. Note carefully.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 1-I · GUILT VS. SHAME

THE SITUATION Kenji told a secret his best friend shared. That night: "I am such a bad person. A real friend would never do this. I don't deserve to have friends." **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is Kenji feeling guilt, shame, or both? Which feelings are useful and pointing toward repair?

SCENARIO CARD 1-J · GUILT VS. SHAME

THE SITUATION After getting a warning for talking, Lily burst into tears: "I always get in trouble. I'm the worst student in this class. I can't do anything right." **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What started as a behavior correction — what did Lily's mind turn it into? What would a guilt response sound like?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: "The difference between guilt and shame is _____. Guilt is more helpful because _____." **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students seemed to live primarily in shame — every mistake becoming an identity statement? Chronic shame is a significant risk factor.

ANCHOR CHART · GUILT VS. SHAME — THE MOST IMPORTANT DISTINCTION

Print this page · Post in classroom at the moment indicated · Keep posted for the remainder of the year

GUILT

SHAME

ABOUT WHAT I DID

ABOUT WHO I AM

UNIT 1 · LESSON 5 · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

BEHAVIOR-FOCUSED "I made a bad choice"	IDENTITY-FOCUSED "I am a bad person"
POINTS TOWARD: REPAIR "Fix it. Do better. Try again."	POINTS TOWARD: HIDING "Why even try? I'm hopeless."
WHEN YOU HEAR THE INNER CRITIC · ASK "Is this attacking my BEHAVIOR or my IDENTITY?"	

Post BEFORE the sorting activity. Keep posted all year. When a student uses shame language, point to the chart: "Which column is that in?"

WORKSHEET · WS2

Sorting: Guilt vs. Shame

Unit 1, Lesson 5

Architecture of Grace · Grades 3-5 · Reproducible for classroom use · School of Life Foundation

PART 1 — Read each statement. Decide whether it is GUILT (about what I DID) or SHAME (about who I AM). Mark each.

I made a bad choice today. ☐ GUILT ☐ SHAME

I am a terrible person. ☐ GUILT ☐ SHAME

I forgot my homework — I need to be more responsible. ☐ GUILT ☐ SHAME

I am stupid. ☐ GUILT ☐ SHAME

I yelled at my sister. That was not how I want to treat her. ☐ GUILT ☐ SHAME

Nobody really likes me. ☐ GUILT ☐ SHAME

I cheated on the quiz. I need to talk to my teacher. ☐ GUILT ☐ SHAME

I always ruin everything. ☐ GUILT ☐ SHAME

PART 2 · REWRITE

Take two SHAME statements above and rewrite them as GUILT statements:

I Am More Than My Worst Moment

DURATION	35 min · Week 6
OBJECTIVE	Students articulate that one moment, mistake, or hard day does not define their identity, and they generate evidence of their own larger story.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness: stable, accurate self-perception
VOCABULARY	moment, narrative, identity, evidence, larger story
MATERIALS	Journals · Index cards from L1 · Mentor text optional

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"We've talked about mistakes, the inner critic, and the difference between guilt and shame. Today we put it together. The story you tell yourself after a bad moment is the most important story."

1

The Story Of A Moment

2-10 MIN

Discuss: When something hard happens, your inner critic offers a quick story. "You ARE the failure." Today we practice the longer story. The longer story includes everything else — the times you tried, the times you came back, the people you helped.

2

Evidence Wall

10-20 MIN

Students think of three pieces of evidence about who they are that the inner critic ignores. Write on index cards. Add to class display. "This is the evidence wall."

3

Worst Moment Reframe

20-30 MIN

In journal: Pick one moment you are not proud of. Write three sentences: (1) What happened. (2) What the inner critic said about who you are. (3) What is also true about you that the critic left out.

4

Closing

30-35 MIN

Read aloud: "You are more than your worst moment." Have students repeat: "I am more than my worst moment."

IN-LESSON SCAN

As students do the worst-moment reframe: a student who cannot generate any "also true" evidence is signalling that the inner critic has full territorial control. Note for individual support.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 1-K · I AM MORE THAN MY WORST MOMENT

THE SITUATION Tariq tripped during the school play and the audience laughed. For weeks afterward, every time he passed a stage he thought: "I'm the kid who falls." **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is Tariq's inner critic saying? What are three other true things about Tariq that don't fit that one story? Why does one moment feel so much louder than all the others?

SCENARIO CARD 1-L · I AM MORE THAN MY WORST MOMENT

THE SITUATION Mia got in big trouble for cheating on a math test in 4th grade. Now in 5th grade, she still tells herself: "I'm a cheater. People don't trust me." **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is Mia describing what she DID or who she IS? What evidence might Mia have built since 4th grade that her inner critic refuses to count? How does someone make a worst moment smaller without pretending it didn't happen?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: Complete: "One moment that doesn't define me is _____. The bigger truth about me is _____." **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students wrote concrete evidence of their bigger story — and which couldn't generate any? Track for Unit 2.

Unit Reflection & Community Affirmation

DURATION	35 min · Week 7
OBJECTIVE	Students reflect on Unit 1 learning, name what was hardest and most useful, and offer one anonymous affirmation to a classmate.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · Social Awareness: empathy and community building
VOCABULARY	reflection, affirmation, community, kindness
MATERIALS	Journals · Index cards · Class identity wall display from L1

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Stand at the class identity wall. "Seven weeks ago, every one of you walked in and we built this wall. Look at it now. This is who we are."

1

Unit Recap (Co-Build)

2-10 MIN

Students name the major ideas of Unit 1: identity, emotions are messengers, mistake vs flaw, inner critic vs coach, guilt vs shame, more than worst moment. Write each on the board.

2

Personal Reflection (Journal)

10-18 MIN

Three prompts: (1) What is one idea from Unit 1 you are still thinking about? (2) What was hardest? (3) What do you understand about yourself now that you didn't seven weeks ago?

3

Anonymous Class Affirmation

18-28 MIN

Students draw a classmate's name from a basket. Write one true, kind thing about that person on an index card. No names of the writer. Read aloud anonymously. Each student leaves with one card written about them.

4

Closing Circle

28-35 MIN

Each student names one word for how they feel as Unit 1 ends. No comments — just the word. Teacher closes: "This is the foundation. Unit 2 builds on it."

IN-LESSON SCAN

During anonymous affirmation: watch for any student whose card seems to take a long time being written about — and any student who seems to avoid making eye contact when their card is read. Both can be data.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

EXIT TICKET

Journal: “One thing I am taking into Unit 2 is _____. One affirmation I received that mattered is _____.” **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students seemed deeply moved by the affirmation activity? Which seemed to deflect? Both extremes are useful data for Unit 2 planning.

BRIDGE PROTOCOL · ENTERING UNIT 2

STEP 1 · SURFACE ANCHOR Empty Heavy Backpack prop (used in Unit 2). **STEP 2 · NAME WHAT WAS BUILT** Students built an honest picture of who they are — strengths, emotional vocabulary, the inner critic vs inner coach distinction, the difference between guilt and shame, and the truth that they are more than their worst moment. **STEP 3 · GRADE 3 PROMPT** “In Unit 1 we learned the difference between guilt and shame. What was that difference? Today we learn what to do with guilt — how to handle it kindly instead of letting it turn into shame.” **STEP 3 · GRADES 4–5 PROMPT** “Look back at your Identity Web from Lesson 1. Did your inner critic attack your strength — or your behavior? That distinction is where Unit 2 begins.” **STEP 4 · STATE THE CONNECTION** “In Unit 1 we learned who we are. In Unit 2 we learn what to do when we let ourselves down. You can only practice self-compassion if you know the self you’re being compassionate toward. Unit 1 built that. Unit 2 builds on it.”

UNIT 2

Self-Compassion & Self-Forgiveness

*“How do I hold myself with both honesty and kindness
when I have done something I regret?”*

DURATION	October – December • 7 Lessons + 1 Strand • 35–40 min each
CASEL PRIMARY	Self-Management: accountability, self-compassion, self-forgiveness
CASEL SECONDARY	Self-Awareness: recognizing emotional and physical cues
MENTOR TEXTS	Beautiful Oops! (Saltzberg) • The Invisible String (Karst) • Wonder (Palacio)

Unit 2 teaches students what to do when they let themselves down — accountability without self-punishment, self-compassion, and the practice of self-forgiveness. The Heavy Backpack is the unit's central physical metaphor.

What Is Forgiveness, Really?

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 1
OBJECTIVE	Students identify and correct at least two common misconceptions about forgiveness and state an accurate definition in their own words.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness: accurate understanding of forgiveness · Self-Management: reframing
VOCABULARY	forgiveness, misconception, condone, weakness, release, heavy backpack
MATERIALS	Anchor chart · Journals · Sticky notes · Myth vs. Truth T-chart · Heavy backpack prop with books

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Hold up the empty backpack. “In Unit 1 we learned about the things we carry. Today we begin Unit 2: how do we actually start taking things OUT?” Ask: “What do you already think forgiveness means?” Students write a one-sentence definition on a sticky note — read 3–4 aloud.

ANCHOR CHART · FORGIVENESS MYTH BUSTERS — THE HEAVY BACKPACK

Add one book as you name each myth. Address the myth. Remove the book. Students watch the load lighten. Four myths, four books, four removals. The physical demonstration IS the lesson.

1

Myth Busters

5–18 MIN

MYTH 1: Forgiveness means forgetting. FALSE. MYTH 2: Forgiveness means what happened was okay. FALSE. MYTH 3: Forgiveness is weakness. FALSE. MYTH 4: You must feel ready before you start. FALSE — forgiveness is a decision, not a feeling. Remove each book as you address each myth.

2

Working Definition

18–25 MIN

Forgiveness is the process of releasing resentment or self-blame — not to excuse behavior, but to free yourself from continuing to carry the weight of it. Write large. “Not for the person who hurt us. For us.”

3

Scenario Discussion

25–32 MIN

Share an age-appropriate scenario illustrating self-forgiveness. What would it cost this person to keep holding on? What might they gain by working toward release?

4

Sticky-Note Revision

32–38 MIN

Students retrieve their original definition. Journal: “Before I thought forgiveness meant _____. Now I think it means _____.”

IN-LESSON SCAN

As students write their initial definition of forgiveness on sticky notes: watch for students who write “forgiveness means forgetting” or “forgiveness means it was okay.” These are the myths most likely to be blocking real forgiveness work — and the students who hold them most firmly often have the most to release.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During sticky-note revision: any student whose revised definition is identical to their original — or who refuses to revise — may be resistant to the reframe. Receive this without pressure. Some resistance is protection. Note for Unit 2.

GRADE 3**GRADES 4 — 5****SCENARIO CARD 2-A · WHAT IS FORGIVENESS, REALLY?**

THE SITUATION Sofia hurt her friend and cannot forgive herself. “Forgiving myself feels like I’m saying it was okay. And it wasn’t okay. I was awful.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What is Sofia confusing forgiveness with? Does forgiving yourself require that what you did was acceptable? Myth: “Self-forgiveness means what I did was okay.” Truth: Forgiving yourself means releasing the weight — not excusing the action.

SCENARIO CARD 2-B · WHAT IS FORGIVENESS, REALLY?

THE SITUATION Elijah got a two-day suspension eight months ago. He did everything required. But he still introduces himself as “the kid who got suspended.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What myth about forgiveness might Elijah be living out? Why might someone hold onto a label even after repair is complete?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: Write one thing you now know about forgiveness that you did not know before today. **TEACHER REFLECTION** How are students defining forgiveness before instruction? Which myths are most deeply held?

ANCHOR CHART · FORGIVENESS MYTH BUSTERS — THE HEAVY BACKPACK

Print this page · Post in classroom at the moment indicated · Keep posted for the remainder of the year

WHAT FORGIVENESS IS NOT

UNIT 2 · LESSON 1 · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

× MYTH 1	Forgiveness does NOT mean forgetting what happened.
× MYTH 2	Forgiveness does NOT mean what happened was okay.
× MYTH 3	Forgiveness is NOT weakness — it takes more courage than holding a grudge.
× MYTH 4	You do NOT have to feel ready before you start — forgiveness is a decision, not a feeling.

WHAT FORGIVENESS IS

Forgiveness is the process of releasing resentment or self-blame — **not to excuse behavior, but to free YOURSELF from continuing to carry the weight of it. Not for the person who hurt us. · For US.**

Use the backpack prop: add one book per myth, remove as you address each. Students watch the load lighten. The physical demonstration IS the lesson.

The Weight of Self-Criticism

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 2
OBJECTIVE	Students describe how unresolved guilt and shame affect the body, behavior, and relationships, and identify at least one sign they may be carrying a burden.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness: recognizing emotional and physical cues · Self-Management: understanding the cost of chronic self-criticism
VOCABULARY	burden, chronic, self-criticism, tension, withdrawal, armor
MATERIALS	Heavy backpack with books · Journals · Body outline worksheet

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"Last lesson we said forgiveness is about putting the backpack down. Today we feel what it's like to carry it — what it actually does to you."

1

Backpack Loading Demonstration

2–8 MIN

Add heavy books one at a time. Ask a volunteer to carry it for 30 seconds. "Some of us carry emotional weight the same way — except no one can see it, and we don't put it down at the end of the day."

2

Where the Weight Goes

8–18 MIN

IN THE BODY (tight chest, stomachaches, trouble sleeping); IN BEHAVIOR (defensiveness, avoiding people, perfectionism); IN RELATIONSHIPS (pushing people away, quick anger). Grades 4–5: Introduce emotional armor.

3

Body Outline Activity (Private)

18–26 MIN

Students mark where they feel or have felt emotional weight and label what it connects to. "This page is private. I will not collect it."

4

Class Discussion (No Personal Disclosure)

26–33 MIN

"Why does holding onto self-blame feel like it's helping?" Reframe: "Carrying the weight indefinitely does not undo what happened."

5

Journal

33–38 MIN

"Describe something you are carrying right now — a mistake, a regret. You don't have to share it. Just name it." Private.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 2 · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

While students work on the private body outline: any student who marks the entire outline or who cannot stop adding details may be carrying a much heavier burden than this lesson was designed for. Note for counselor involvement consideration.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the backpack demonstration: watch student faces and body language. A student who physically responds — shoulders rounding, eyes dropping, a sharp intake of breath — may be recognizing weight they carry daily. The weight may be resonating with something real.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 2-C · THE WEIGHT OF SELF-CRITICISM

THE SITUATION Nadia is a perfectionist. When she gets anything less than an A, she spends the day going over every mistake. She has trouble sleeping. Her teacher notices she erases more than she writes.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS Where is Nadia's body carrying the weight of her self-criticism? What "armor" has she put on? Body Check-In: Where do you feel tension when you are being hard on yourself? Chest? Stomach? Shoulders?

SCENARIO CARD 2-D · THE WEIGHT OF SELF-CRITICISM

THE SITUATION After making a mistake during a group presentation, Diego refused to speak for the rest of class and pulled away from friends at lunch. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What behavioral signs suggest Diego is carrying significant self-criticism? What does the self-criticism cost him beyond how he feels?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: Describe something you are carrying right now — a mistake, a regret. Just name it. **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students seem to be carrying particularly heavy loads? Note for individual follow-up and consider counselor involvement.

Accountability Without Self-Punishment

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 3
OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish between genuine accountability and self-punishment, and practice the three-part accountability framework.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: responsible decision-making after a mistake · Relationship Skills: repair
VOCABULARY	accountability, self-punishment, repair, genuine, consequences
MATERIALS	WS4 Accountability Map · Scenario cards · Journals

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"Today we learn the difference between handling a mistake in a way that actually helps — and handling it in a way that makes things worse." Quick check: "Accountability is guilt in action. Self-punishment is shame in action."

1 Define the Distinction

2–9 MIN

Genuine accountability = owning what happened + understanding the impact + making repair. Self-punishment = using the mistake as evidence of unworthiness, replaying guilt without moving toward repair. "The person drowning in self-punishment is often the LEAST accountable."

ANCHOR CHART · THREE-PART ACCOUNTABILITY MAP — DISPLAY DURING ACTIVITY

Post before distributing WS4. Walk through each step as a class with the Isabella example. Keep displayed throughout Unit 2.

2 The Three-Part Accountability Map (WS4)

9–17 MIN

Three steps: (1) What EXACTLY happened — honest, not dramatized. (2) What was the actual IMPACT? (3) What can I actually do to REPAIR or do better? Model with a real teacher example.

3 Scenario Practice (WS4)

17–28 MIN

(1) Model the first as a class. (2) Pairs do the second. (3) Individual for the third. Debrief: "What would self-punishment look like here instead?"

4 Personal Application — Journal

28–36 MIN

Apply the accountability map to a mistake you have been hard on yourself about. "Notice: filling in the map probably feels different from just feeling bad."

UNIT 2 · LESSON 3 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the personal application journal: students who fill in Steps 1 and 2 extensively but leave Step 3 blank may genuinely believe repair is not possible — or that they do not deserve it. This is significant. Note for Unit 2, Lesson 5 watch list.

IN-LESSON SCAN

As you model the three-part accountability map: students who interrupt with “but it was so much worse than that” or who dramatically expand the scenario may be stuck in self-punishment rather than accountability. These students are not minimizing — they are maximizing. Both need attention.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 2-E · ACCOUNTABILITY WITHOUT SELF-PUNISHMENT

THE SITUATION Isabella accidentally broke her neighbor's garden gnome. She told her parents and offered to pay with her allowance. But weeks later, she is still apologizing — even though the neighbor has clearly moved on. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Has Isabella done genuine accountability? At what point does accountability tip into self-punishment? Three-Part Map: Broke the gnome. Impact: neighbor lost something valued. Repair: apologized and offered to pay. ✓ COMPLETE. The self-punishment can stop here.

SCENARIO CARD 2-F · ACCOUNTABILITY WITHOUT SELF-PUNISHMENT

THE SITUATION After lying to his parents, Marcus has been staying up late stressing, triple-checking every assignment, and told his friend: “I am the worst kid. I always lie. I can't be trusted.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What accountability does Marcus need to complete? Which parts of his response are useful? Which are self-punishment rather than repair?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: “The difference between accountability and self-punishment is _____. Accountability is more useful because _____.” **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students seem most stuck in shame spirals? Both withdrawing and becoming defensive are shame responses.

ANCHOR CHART · THREE-PART ACCOUNTABILITY MAP

Print this page · Post in classroom at the moment indicated · Keep posted for the remainder of the year

✓ ACCOUNTABILITY

× SELF-PUNISHMENT

UNIT 2 · LESSON 3 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

STEP 1	What EXACTLY happened? Honest, not dramatized. Not worse than it was, not better.
STEP 2	What was the actual IMPACT? On the other person. On the relationship. On yourself.
STEP 3	What REPAIR is possible? What can I actually do? And when repair is complete — release.

*WHEN THE MAP IS COMPLETE — THE SELF-PUNISHMENT CAN STOP.

*

WORKSHEET · WS4

The Three-Part Accountability Map

Unit 2, Lesson 3

Architecture of Grace · Grades 3–5 · Reproducible for classroom use · School of Life Foundation

ACCOUNTABILITY	SELF-PUNISHMENT
----------------	-----------------

PRACTICE EXAMPLE — ISABELLA'S SCENARIO

Isabella broke her neighbor's garden gnome. She told her parents, apologized, and offered to pay. Three weeks later she is still apologizing — even though the neighbor has clearly moved on.

STEP 1 — WHAT EXACTLY HAPPENED?

STEP 2 — WHAT WAS THE ACTUAL IMPACT?

STEP 3 — WHAT REPAIR HAS ISABELLA DONE? IS IT COMPLETE?

APPLY IT TO YOURSELF · PRIVATE — NOT COLLECTED

STEP 1 — WHAT EXACTLY HAPPENED?

STEP 2 — WHAT WAS THE ACTUAL IMPACT?

STEP 3 — WHAT REPAIR IS POSSIBLE?

Reflection: Is my accountability map complete? What can I now release?

Recovering After Mistakes

DURATION	35–40 min · Unit 2 Week 4 (after Lesson 3, before Lesson 4)
OBJECTIVE	Students map a recent mistake through the four-phase recovery sequence — Activated → Regulating → Reflecting → Reintegrating — and articulate why regulation must precede repair and accountability work.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: emotional regulation after mistakes · Self-Awareness: recognizing recovery phases · Responsible Decision-Making: sequencing repair correctly
NEW ANCHOR CHART	The Recovery Arc (ARC-1) — four-phase diagram. Must be posted before class begins.
WORKSHEET	WS-R2: My Recovery Map — private, completed in class, kept by student all year.
VOCABULARY	recovery, activated, regulating, reflecting, reintegrating, phase, sequence, window of tolerance

PLACEMENT NOTE

This lesson lands between Unit 2 Lesson 3 (Accountability Without Self-Punishment) and Lesson 4 (Talking to Yourself Kindly — the self-compassion letter). The Three-Part Accountability Map from L3 gives students a framework for what to do after a mistake. This strand lesson answers the question that precedes it: before you can use that map well, you need to be in a regulated enough state to use it at all.

SAFETY NOTE

Standard risk lesson — no counselor co-facilitation required. However, the private journal phase (WS-R2) invites students to apply the four phases to a real recent mistake. The worksheet is always private and never collected. If a student's journal writing during Step 3 triggers a disclosure, follow the standard disclosure protocol (Section 4 — Legal & Clinical Compliance).

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Point to the Window of Tolerance anchor chart (WOT-1). Hold up WS-R1 (My Toolkit) if students have theirs. "Last time in our strand work we built our toolkits. We learned that you cannot do hard emotional work from outside your Window. Today we go one step further: what does it actually look like to move from the moment a mistake happens — that hit of activation, shame, or dread — all the way through to being ready to do something real about it? That sequence has four phases. And knowing them changes how you treat yourself in the middle of them."

UNIT 2 · LESSON STRAND · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

ANCHOR CHART · THE RECOVERY ARC · ARC-1

Post this chart before students arrive alongside WOT-1. The two charts work together: WOT-1 names the states; ARC-1 names the journey between them after a mistake.

*REGULATE FIRST. · REFLECT SECOND. · REPAIR THIRD. · IN THAT ORDER. EVERY TIME.

*

I

Walk Through the Four Phases

1-6 MIN

Point to each phase on the Recovery Arc chart. Use a recent, low-stakes personal example — something real, not polished. This models the authenticity the lesson requires.

2

The Sequence Is Not Optional

6-10 MIN

"When something goes wrong — when you make a mistake, hurt someone, feel ashamed — the instinct is to rush straight to fix it. That instinct is understandable. But if you are still in Phase 1 when you attempt Phase 4 work, it will not land. An apology delivered while activated often sounds defensive."

3

Private Mapping — WS-R2

10-18 MIN

Distribute WS-R2. Students apply the four-phase arc to a real recent mistake. "This worksheet is private. Think of a mistake from the last week or two — not the worst mistake of your life. We are going to walk that mistake through the four phases."

4

Connection to Unit 2 Content

18-22 MIN

Phase 3 is exactly where WS4 (the Accountability Map) lives. Phase 4 is where the self-compassion letter from Lesson 4 lives. The arc is the prerequisite for everything that follows in Unit 2.

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE — A student who begins writing intensely and then stops, covers the paper, or appears visibly distressed. **MAY MEAN** — The mistake they chose to map may be more significant than a 'manageable recent mistake.' Some students will unconsciously bring their biggest burden into any reflective task. **ACTION** — Do not approach during the writing. After class: "Today seemed to land somewhere real for you. If you want to talk, I'm here. The counselor is also an option."

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE — A student who writes Phase 1 very quickly and then gets stuck at Phase 2 — staring at the page. **MAY MEAN** — This student may not yet have a functional Phase 2 — they know what activated feels like but have no reliable pathway back to their Window. Their toolkit may be underdeveloped or unused. **ACTION** — After class: briefly review their WS-R1 with them if they consent. Their relational strategy in particular may need strengthening. Note for counselor awareness before Unit 2 L6.

UNIT 2 · LESSON STRAND · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

SCENARIO CARD R2-A · SOFIA — GROUP PROJECT SPIRAL

THE SITUATION Sofia's group just got their grade back — a C+, lower than she expected. Her part of the project had two errors. Within five minutes she has already told herself she always ruins group projects. It is lunchtime. Her group is at the next table. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Which phase of the Recovery Arc is Sofia in right now? What specific evidence tells you? What would happen if Sofia walked over to her group right now and tried to apologize? What does Sofia need to do in Phase 2 — specifically, in the next 10 minutes at lunch — to begin moving back toward her Window?

SCENARIO CARD R2-B · JAYLEN — PENALTY KICK (TWO MONTHS LATER)

THE SITUATION Two months ago, Jaylen missed the penalty kick that cost his team the championship. He has already talked to his coach, apologized to his team. But he still replays the moment every night. He says: "I've done everything I'm supposed to do. Why can't I just let it go?" **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Which phase of the Recovery Arc is Jaylen stuck in, two months later? Jaylen has completed Phase 3 and Phase 4 actions — the apology, the accountability. Why is he still stuck? What would it mean for Jaylen to actually complete Phase 4 — not just do the actions, but genuinely reintegrate?

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

EXIT TICKET

Journal: "The four phases of the Recovery Arc are: (1) ___, (2) ___, (3) ___, (4) ___. The most important thing about the sequence is ___. A time I tried to do Phase 4 work from Phase 1 was ___. What I would do differently now is ___." **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students seemed to genuinely recognize a real experience in the four-phase arc? Which got stuck at Phase 2 on WS-R2 — suggesting an underdeveloped regulation capacity? These students may struggle with Lesson 4 (self-compassion letter) and should be noted for closer observation at Unit 2 L6.

WORKSHEET · WS-R2

My Recovery Map

Unit 2 Strand Lesson

Architecture of Grace · Grades 3–5 · Reproducible for classroom use · School of Life Foundation

PRIVACY NOTE

This worksheet is private. Your teacher will not collect or read it. Keep it with WS-R1 in your journal or folder and bring it to class all year.

Think of a real mistake from the last week or two — not the worst mistake of your life, but something real. Walk that mistake through the four phases below.

PHASE 1 · ACTIVATED

The mistake (1–2 sentences):

UNIT 2 · LESSON STRAND · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

What did Phase 1 feel like in your body?

What was your inner critic saying in Phase 1?

PHASE 2 · REGULATING

Which strategy from your toolkit (WS-R1) did you use — or could you have used?

How long did Phase 2 take — or how long would it need to take?

PHASE 3 · REFLECTING

What could you see clearly from inside your Window that you could NOT see in Phase 1?

Using the Accountability Map (WS4): What exactly happened? What was the impact? What does repair require?

PHASE 4 · REINTEGRATING

What would completing Phase 4 look like for this mistake?

Is there anything still incomplete in the arc? If so, what is one next step?

Talking to Yourself Kindly ★ ELEVATED

DURATION	40 min · Week 4
OBJECTIVE	Students write a self-compassion letter to themselves and articulate what makes self-compassion different from self-pity or excusing mistakes.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: self-compassion practice · Self-Awareness: honest and kind self-talk
VOCABULARY	self-compassion, kindness, honest, letter, friend voice
MATERIALS	Journals · WS5 Letter From Your Best Friend · Teacher model letter (prepared in advance)

SAFETY CHECK — COMPLETE BEFORE DELIVERING

Counselor notified — minimum 1 week in advance. · Counselor reachable on the day. · Lesson NOT scheduled before a school break. · Reflection Pass pre-positioned at every student seat. · AFSP Safe Messaging applies. If student language shifts from feeling to self ("I want to get rid of myself"), STOP immediately and activate the Disclosure Protocol.

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"Once you have owned a mistake and started repair — then comes the part we skip most often: being kind to yourself about it."

I

The Friend Test — Opening Hook

2–8 MIN

"If your best friend came to you after making a mistake — what would you say?" Students write for 90 seconds. Then: "Do you ever say that to YOURSELF?" Very few hands. "Why not?" This gap is Dr. Neff's foundational research finding.

2

Direct Instruction

8–16 MIN

SELF-COMPASSION IS: (1) Self-kindness: speak with care, not contempt. (2) Common humanity: everyone struggles — you are not uniquely broken. (3) Mindfulness: notice what happened without dramatizing or suppressing. SELF-COMPASSION IS NOT: a free pass or pretending it was fine.

ANCHOR CHART · DR. NEFF'S THREE COMPONENTS OF SELF-COMPASSION

Post BEFORE students begin writing. They use it as a checklist: Does my letter include self-kindness? Common humanity? Mindfulness?

3

Teacher Model Letter (Read in Full)

16–22 MIN

Read your own model letter — written in advance, from a real experience. Do not summarize. Read it in full. After reading: silence for 10 seconds. “That is what we are doing today.”

4

Independent Letter Writing — WS5

22–35 MIN

Grade 3 frame: “Dear ___, What happened was ___. I know it feels hard. Everyone makes mistakes. You can still ___. I believe in you because ___. With love, ___.” Silence during writing is appropriate — do not fill it.

5

Seal the Letter

35–38 MIN

Students fold and seal their letters. “This belongs to you. I will not read it without your invitation.” Store with their journals.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the Friend Test opening: watch for students who cannot write anything for 90 seconds — who genuinely do not know what they would say to a friend in distress. This may indicate impoverished models of compassion at home. These students will struggle with the letter. Stay close.

IN-LESSON SCAN

HEIGHTENED SCAN — Elevated-risk lesson. During letter writing: maintain quiet circulation. Watch for students who are visibly distressed, crying silently, or who write and then furiously cross everything out. If you observe language suggesting self-harm or hopelessness — STOP the activity immediately and activate the Disclosure Protocol.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 2-G · TALKING TO YOURSELF KINDLY

THE SITUATION After bombing a tryout, Zara's friend says: “If I had just bombed a tryout, here is what you would say to me: ‘You are so brave for trying. One audition does not define you.’ But you will never say that to yourself.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Why do we speak to friends with more compassion than we speak to ourselves? What does “honest AND kind” look like for Zara?

SCENARIO CARD 2-H · TALKING TO YOURSELF KINDLY

THE SITUATION When Liam got a 68, his mom said: “It is okay, sweetie. You tried your best. You are amazing no matter what.” Liam felt worse, not better. “She's just saying that. That was a bad test.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Why did his mother's comfort not land? What was missing? What is the difference between self-compassion and empty cheerleading?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: "Self-compassion is not the same as letting yourself off the hook because ____." **TEACHER**

REFLECTION Which students struggled most to write the letter — unable to be kind enough, or unable to be honest? Both reveal different support needs.

WORKSHEET · WS5

Letter From Your Best Friend

Unit 2, Lesson 4

Architecture of Grace · Grades 3–5 · Reproducible for classroom use · School of Life Foundation

PRIVACY NOTE

This letter is private and belongs to you. Your teacher will not collect or read it without your invitation.

BEFORE YOU WRITE — If my best friend came to me having made this mistake, I would say:

Do I ever say anything like that to myself? Circle one:

THE THREE PARTS OF SELF-COMPASSION · DR. KRISTIN NEFF

SELF-KINDNESS	"I care about you. You are not defined by this."
COMMON HUMANITY	"Everyone goes through hard things like this."
MINDFULNESS	"I can acknowledge this without making it bigger than it is."

WRITE YOUR LETTER — INCLUDE ALL THREE COMPONENTS:

Dear _____ ,

With love, _____

Self-compassion is NOT letting yourself off the hook because...

Letting Go — A Practice ★ ELEVATED

DURATION	40 min · Week 5
OBJECTIVE	Students engage in a symbolic release practice and articulate why self-forgiveness is an ongoing practice, not a single event.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: symbolic release and process understanding
VOCABULARY	release, practice, process, choose, ongoing, lighter
MATERIALS	Small stones or slips of paper · Journals · Reflection Pass pre-positioned at every seat

SAFETY CHECK — COMPLETE BEFORE DELIVERING

Counselor notified — minimum 1 week in advance. · Counselor reachable on the day. · Lesson NOT scheduled before a school break. · Reflection Pass pre-positioned at every seat. Monitor for students who interpret “letting go” language as about letting go of the SELF. If you hear “I want to get rid of myself,” STOP immediately and activate the Disclosure Protocol.

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

“Last lesson we wrote letters to ourselves. Today we practice actually putting something down. Not forgetting. Not saying it was fine. Just choosing not to carry it the same way anymore.”

ANCHOR CHART · THE STONE PRACTICE — GUIDED RELEASE VISUAL

Display this visual as you lead the practice. Walk through each step slowly. Students hold the stone through Steps 1-3, then place it down at Step 4. Give 30 seconds of silence. Do not rush this moment.

1

The Process Frame

2-9 MIN

Self-forgiveness is not a switch that flips. It is a practice you return to. Some things you put down dozens of times before they stay down. That is not failure — that is what the practice looks like.

2

The Stone Practice

9-18 MIN

Distribute small stones or slips of paper. Students write one thing they are ready to work on releasing. Guided release: “Hold what you wrote. I acknowledge what happened. I have done what repair is possible. I am choosing not to carry the weight of this the same way anymore.” Place the stone down. 30 seconds of silence.

3

Debrief the Practice

18–26 MIN

"How does it feel? Why does it sometimes feel like cheating to put something down?" Reframe: "Putting something down is choosing not to let it keep using your energy when that energy is needed elsewhere."

4

Journal

26–35 MIN

"What is one thing you have been carrying that might be ready to be worked on?" Drawing accepted. Private.

5

Closing

35–38 MIN

"Some of you may notice that what you put down today comes back tomorrow. That is okay. That is the practice. You put it down again. Each time, you get a little better at it."

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the closing: scan for students who appear more distressed at the end of the practice than at the beginning. A student who seems unable to find relief from the exercise may need individual support. Do not let this student leave without a brief, warm private check-in.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the stone practice: watch for students who cannot write anything on their stone — or who write something and then hold the stone without ever putting it down. A student who cannot put the stone down may be carrying something too significant for this classroom activity alone.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 2-I · LETTING GO — A PRACTICE

THE SITUATION Kayla cheated on a quiz, told her teacher the next day, and was given a zero. She did the right thing. But she still thinks about it almost every day. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Has Kayla done everything repair requires? What is the difference between not forgetting something and being crushed by it indefinitely? Acknowledge: cheated. Told the truth. ✓ Repair: Done. ✓ Release: "I am choosing not to carry the weight of this the same way anymore."

SCENARIO CARD 2-J · LETTING GO — A PRACTICE

THE SITUATION Connor has put the stone down a dozen times in his mind about crying in front of the class in 3rd grade. He is now in 5th grade. But sometimes it comes right back. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Has Connor failed because the shame keeps returning? What is the difference between self-forgiveness as a one-time event and an ongoing practice?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: "Letting go does not mean forgetting because _____. I can let go AND still _____." **TEACHER**

REFLECTION Were there students who seemed unable or unwilling to put the stone down? The student who cannot release may be carrying something too significant for this classroom activity alone.



When Self-Forgiveness Feels Impossible

★★ HIGHEST RISK

DURATION	40 min · Week 6
OBJECTIVE	Students identify strategies for when self-forgiveness feels genuinely difficult and understand that asking for help is an appropriate and brave response.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: coping with difficulty · Self-Awareness: recognizing when support is needed
VOCABULARY	impossible, stuck, support, brave, ask, counselor, trusted adult
MATERIALS	Support web graphic organizer · Anchor chart · Reflection Pass pre-positioned · Crisis resources posted visibly

SAFETY CHECK — COMPLETE BEFORE DELIVERING

Counselor confirmed ON-SITE or immediately available — full lesson. · Lesson NOT scheduled before a school break. · Lesson NOT scheduled with a substitute. · Reflection Pass pre-positioned. · 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline posted. · Crisis Text Line (HOME to 741741) posted. · AFSP Safe Messaging Guidelines applied: do NOT use “committed suicide” — use “died by suicide.” Do NOT describe methods or means.

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

“Over the past five lessons we’ve learned the tools. Today we face something honest: sometimes those tools are not enough. Not because you failed — because some things are too big to carry alone.”

1

Normalize the Difficulty

2-10 MIN

Some things are genuinely hard to forgive ourselves for. This curriculum is not asking you to feel fine. It is asking you not to be destroyed. When the practice is not enough: asking for help is wisdom, not weakness.

2

The Support Web Activity

10-20 MIN

Students map who they can talk to: school counselor / trusted teacher / parent / older sibling / mentor / coach. “What makes each person safe?” Teacher circulates to note students with very sparse webs.

3

One Sentence to Start

20-28 MIN

Write large: “I have been really hard on myself about something and I cannot seem to let it go. Can I talk to you?” Read together twice. “This is the sentence. You do not need a longer explanation.” Students copy into their journal.

4

Anchor Chart

28–33 MIN

Build together: (1) Talk to someone you trust. (2) Keep putting it down even if it keeps coming back. (3) The work you have done matters — even when it doesn't feel like it does.

5

Closing

33–38 MIN

"Asking for support is the bravest thing in this curriculum. Full stop." Do not collect written work.

IN-LESSON SCAN

As students copy the sentence into their journals: any student who stares at the page but does not write, or who writes and then closes the journal quickly, may be experiencing something they cannot yet name. Stay present. The closing of this lesson is not the end of the work.

IN-LESSON SCAN

HEIGHTENED SCAN — Highest-risk lesson in Unit 2. During the support web activity: watch every student. A student who cannot name a single trusted adult on their web is in significant isolation. Brief your counselor immediately — do not wait until after class. Flat affect, sudden crying, or any disclosure requires immediate counselor contact.

GRADE 3**GRADES 4 — 5****SCENARIO CARD 2-K · WHEN SELF-FORGIVENESS FEELS IMPOSSIBLE**

THE SITUATION Amara has never told anyone about the time she witnessed her best friend being bullied and did nothing. She walked away. Her friend moved schools. Amara has carried this for two years.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS Is Amara's situation one where the classroom exercises alone are enough? Who could be on Amara's support web? When to Ask for Help: The harm was significant · The person is no longer reachable · The weight has been carried too long. Asking for help is wisdom — not weakness.

SCENARIO CARD 2-L · WHEN SELF-FORGIVENESS FEELS IMPOSSIBLE

THE SITUATION Marcus lied to his parents two years ago about an incident with his little sister. She is fine — but Marcus still lies awake thinking about the lie. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Why might Marcus feel this is "too small" to bring to an adult and "too big" to process alone? What repair is still incomplete?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: Name one person on your support web you could go to if something felt too hard to carry alone. Write what you would say to them. Private. **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students had very few people on their support web? A student with no named trusted adults may be in significant isolation. Brief your counselor the same day.

Unit 2 Reflection & Bridge to Unit 3

DURATION	40–45 min · Week 7
OBJECTIVE	Students consolidate Unit 2 learning, write a letter to their future self, and articulate what they are carrying into Unit 3.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · Social Awareness (synthesis)
VOCABULARY	review, bridge, ready, carry forward
MATERIALS	Journals · All Unit 2 work · Letter paper · Envelopes · Heavy backpack prop

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Bring out the backpack from L1. “How heavy is it now compared to the beginning of Unit 2? What did you put down? What is still in there?” “You did seven weeks of real work. Today we close it — and we send something forward to May.”

1

Unit 2 Synthesis — Journal

2–10 MIN

Journal for 8 minutes: What was the most important lesson? What was the hardest? What is different about how I talk to myself now versus seven weeks ago?

2

Letter to Future Self

10–25 MIN

▲ **CRITICAL:** Collect every envelope. Label with student names. Store in a clearly labeled, secure location. These are returned and opened at Unit 4, Lesson 7. Do NOT lose these.

3

Seal the Letters — Collect and Store

25–32 MIN

Students seal their envelopes. Read aloud together: “Do Not Open Until May.” Teacher collects every envelope and stores securely.

4

Bridge to Unit 3

32–40 MIN

“In Unit 2 we practiced being kind to ourselves after mistakes. In Unit 3 we turn that same compassion outward — toward people who have hurt us. Unit 2 gave you the floor. Unit 3 gives you the door.”

IN-LESSON SCAN

As students seal their letters: any student who appears moved or tearful is responding authentically. Any student who seems unable to write anything — or who writes and then destroys the letter — may be struggling to imagine a future self worth writing to. Note for counselor consideration.

UNIT 2 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the Unit 2 synthesis journal: watch for students who write very little or who seem disengaged — a student who has emotionally checked out may be protecting themselves from the weight of Unit 2's content. Do not press. Note for Unit 3 watch list.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

EXIT TICKET

Journal: "The most important thing I am taking from Unit 2 into Unit 3 is ____." **TEACHER REFLECTION**
Compare what you know about these students now to who they were in September. Has the inner critic gotten quieter?

BRIDGE PROTOCOL · ENTERING UNIT 3

STEP 1 · SURFACE ANCHOR Sealed future-self letters (stored from U2 L7). **STEP 2 · NAME WHAT WAS BUILT** Students practiced genuine accountability, wrote self-compassion letters, engaged in symbolic release, and learned that asking for support when self-forgiveness feels impossible is wisdom. **STEP 3 · GRADE 3 PROMPT** "In Unit 2 we practiced putting our heavy things down — things we did. Today we start with the heavy things OTHER people put in your backpack. Your hurt is real." **STEP 3 · GRADES 4-5 PROMPT** "At the end of Unit 2 you wrote a letter to your future self. Now: Is there someone who hurt you that you've been carrying? Not a mistake you made — something they did. That is where we start today." **STEP 4 · STATE CONNECTION** "In Unit 2 we practiced being kind to ourselves after mistakes. In Unit 3 we turn that same compassion outward. Unit 2 gave you the floor. Unit 3 gives you the door."

UNIT 3

Empathy & Forgiving Others

“How do I deal with the hurt others cause without letting it change my character or ruin my peace?”

DURATION	January – March · 7 Lessons + 1 Strand · 35–40 min each
CASEL PRIMARY	Social Awareness: empathy, perspective-taking, narrative identity
CASEL SECONDARY	Relationship Skills: communicating about hurt; distinguishing forgiveness from trust
MENTOR TEXTS	Each Kindness (Woodson) · Wonder (Palacio) · The Invisible String (Karst)

STANDING SAFETY NOTE: This unit never asks students to forgive anyone who is currently harming them. If a student's responses suggest an ongoing harmful situation, pause the lesson and follow the Disclosure Protocol immediately.

Your Hurt Is Real and It Matters

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 1
OBJECTIVE	Students feel genuinely validated in their hurt and articulate that pain caused by others is real — before any discussion of forgiveness.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness: recognizing and naming emotional pain · Social Awareness: understanding impact on self
VOCABULARY	hurt, valid, acknowledge, pain, deserve
MATERIALS	Journals · Anchor chart · Drawing supplies · Body outline (exit ticket)

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"Today we apply that same principle to a harder situation: being hurt by someone else. Before we talk about forgiveness — we start with the hurt itself. Because your hurt is real. And it matters. Full stop."

1

First Message

2–10 MIN

Build the anchor chart: What kinds of hurt happen between people? Teasing · Exclusion · Broken trust · Unkind words · Betrayal · Being left out.

2

Journal (Private)

10–20 MIN

Students write about a hurt they have experienced. What happened? How did it feel in your body? What did you want the other person to know? Drawing fully valid. Private.

3

The Validation Circle

20–28 MIN

Ask students to put one hand on their journal. Say slowly and sincerely: "Whatever you wrote in there — that hurt is real. It was not nothing. You are not making it up." 20–30 seconds of silence. Do not move on immediately. This moment IS the lesson. Stay in it.

4

Bridge to the Unit

28–36 MIN

"We are not going to talk about forgiveness today. We are just going to let the hurt be real. Forgiveness will come — but not before we acknowledge that something happened that should not have."

UNIT 3 · LESSON 1 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the validation circle: hold complete silence for the full 20–30 seconds after the validation statement. Watch student faces. A student who cries or goes very still at being told their hurt is real may be receiving something they have rarely or never heard. Do not rush this. This moment IS the lesson.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the private journal: this is one of the highest-disclosure moments in Unit 3. Circulate quietly with your eyes open — not to read content, but to watch affect. A student who becomes visibly distressed, begins crying, or whose writing pace suddenly accelerates may be connecting to something significant.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 3-A · YOUR HURT IS REAL AND IT MATTERS

THE SITUATION Every day at lunch, a group deliberately moves their chairs so Priya has to squeeze in awkwardly. When Priya mentioned it to her mom, her mom said, “They’re probably not doing it on purpose. Just ignore it.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What kind of hurt is Priya experiencing? What did she need from her mom that she did not receive? Before Forgiveness: This lesson does not ask students to forgive yet. The one job right now: let the hurt be real. Nothing more.

SCENARIO CARD 3-B · YOUR HURT IS REAL AND IT MATTERS

THE SITUATION Two years ago, Marcus’s best friend Jake stopped inviting him to things — no fight, no explanation. His dad says, “You’re over it — you’ve got tons of friends.” But Marcus is not fully over it. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Can you be “mostly over something” AND still carry a real hurt? What does Marcus need acknowledged before he can genuinely let it go?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: Draw or write: What does hurt feel like in your body? Where do you carry it? **TEACHER**

REFLECTION Which students seemed to carry particularly significant hurts into this lesson? Do not rush into forgiveness with students still in active pain.

Why People Hurt People

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 2
OBJECTIVE	Students identify at least two reasons people cause hurt to others and explain how understanding reasons does not excuse harm but can reduce the weight of it.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness: perspective-taking and empathy · Responsible Decision-Making: evaluating behavior in context
VOCABULARY	perspective, intent, impact, empathy, reason, excuse
MATERIALS	Journals · Scenario cards · Anchor chart

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"Last lesson we said: your hurt is real. Today we take one step back — not to excuse the hurt, but to understand it." Can understanding why someone hurt you be the same as excusing them? [No — that is today's key distinction.]

1

Why People Hurt

2–10 MIN

People cause hurt for reasons: they are hurting themselves / they want power and don't know another way / they feel embarrassed or defensive / they were taught this is how people treat each other / they did not understand the impact. "None of these is an excuse. But all of them are explanations."

2

Intent vs. Impact

10–18 MIN

Intent is what the person meant to do. Impact is what happened to you. A person can cause significant hurt without intending to — and the hurt is still real. "If someone bumps into you by accident, their intent was not to hurt you — but you still fell."

3

Scenario Card Practice — Pairs

18–30 MIN

What might the person who caused harm have been feeling? Does understanding that change how you feel about what happened?

4

Journal

30–37 MIN

Think of a time you were hurt. What might the other person have been going through? "People are rarely mean because you deserved it. They are usually mean because of something going on in them."

UNIT 3 · LESSON 2 · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the journal: any student whose writing pace accelerates dramatically, or who writes and then abruptly stops and covers the page, may have connected to a hurt that goes beyond what this lesson was designed to hold. Watch the body language after writing. Note for individual follow-up.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the direct instruction on why people hurt: a student who becomes visibly angry or who says “I don’t care why they did it” is not resistant — they may be processing a real hurt that is still raw. Receive this honestly. Do not push toward understanding before the hurt has been validated.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 3-C · WHY PEOPLE HURT PEOPLE

THE SITUATION During a presentation, Tyler made a joke at Samira’s expense. When she told her older sister: “He probably likes you.” That made Samira feel worse. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Was the explanation helpful? What is the difference between explaining why someone caused hurt and dismissing the hurt itself? Intent vs. Impact: Tyler may not have intended deep harm. That does not make the impact less real.

SCENARIO CARD 3-D · WHY PEOPLE HURT PEOPLE

THE SITUATION After being excluded from a group project, Chloe’s teacher explains that one girl has a difficult home situation. Chloe says: “So I have to accept being treated badly because her home life is hard? That doesn’t seem fair.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is Chloe right? How would you explain that understanding is for her benefit, not permission for the other person?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: “When someone hurts me, understanding why they did it makes me feel ____.” **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students struggled most with the concept that understanding does not equal excusing? Some students have experienced significant harm.

Repair That Actually Works

DURATION	40–45 min · Unit 3 Week 3 (after Lesson 2, before Lesson 3 ★★)
OBJECTIVE	Students practice a five-step structured repair protocol — both sides of a repair conversation — and articulate the specific conditions under which repair becomes possible after hurt.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills: repair after rupture · Self-Management: regulating before repair · Social Awareness: impact acknowledgment · Responsible Decision-Making: re-entry terms
NEW ANCHOR CHART	The Repair Protocol (REP-1) — five-step sequence. Post before class begins.
WORKSHEET	WS-R3: My Repair Plan — private, scenario-based practice worksheet completed in class.
VOCABULARY	repair, rupture, re-entry, acknowledge, impact, terms, regulate, conditions

SAFETY NOTE — ELEVATED AWARENESS

Brief your school counselor before delivering this lesson. The scenario-card practice uses fictional characters only — students do not practice repair conversations about personal situations. However, students who are currently in an unresolved rupture with a peer may find the scenario work activating. The re-entry terms discussion (Step 4) occasionally surfaces awareness of unsafe relationships. This connects directly to Unit 3 L3's standing safety statement: forgiveness is never required when someone is still harming you.

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Point to the Recovery Arc (ARC-1) and the Window of Tolerance (WOT-1). "We said that repair belongs in Phase 4 — after you have regulated, after you have reflected honestly. Today we are going to look at what repair actually involves. Not just the apology. The whole conversation. Most failed repairs are not failed because the person didn't care — they're failed because the conversation was missing something." "Has anyone ever received an apology that didn't feel like a real apology? Without naming names — what was missing from it?"

ANCHOR CHART · THE REPAIR PROTOCOL · REP-1

Post this chart before students arrive alongside the Recovery Arc (ARC-1) and Window of Tolerance (WOT-1). The three charts form the complete Regulation & Repair visual system.

1 BOTH PEOPLE REGULATE FIRST** Each person checks their Window independently. Neither begins until both are inside or close to it. If one person is still in Phase 1 — wait.

"I NEED A FEW MINUTES BEFORE WE TALK ABOUT THIS. CAN WE DO IT AT LUNCH?"

2 ONE PERSON SPEAKS** The person who caused harm speaks first: specific action, honest tone. The person who was hurt listens without preparing their response. Then they switch.

"I TOLD YOUR SECRET. THAT WAS WRONG. I WANT TO HEAR WHAT THAT DID TO YOU."

3 IMPACT ACKNOWLEDGED** The person who caused harm names the actual impact — not a summary or deflection. "I understand you felt bad" is not enough.

"I KNOW THAT BROKE YOUR TRUST. AND I KNOW IT EMBARRASSED YOU IN FRONT OF PEOPLE YOU CARE ABOUT."

4 REPAIR ACTION NAMED** What specifically will change? What will the person who caused harm do differently? This is not a promise of feeling — it is a commitment of action.

"NEXT TIME I AM TEMPTED TO SHARE SOMETHING THAT ISN'T MINE TO SHARE — I WON'T. AND IF YOU TELL ME SOMETHING, I WILL ASK FIRST."

5 RE-ENTRY AGREED** What does the relationship look like going forward? This is not always returning to what it was — that depends on trust. Both people state explicitly what re-entry looks like.

"I'M NOT READY TO BE AS CLOSE AS BEFORE. BUT I'M WILLING TO TRY AGAIN SLOWLY. CAN WE START WITH JUST BEING OKAY IN CLASS?"

CRITICAL CONNECTION — STATED BEFORE ANY SCENARIO PRACTICE

"This repair protocol is designed for relationships where repair is appropriate and safe to attempt. It is not a framework for unsafe relationships — situations where someone is still causing harm. In those situations, the priority is safety, not repair. We will talk more about this in Lesson 3 of Unit 3. But I want to name it now: no part of today's lesson requires you to repair a relationship with someone who is still hurting you."

1 Chart Walk-Through

0–5 MIN

Walk the five steps using a personal low-stakes example. After each step: "What would make this step fail?" Students generate the failure modes.

2 The Failed Apology List

5–8 MIN

Return to the list from the opening — what students said was missing from a real apology they received. Map each item to one of the five steps. Which step was absent?

3 The Re-Entry Distinction

8–13 MIN

Step 5 (Re-entry Agreed) requires dedicated time because it is the most commonly omitted step. Repair does not mean restoration. The relationship going forward — that is a separate conversation. The key is that re-entry is not assumed. It is agreed.

4

Bilateral Pair Practice

13–25 MIN

Round 1: Partner A speaks as the person who caused harm, Partner B as the person hurt. Work through all five steps together — out loud. Round 2: switch roles. The protocol is on the board. Use it.

5

Private Application — WS-R3

25–33 MIN

Distribute WS-R3. Students apply the five-step protocol to a scenario of their own choosing. The personal application section is always private.

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE — During pair practice, a student who shifts from speaking as the character to speaking in first person — using 'I' and referring to real people or events. **MAY MEAN** — The scenario has triggered a real unresolved rupture. The student has stepped out of the fictional frame into their own experience. **ACTION** — Do not interrupt the pair work publicly. After the round ends: quietly approach. “It sounded like that connected to something real for you. The worksheet at the end has a private section.” If the content suggests an ongoing unsafe relationship, follow the disclosure protocol.

SCENARIO CARD R3-A · PRIYA & LAYLA — THE SECRET SHARED

THE SITUATION Last week, Layla told Priya something private about her family. Two days later, Layla found out three other people knew — Priya had mentioned it in a group chat. Layla is hurt and has barely spoken to Priya since. Both girls want to repair the friendship but neither knows how to start. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Which step of the protocol needs to happen before Priya says anything at all? How would you know both girls are ready? Help Priya write what Step 2 sounds like — specifically. Not 'I'm sorry I told your secret' but the fuller version. What does Step 3 (Impact Acknowledged) require Priya to name specifically? Draft what Step 5 (Re-entry) could sound like for this friendship.

SCENARIO CARD R3-B · MARCUS & DARIUS — THE BENCH INCIDENT

THE SITUATION During a basketball game, Marcus made a joke about Darius's playing in front of the whole team. Everyone laughed. But Darius didn't laugh. Marcus is confused: “I was just joking. He knows I didn't mean it like that.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Marcus says 'I didn't mean it like that.' Using the impact vs. intent distinction: does Marcus's intent change what repair requires? What is the specific failure risk for Marcus at Step 3 (Impact Acknowledged)? Help Marcus write what a genuine Step 3 acknowledgment sounds like — one that names what actually happened to Darius without hiding behind intent.

SCENARIO CARD R3-C · THE RE-ENTRY PROBLEM · OPTIONAL, GRADES 4–5

THE SITUATION Jordan and Sam had a falling-out. Jordan apologized — a real, specific apology. Sam accepted. But Sam has been noticeably more guarded since. Jordan is frustrated: “I apologized. Why isn't it back to normal?” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Has this repair protocol been completed? Which step did Jordan complete — and which step was assumed rather than explicitly agreed? What is the difference between repair being complete and trust being restored? What does an honest Step 5 conversation between Jordan and Sam look like now?

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

EXIT TICKET

Journal: Index card (not collected): “The five steps of repair in order are: _____. The step most likely to be skipped is _____ because _____. The most important thing I learned today is _____.” **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students produced genuinely specific impact acknowledgments versus students who defaulted to summary language? Specificity in Step 3 is the strongest indicator of real empathy development. Which students appeared activated during the practice — suggesting a real unresolved rupture is present? Note for counselor awareness before Unit 3 L3.

WORKSHEET · WS-R3

My Repair Plan

Unit 3 Strand Lesson

Architecture of Grace · Grades 3-5 · Reproducible for classroom use · School of Life Foundation

PRIVACY NOTE

This worksheet is private. Your teacher will not collect or read it. The personal application section is yours alone. You can stay with the scenario characters throughout if you prefer.

PART 1 · SCENARIO PRACTICE · CHOOSE CARD R3-A OR R3-B

Work through each step of the Repair Protocol below as if you were the person who caused the harm. Be specific.

STEP 1 · BOTH PEOPLE REGULATE FIRST

How do you know this person is ready for the conversation? What signals tell you they are in their Window? What would you say to check in before starting?

STEP 2 · ONE PERSON SPEAKS — THE OTHER LISTENS

Write exactly what the person who caused harm says — specific, honest, not defensive.

STEP 3 · IMPACT ACKNOWLEDGED

What specifically happened to the person who was hurt — not their feeling, but the actual consequence? Write what acknowledging the impact sounds like.

STEP 4 · REPAIR ACTION NAMED

What specifically will change going forward? Not a feeling — an action.

STEP 5 · RE-ENTRY AGREED

What does the relationship look like going forward? Is it the same as before — or different?

UNIT 3 · LESSON STRAND · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

PART 2 · PERSONAL APPLICATION · PRIVATE

Think of a real rupture in your own life. Is repair appropriate for this situation — or is this a situation involving ongoing harm where safety comes first?

☐ Repair is appropriate — I can use the protocol ☐ Safety first — this is not the right framework here

If repair is appropriate: which step of the protocol feels hardest for this specific situation?

What would an honest Step 5 (re-entry) look like for this relationship — not what you wish, but what would be real and true?

Forgiveness Is Not the Same as Trust ★★

HIGHEST RISK

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 3
OBJECTIVE	Students clearly distinguish between forgiveness (internal, releases resentment) and trust (earned, relational) — and understand they can forgive without reconciling.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: emotional regulation and boundary-setting · Relationship Skills: distinguishing healthy from unsafe relationships
VOCABULARY	forgiveness, trust, reconciliation, boundary, safety, internal
MATERIALS	WS6 Two Separate Decisions · Two-column anchor chart · Scenario cards · Journals · Reflection Pass pre-positioned

SAFETY CHECK — COMPLETE BEFORE DELIVERING

Counselor confirmed ON-SITE or immediately available — full lesson. · Lesson NOT scheduled before a school break. · Lesson NOT scheduled with a substitute. · Reflection Pass pre-positioned. · 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline posted. · Crisis Text Line (HOME to 741741) posted. · AFSP Safe Messaging Guidelines reviewed. MOST LIKELY LESSON TO SURFACE DISCLOSURES ABOUT ONGOING UNSAFE RELATIONSHIPS. Before this lesson: teacher and counselor identify 1–2 students they are watching. Deliver the safety statement BEFORE any content.

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"Today we go one step further. Has anyone ever been told they had to forgive someone AND be friends with them again — when they did not feel safe?" Today we separate forgiveness and trust.

I

Safety Statement — Deliver First

2–5 MIN

Say directly and calmly: "Before we start: in this curriculum, forgiveness is never required when someone is still hurting you. If anything we talk about today makes you think of a situation where you are still being harmed, you can use your Reflection Pass. Your safety is more important than any lesson." Pause. Then proceed.

ANCHOR CHART · FORGIVENESS VS. TRUST — TWO SEPARATE DECISIONS (WS6)

Build WITH students through co-construction — do not present it pre-made. Color-code. This chart is the lesson. Keep it posted for the rest of Unit 3.

2

Build the Two-Column Anchor Chart + WS6

5–14 MIN

FORGIVENESS: internal / for your own peace / can happen alone / requires nothing from the other person.
TRUST: relational / requires demonstrated change / requires safety / never obligatory. Build slowly with student input.

3

Direct Instruction

14–22 MIN

Forgiveness is a gift you give yourself — for your own peace. Trust is earned through demonstrated behavioral change over time. It is never obligatory. Even after genuine forgiveness, trust must be rebuilt — not restored on demand.

4

Scenario Card Practice

22–30 MIN

Can forgiveness happen here? Should trust be extended? What would trust require? Complete the two-column analysis on WS6.

5

The Boundary Statement

30–37 MIN

WS6 Part 2: “I am choosing not to carry resentment. I am also not in a place to be close to this person right now, and that is okay.” This is one of the most important things they will write all year.

IN-LESSON SCAN

HEIGHTENED SCAN — Most likely lesson to surface disclosures about ongoing unsafe relationships. Deliver the safety statement and then pause — watch the room. Any student who uses their Reflection Pass, who looks at you with a particular expression, or whose body language shifts significantly after the safety statement may be signaling something real. Do not proceed past that student without a quiet, private check-in.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the boundary statement writing: students who write quickly and with visible relief may have been waiting for permission to hold this boundary. Students who cannot complete the sentence may be in an active situation where the boundary feels impossible or unsafe to draw. Watch for both. The second student needs immediate counselor involvement.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 3-E · FORGIVENESS IS NOT THE SAME AS TRUST

THE SITUATION After Jordan told Leila's secret, she apologized sincerely. Leila says: “I can try to forgive Jordan. But I'm not going to tell her secrets anymore.” Jordan says if Leila was really forgiving her, she would trust her again. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is Leila's position reasonable? What does Jordan misunderstand about what forgiveness requires? Two-Column: **FORGIVENESS** — internal, for your own peace, requires nothing from Jordan. **TRUST** — relational, must be rebuilt through demonstrated change, never obligatory.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 3 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

SCENARIO CARD 3-F · FORGIVENESS IS NOT THE SAME AS TRUST

THE SITUATION Nico was bullied throughout third grade. His counselor encourages forgiveness for his own peace. But his aunt keeps saying: “You have to forgive AND forget.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is “forgive and forget” good advice? Write the boundary statement Nico might say — honoring his forgiveness work AND his right to keep himself protected.

EXIT TICKET

Journal: In your own words: What is the difference between forgiveness and trust? Why does it matter?

TEACHER REFLECTION Are any students being pressured to reconcile with someone who has not changed and may not be safe? Brief your counselor same day with any observations.

ANCHOR CHART · FORGIVENESS VS. TRUST — TWO SEPARATE DECISIONS

Print this page · Post in classroom at the moment indicated · Keep posted for the remainder of the year

FORGIVENESS

TRUST

You can FORGIVE someone and still choose not to be close to them. Forgiveness is for your peace. Trust is earned — never obligatory. **FORGIVENESS IS NEVER REQUIRED WHEN SOMEONE IS STILL HARMING YOU.**

WORKSHEET · WS6

Two Separate Decisions: Forgiveness vs. Trust

Unit 3, Lesson 3

Architecture of Grace · Grades 3–5 · Reproducible for classroom use · School of Life Foundation

FORGIVENESS

TRUST

PART 1 · SCENARIO ANALYSIS

SCENARIO A: YOUR CLASSMATE BORROWED YOUR PENCIL CASE WITHOUT ASKING AND LOST IT. SHE APOLOGIZED AND REPLACED IT.

WORKING TOWARD FORGIVENESS? WHY?

EXTENDING TRUST? WHAT WOULD IT TAKE?

SCENARIO B: A FRIEND BROKE YOUR CONFIDENCE AND TOLD YOUR SECRET. SHE APOLOGIZED ONCE BUT CONTINUES SHARING OTHER PEOPLE'S THINGS.

WORKING TOWARD FORGIVENESS? WHY?

EXTENDING TRUST? WHAT WOULD IT TAKE?

SCENARIO C: A CLASSMATE TEASED YOU IN THIRD GRADE. YOU ARE NOW IN FIFTH GRADE AND THEY ARE KINDER. YOU STILL FEEL GUARDED.

WORKING TOWARD FORGIVENESS? WHY?

EXTENDING TRUST? WHAT WOULD IT TAKE?

PART 2 · YOUR BOUNDARY STATEMENT · PRIVATE

"I am choosing not to carry resentment toward _____. I am also not in a place to be close to this person right now, and that is okay. Both of these things can be true at the same time."

Reflection: Why does it matter that forgiveness and trust are two separate things?

Forgiveness Takes Time

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 4
OBJECTIVE	Students understand the non-linear nature of the forgiveness process and practice self-compassion for not being further along than they are.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness: understanding the forgiveness process · Self-Management: patience with self
VOCABULARY	process, non-linear, setback, patience, steps, path
MATERIALS	Forgiveness process chart (posted large) · Sticky dot stickers · Journals

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"Last lesson we learned forgiveness and trust are not the same thing. Today: forgiveness doesn't happen all at once. Has anyone ever decided to forgive someone — and then found the hurt coming back? That is not failure. Forgiveness is a process."

ANCHOR CHART · THE FORGIVENESS PATH — NON-LINEAR (ANONYMOUS STICKY DOT PLACEMENT)

Post this chart large before the lesson. After direct instruction, give each student a sticky dot — they place it where they are on the path. Anonymous. After placement: "Is that okay?" The answer is always yes.

1

The Forgiveness Process Chart

2–10 MIN

Draw a squiggly — non-linear — path. Name the stations: Still hurting / Beginning to understand / Some days are better / Choosing to put it down today / The hurt is getting smaller / I am okay. "The path is not a straight line. Setbacks are not failure."

2

Anonymous Sticky Dot Placement

10–18 MIN

Students receive a sticky dot and place it where they are — anonymously. "Is that okay?" Some dots are near the beginning. "Every dot represents someone doing the work."

3

The Setback Is Normal

18–27 MIN

"Some days you will feel like you have forgiven something. Then it comes back. That is not failure. You put it down again." Connect to U2 L5: "Remember the stone practice? The same is true for forgiving others."

4

Connect to Self-Compassion

27–35 MIN

"You are not required to be further along the path than you are." Journal: Where are you on the forgiveness path for something specific?

IN-LESSON SCAN

After dot placement: note where most dots land as a class pattern. A class where the majority of dots are at Station 1 — still hurting — needs more validation before any further forgiveness practice. Do not pressure students toward resolution.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the journal: watch for a student who places their dot at Station 5 or 6 but whose journal writing suggests they are still at Station 1. Some students perform resolution they have not yet reached.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 3-G · FORGIVENESS TAKES TIME

THE SITUATION Three months ago, Mia decided to forgive her friend for spreading a rumor. She meant it. But last week she felt a sudden flash of anger as real as the day it happened. "I thought I was done. I guess I'm not a forgiving person after all." **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is Mia right? What does the return of anger actually mean? Forgiveness Path Stations: Still hurting · Beginning to understand · Some days are better · Choosing to put it down today · The hurt is getting smaller · I am okay. Moving backward is not failure.

SCENARIO CARD 3-H · FORGIVENESS TAKES TIME

THE SITUATION Ben's best friend moved away without saying goodbye. Eight months later: "I know he probably had no choice. But I'm still angry. I feel bad for being angry." **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is Ben wrong to still feel angry eight months later? How would you use the self-compassion from Unit 2 to respond to Ben's guilt?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: "Forgiveness takes time because _____. When the hurt comes back, I can _____." **TEACHER**

REFLECTION Where did most students place their dots? Were there students at "still hurting" for something significant?

ANCHOR CHART · THE FORGIVENESS PATH — IT IS NOT A STRAIGHT LINE

Print this page · Post in classroom at the moment indicated · Keep posted for the remainder of the year

I

STILL HURTING

THE WOUND IS RECENT OR RAW. THIS IS WHERE THE PATH BEGINS. YOUR HURT IS REAL.

2

BEGINNING TO UNDERSTAND

YOU CAN SEE WHY IT HAPPENED — EVEN IF THAT DOESN'T EXCUSE IT.

3

SOME DAYS ARE BETTER

THE HURT COMES AND GOES. YOU ARE IN THE PRACTICE.

4

CHOOSING TO PUT IT DOWN TODAY

A CONSCIOUS DECISION — NOT PERMANENT YET, BUT REAL.

5

THE HURT IS GETTING SMALLER

IT STILL EXISTS, BUT IT HAS LESS POWER. YOU NOTICE THAT.

6

I AM OKAY

YOU CAN HOLD WHAT HAPPENED WITH HONESTY — WITHOUT BEING HELD BY IT.

*MOVING BACKWARD ON THE PATH IS NOT FAILURE — IT IS THE PRACTICE.

You put it down again. Each time, you get a little better at it.*

Holding Your Story Without Being Held by It ★ ELEVATED

DURATION	40 min · Week 5
OBJECTIVE	Students engage in the three-panel narrative reclaim activity and articulate that they are the authors of what their story means.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness: narrative identity and agency · Self-Management: reclaiming authorship
VOCABULARY	narrative, story, author, panel, meaning, choose, reclaim
MATERIALS	Journals · WS7 Three-Panel Story · Drawing supplies

SAFETY CHECK — COMPLETE BEFORE DELIVERING

Counselor notified — minimum 1 week in advance. · Counselor reachable on the day. · Lesson NOT scheduled before a school break. · Reflection Pass pre-positioned. Panel 1 is ALWAYS private — teacher does not collect or retain Panel 1 without explicit student permission. Students with significant loss or migration narratives may find this lesson particularly activating.

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"You did not choose what happened to you. But you get to choose what it means. That is what it means to be the author of your story."

ANCHOR CHART · MY THREE-PANEL STORY — NARRATIVE IDENTITY (WS7)

Show this BEFORE distributing WS7. Walk through the three panels: Panel 1 = what happened (private). Panel 2 = the story I told myself. Panel 3 = the story I am CHOOSING. Model your own example first.

1

Introduce the Three-Panel Structure

2–13 MIN

Panel 1: Something that happened to me — a real hurt. Private. Panel 2: The story I told myself about it. Panel 3: The story I CHOOSE instead — not denying Panel 1, but choosing what meaning I give it going forward.

2

Three-Panel Book — WS7 (Protected Time)

13–32 MIN

Panel 1 — PRIVATE — teacher does not collect. Panel 2: The story I told myself. Panel 3: The story I am CHOOSING. Protect this time. Silence is appropriate. Drawing valid for all three panels.

3

Debrief — Concept Level Only

32-38 MIN

"Does choosing a different story mean pretending nothing happened?" [No — Panel 1 stays true.] "Does it mean forgiving the person?" [Not necessarily.]

IN-LESSON SCAN

Panel 1 carries the highest disclosure risk in this lesson. Circulate quietly and watch body language — not content. A student who writes for a very long time or who appears distressed may be processing something significant. If you see content that raises a mandatory reporting concern, speak with the student privately after class.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the debrief: a student who answers "yes — Panel 3 IS pretending" may be protecting themselves from false resolution. This is a sophisticated and honest response. Affirm it specifically: "You're right that Panel 3 doesn't erase Panel 1. The question is what meaning Panel 1 gets going forward." Never pressure students toward a Panel 3 they don't genuinely hold.

GRADE 3**GRADES 4 — 5****SCENARIO CARD 3-I · HOLDING YOUR STORY WITHOUT BEING HELD BY IT**

THE SITUATION When Ava was seven, her family lost their home. She has told the story to herself as: "That was the year everything fell apart and I learned that nothing is safe." She is now cautious, guarded, and reluctant to trust. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is the story Ava tells herself accurate — or is it one interpretation? What is the story she might choose instead?

SCENARIO CARD 3-J · HOLDING YOUR STORY WITHOUT BEING HELD BY IT

THE SITUATION When Jordan's best friend group excluded him in fourth grade, he decided: "I'm clearly not the kind of person people want to be close to." He is now in fifth grade with new friends — but the Panel 2 story is still running. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What story is Jordan still telling himself? Is it true now? How would you help Jordan write Panel 3?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: "One story I am choosing to tell myself differently is _____. Because _____." **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students have the most rigid, negative narratives? Individual support may be needed for students deeply embedded in contamination narratives.

WORKSHEET · WS7

My Three-Panel Story — Narrative Reclaim

Unit 3, Lesson 5

PRIVACY NOTE

Panel 1 is ALWAYS private. Your teacher will never collect or read Panel 1.

Drawing is a valid response for all three panels. Take your time.

PANEL 1 · WHAT HAPPENED

Private — belongs to you only. Something that happened to me — a real hurt, loss, or disappointment. Draw or write.

PANEL 2 · THE STORY I TOLD MYSELF

The interpretation I gave it. What did I decide this meant about me / others / life?

PANEL 3 · THE STORY I AM CHOOSING

Not denying Panel 1. Choosing what meaning it gets going forward. What I choose to believe this means instead:

Reflection: One story I am choosing to tell differently is ____ . Because ____ .

Stories of Forgiveness in Practice + Say It Straight

DURATION	40 min · Week 6
OBJECTIVE	Students analyze forgiveness through a literary example and practice a structured framework for communicating about hurt.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness · Relationship Skills: communicating about hurt; structured dialogue
VOCABULARY	story, character, choice, courage, navigate, specific
MATERIALS	Mentor text · Scenario Cards · Anchor chart · Journals · Index cards

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

If Panel 3 was deferred: "Let's open with Panel 3 now — take 3 minutes." If Panel 3 was completed: "Today we watch someone else do it — in a story — and then we practice what to do with your voice when you've been hurt."

1

Mentor Text Read-Aloud + Discussion

2–18 MIN

"As we read, notice: How did the character experience being hurt? What did they choose? What did it cost — and what did it give?" After: connect the character's journey to unit learning.

2

Say It Straight Framework

18–25 MIN

THREE STEPS: STEP 1: Name the moment, not the person. "When [specific thing] happened, I felt ____." No "you always" or "you never." STEP 2: Say what you need. "What I need going forward is ____." STEP 3: Listen without defending. Give the other person a real turn.

3

Pair Practice — Scenario Card Dialogue

25–35 MIN

Person A (hurt) uses Say It Straight. Person B listens without defending. Switch. "Stay in Step 1 — name the moment, not the character."

4

Closing Discussion

35–38 MIN

"Can you say it straight to someone and still forgive them? Can you forgive someone without ever saying anything?" Both are true — this gives students a choice, not a mandate.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 6 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

During pair practice: any student who becomes tearful, who breaks the frame of the scenario and begins speaking from personal experience, or who refuses to switch roles may be processing a real situation. Do not press. Offer the Reflection Pass quietly.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the mentor text read-aloud: watch for students who become visibly emotional at specific moments. These moments may be resonating with personal experience. Note which part of the story triggers the strongest reaction.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 3-K · STORIES OF FORGIVENESS IN PRACTICE

THE SITUATION After reading *Each Kindness*, one student says: “Forgiveness doesn’t seem to fix what happened between them.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** The student is right: forgiveness does not fix what happened. So what does it do? *Each Kindness* explores regret and the cost of cruelty. It does not offer easy resolution — because forgiveness in real life rarely does.

SCENARIO CARD 3-L · UNIT 3 WRAP-UP — I CHOOSE

THE SITUATION At the end of a role-play, Jasmine writes: “I choose not to forgive yet. Because I am still hurting. And that is where I am on the path.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is Jasmine’s “I Choose” statement valid? Why might this be one of the most honest and healthy responses in the class? All “I Choose” Statements Are Valid If Conscious: “I choose to forgive.” ✓ “I choose to keep working at it.” ✓ “I choose not to forgive yet.” ✓

EXIT TICKET

Journal: Index card: One thing — real or hypothetical — where you might try *Say It Straight* this week.

TEACHER REFLECTION Which step was hardest for most students — naming the moment, stating the need, or listening without defending?

Unit 3 Wrap-Up — I Choose

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 7
OBJECTIVE	Students consolidate Unit 3 learning through role-play and articulate that forgiveness is a personal choice made for their own wellbeing.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills · Social Awareness (synthesis)
VOCABULARY	review, choose, agency, synthesis
MATERIALS	Scenario cards · Journals · Index cards · All Unit 3 anchor charts displayed

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Display all Unit 3 anchor charts. “Look at what we built. Seven weeks of honest, complex, brave work. Today we practice using all of it — and then we say what we choose.”

1

Role-Play Scenarios — All Unit 3 Skills

2–15 MIN

Students work through realistic hurt scenarios using all Unit 3 skills: validating the hurt / exploring why it happened / distinguishing forgiveness from trust / locating on the forgiveness path / reclaiming the narrative.

2

Debrief

15–22 MIN

What felt easy? What felt hard? What Unit 3 skill do you feel most ready to use?

3

The I Choose Statements

22–30 MIN

Each student writes: “I choose to _____. Because _____.” All conscious choices are valid — including choosing not to forgive yet. Collect for reference.

4

Bridge to Unit 4

30–37 MIN

“In Unit 3 we learned to deal with the hurt others cause without letting it change our character. In Unit 4 we practice the other direction: giving grace. Unit 3 cleared the ground. Unit 4 plants something in it.”

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the I Choose statements: a student who writes “I choose not to forgive yet” is being honest and healthy — affirm this. A student who writes nothing, or who writes and then crosses everything out, may be in a situation where no choice feels available. This is significant.

UNIT 3 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the role-play scenarios: watch for students who become emotionally activated — moving from role-play language to first-person language. A student who says “I” instead of “the character” may have shifted from the scenario into their own experience.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

EXIT TICKET

Journal: “One thing I am carrying from Unit 3 into Unit 4 is ____.” **TEACHER REFLECTION** How has the class changed across Units 2 and 3? Are students using the vocabulary with each other in unstructured time?

BRIDGE PROTOCOL · ENTERING UNIT 4

STEP 1 · SURFACE ANCHOR I Choose index cards from U3 L7. **STEP 2 · NAME WHAT WAS BUILT** Students learned that hurt is real and deserves acknowledgment, explored why people cause harm, distinguished forgiveness from trust, practiced the non-linear forgiveness process, and reclaimed authorship through the Three-Panel Book. **STEP 3 · GRADE 3 PROMPT** “You made your I Choose statements. Today we ask a bigger question: I choose to give something to someone — not because they earned it. Does anyone have a word for that? That’s grace. And that’s Unit 4.” **STEP 3 · GRADES 4–5 PROMPT** “Look at your I Choose card. Now: Is there someone in your life you could give something to — not because they earned it, but because YOU decided to be the kind of person who does that? That’s the Grace Gap.” **STEP 4 · STATE CONNECTION** “In Unit 3 we learned to deal with the hurt others cause. In Unit 4 we practice the other direction: giving grace. Unit 3 cleared the ground. Unit 4 plants something in it.”

UNIT 4

Grace & Generosity

“What does it look like to actively choose generosity — even when it is not required, and even when it is hard?”

DURATION	March – May · 7 Lessons + 1 Strand · 35–40 min each
CASEL PRIMARY	Responsible Decision-Making: applied grace, charitable interpretation
CASEL SECONDARY	Social Awareness: identifying community needs; recognizing grace in action
MENTOR TEXTS	Each Kindness (Woodson) · The Invisible String (Karst) · Wonder (Palacio) · Have You Filled a Bucket Today? (McCloud)

Unit 4 is the capstone. The Grace Gap Field Assignment in L4–L6 is the curriculum's most original pedagogical element. Do NOT debrief in L4 — it requires minimum 5 full school days before L6.

What Does Grace Look Like?

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 1
OBJECTIVE	Students define grace as giving something generous that was not earned or required — and identify at least three ways grace shows up in everyday school life.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness: recognizing generosity in action · Responsible Decision-Making: choosing grace as a practice
VOCABULARY	grace, generous, unearned, offer, extend, practice
MATERIALS	Anchor chart · Journals · Sticky notes · Display board

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"You made your I Choose statements in Unit 3. Today we ask a bigger question: I choose to give something to someone — not because they earned it." Address the religious question: "Grace is used in religious traditions — we are using it here as a psychological word about choosing generosity. Not a religious lesson."

1

Define Grace

2–10 MIN

Grace is giving something generous — kindness, patience, the benefit of the doubt, a second chance — to someone who has not necessarily earned it. A choice, not a requirement. A strength, not a weakness.

ANCHOR CHART · GRACE VS. DOORMAT — THE CRITICAL DISTINCTION

Post this alongside the grace definition BEFORE any scenario work. Return to this chart at L5.

2

Grace vs. Doormat

10–17 MIN

"Grace is not the same as letting people treat you badly. A doormat has no choice. A person extending grace has full choice — and chooses generosity deliberately. If someone keeps hurting you and you keep doing nothing — that is not grace. That is a boundary problem."

3

Sticky Note Gallery

17–26 MIN

Each student writes one act of grace they have witnessed this week. Teacher reads them: "Look how much grace is already in this room."

4

Journal

26–35 MIN

Write about a time you extended grace — something kind, patient, or generous you gave that you did not have to give. What made you choose it?

UNIT 4 · LESSON 1 · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the journal: students from communities where survival has required vigilance may find the concept of unearned generosity confusing or even threatening. Watch for flat affect or a student who writes "I never do that." Meet it with curiosity, not correction.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the sticky note gallery: a student who cannot name a single act of grace they have witnessed may be in an environment where grace is genuinely rare. This student's observation is correct data about their context.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 4-A · WHAT DOES GRACE LOOK LIKE?

THE SITUATION When Mateo transferred mid-year, he sat alone at lunch for three weeks. On the twenty-second day, Ryn moved her tray: "You can sit here." **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What makes Ryn's action an act of grace rather than just friendliness? Mateo had done nothing to earn a place in the group. Grace Defined: Grace is giving something generous to someone who has not necessarily earned it.

SCENARIO CARD 4-B · WHAT DOES GRACE LOOK LIKE?

THE SITUATION Omar said something cutting to his friend Darius during an argument. He apologized sincerely. Darius said: "I know you were angry. We are still friends." He did not make Omar grovel. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What did Darius choose to give Omar that Omar had not yet earned back?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: Name one person you could extend grace to this week — and what that grace might look like.

TEACHER REFLECTION What acts of grace did students identify? Were they surprised by how much grace is already happening?

ANCHOR CHART · GRACE VS. DOORMAT — THE CRITICAL DISTINCTION

Print this page · Post in classroom at the moment indicated · Keep posted for the remainder of the year

GRACE

DOORMAT

GRACE IS:

Giving something generous to someone who has not necessarily earned it. **A CHOICE, not a requirement. · A STRENGTH, not a weakness.**

What Does Mercy Look Like?

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 2
OBJECTIVE	Students define mercy as choosing not to deliver the full consequence someone deserves — and articulate why mercy is a form of strength.
CASEL FOCUS	Responsible Decision-Making: evaluating when mercy is appropriate · Social Awareness
VOCABULARY	mercy, consequence, deserve, restrain, strength, justice
MATERIALS	Scenario cards · Anchor chart · Journals

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"Last lesson we defined grace. Today: mercy. Mercy is when you could give someone a consequence — and you choose not to." If you could embarrass someone who embarrassed you — and you don't. Is that weakness or strength?

1

Define Mercy

2–10 MIN

Mercy is choosing not to deliver the full consequence someone might deserve. It requires power. "A weak person cannot show mercy — only a strong person can choose not to use their strength."

2

Equity Context — Deliver With Care

10–20 MIN

Directly acknowledge: Not everyone gets the same amount of mercy in the real world. Certain students and communities have experienced systematic application of full consequences without mercy. That is unjust. "In this lesson we are talking about the mercy WE can choose to give."

3

Scenario Card Practice

20–30 MIN

What could this person do? What would mercy look like instead? Is this mercy appropriate — or is it enabling harm?

4

Journal

30–37 MIN

Write about a time someone showed you mercy. How did it feel? Did it change how you behaved going forward?

UNIT 4 · LESSON 2 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the journal: a student who cannot recall a single instance of being shown mercy may have experienced a pattern of full consequences without grace. Note for counselor consideration. Do not press for a positive memory if none exists.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the equity context delivery: watch for students who become visibly angry. Students who have experienced systematic application of full consequences without mercy are responding correctly. Receive it honestly.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 4-C · WHAT DOES MERCY LOOK LIKE?

THE SITUATION After Priya was caught passing an unkind note, the substitute teacher paused: “I am not going to make this a bigger deal than it is. But think about how it would feel to read your name in someone’s note.” No referral. No call home. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What consequence did the sub have the power to deliver — and what did she choose instead? Why might mercy have been more effective than a referral?

SCENARIO CARD 4-D · WHAT DOES MERCY LOOK LIKE?

THE SITUATION Zach left his lab cleanup early. His partner Imani stayed and cleaned alone. When the teacher asked, Imani said “We got it done.” Zach said, “You covered for me. I owe you.” She said, “Just don’t leave me with it again.” **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What did Imani choose not to do? How is what Imani did different from repeatedly covering for someone?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: “Mercy is _____. It is a strength because _____. A time someone showed me mercy was _____.” **TEACHER REFLECTION** Did students seem comfortable or uncomfortable with the equity context?

Boundaries from Strength

DURATION	40–45 min · Unit 4 Week 3 (after Lesson 2, before Lesson 3)
OBJECTIVE	Students distinguish limits set from strength (self-respect) from limits set from fear (retaliation or compliance), practice the three-part limit formula, and apply it to three scenarios.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: limit-setting as a regulation tool · Relationship Skills · Responsible Decision-Making
NEW ANCHOR CHART	Boundaries From Strength (BFS-1) — the limit formula and the strength/fear distinction.
WORKSHEET	WS-R4: My Limit Statements — three practice scenarios plus personal application.
VOCABULARY	limit, boundary, strength, fear, self-respect, retaliation, compliance, formula, grace

PLACEMENT NOTE · STRAND CAPSTONE

Students have just studied grace and mercy. Before they go into charitable interpretation and the Grace Challenge, they need the complementary skill — how to maintain their own integrity while extending grace. Without this, 'grace' collapses into compliance. **This is the final Regulation & Repair strand lesson of the year.** It functions as the strand's capstone — pulling together regulation (WS-R1), recovery (WS-R2), repair (WS-R3), and now limits, into a coherent personal framework.

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Point to the Grace vs. Doormat anchor chart. "We have spent this unit learning what grace looks like — choosing generosity, extending mercy. But there is a question underneath: can you extend grace without losing yourself? The answer is yes. But it requires something specific: a limit. And a limit only does its job when it comes from the right place."

ANCHOR CHART · BOUNDARIES FROM STRENGTH · BFS-1

Post before students arrive. Three components: the strength/fear distinction, the limit formula, and the three tests.

FROM STRENGTH

FROM FEAR

THE LIMIT FORMULA

When ___, I feel ___ because ___. **Going forward, I will ___.** The limit is what YOU will do — not what you are demanding from the other person. The formula works whether or not the other person agrees, changes, or even hears it. The most important word is the last one: **I WILL.**

BEFORE YOU SET A LIMIT · THREE TESTS

1. Is this from self-respect or retaliation? **2.** Does the formula focus on what I will do? **3.** Can I hold this even if they don't change? If all three answers are yes — this is a limit from strength.

1**Strength/Fear Distinction**

0-5 MIN

Two contrasting examples — same situation (a friend who repeatedly makes cutting jokes). Walk through both responses. Run the three tests on the strength version.

2**Practice the Formula**

5-10 MIN

Build the formula on the board with students. "The last part is the hardest. A limit is in your control. 'I will leave.' 'I will not share information.' These are limits."

3**Card R4-A — Whole Class**

10-14 MIN

Sofia and the group chat. Students draft formula on WS-R4 Part 1. Test it. Refine together.

4**Card R4-B — Pairs**

14-18 MIN

Marcus and the difficult teammate. Pairs draft the formula. Focus on the limit-vs-complaint distinction.

5**Card R4-C — Individual**

18-20 MIN

Nadia and the screenshot. Self-check using the three tests.

6**Personal Application — WS-R4 Part 2**

20-27 MIN

Part 2 is always private. "If something real comes to mind, the formula works there too. I won't read it."

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE — A student whose formula consistently ends with what the other person should do — even after the distinction has been taught. **MAY MEAN** — This student may be having difficulty locating their own agency. It is also possible their own actions have had no effect on the harm they receive — making 'what I will do' feel futile. **ACTION** — Approach quietly. "Your formula's last part — is that something you can control?" Receive without correcting. Note for counselor.

UNIT 4 · LESSON STRAND · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

OBSERVE — A student who writes in the personal application that their limit is “I will avoid them entirely” in a situation that sounds like ongoing harm. **MAY MEAN** — The student may be describing ongoing harm — where distancing is a safety response, not a limit from strength. The formula is not the right tool for unsafe relationships. **ACTION** — After class: “If someone is genuinely hurting you, the right response is not just a limit formula. It's getting support. Can we talk?” Note for counselor today.

SCENARIO CARD R4-A · SOFIA — THE GROUP CHAT PRESSURE

THE SITUATION Sofia's friend group makes fun of a student in another class in their group chat. Every time she has tried to say 'this is kind of harsh,' her friends have told her she's being sensitive. The jokes are getting worse. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Which response would be from fear: saying nothing OR leaving the group chat dramatically? Apply the limit formula. What is the 'going forward, I will' that is actually in Sofia's control? Run the three tests. Does it pass all three? Sofia is worried that setting a limit will cost her the friendship. Is that a reason not to set the limit — or is it information about the friendship?

SCENARIO CARD R4-B · MARCUS — THE DIFFICULT TEAMMATE

THE SITUATION Marcus has a teammate, Darius, who is constantly critical. Marcus wants to keep extending grace — he knows Darius is going through something hard at home. But he is starting to dread practice. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is Darius a 'difficult person' or an 'unsafe person' in this curriculum's terms? Marcus wants to keep extending grace. Can he do that AND set a limit at the same time? Help Marcus draft a limit formula. What is the 'going forward, I will' that protects his focus without requiring Darius to change?

SCENARIO CARD R4-C · NADIA — THE SCREENSHOT · OPTIONAL GRADES 4–5

THE SITUATION Nadia has a classmate who repeatedly screenshots her social media posts and shares them with mocking commentary. When asked to stop, the classmate laughs it off. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Nadia's current response — posting less — is a limit. Is it from strength or from fear? Help Nadia draft a limit formula for the specific person. Connect to Unit 3 L4: what would 'regulate first' look like before this conversation?

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

★ STRAND YEAR-END REFLECTION

This is the final Regulation & Repair Strand lesson of the year. Distribute one index card per student. Ask them to write their four-tool framework: **My regulation strategy (WS-R1): My recovery phase (WS-R2): My repair step I do best (WS-R3): My limit formula (WS-R4):** Students keep this card — the four-tool framework in their handwriting.

UNIT 4 · LESSON STRAND · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

EXIT TICKET

Journal: "A limit from strength is different from a limit from fear because _____. The most important word in the limit formula is 'I will' because _____. One situation in my life where I could try the formula this week is _____."

TEACHER REFLECTION Which students were able to write a genuine 'I will' — one in their control? The ability to locate agency in one's own actions is one of the hardest skills in this strand and one of the most protective.

REGULATION & REPAIR STRAND — YEAR-END SUMMARY

WS-R1 My Toolkit · Unit 1 Strand · WOT-1 Window of Tolerance · Regulate first. Then do the work. **WS-R2 My Recovery Map** · Unit 2 Strand · ARC-1 Recovery Arc · Regulate. Reflect. Repair. In that order. **WS-R3 My Repair Plan** · Unit 3 Strand · REP-1 Repair Protocol · Repair has five steps. Step 5 is the most skipped. **WS-R4 My Limit Statements** · Unit 4 Strand · BFS-1 Boundaries From Strength · A limit is what I will do.

WORKSHEET · WS-R4

My Limit Statements

Unit 4 Strand Lesson

Architecture of Grace · Grades 3–5 · Reproducible for classroom use · School of Life Foundation

PRIVACY NOTE

This worksheet is private. Keep it with WS-R1 through WS-R3 in your journal.

THE LIMIT FORMULA

When ____, I feel ____ because _____. **Going forward, I will ____.** The most important part is the last one. It must be something in YOUR control.

SCENARIO 1 · SOFIA (CARD R4-A) — PEER PRESSURE

WHEN ____

I FEEL ____ **BECAUSE** ____

GOING FORWARD, I WILL ____

Test 1 — self-respect? ☐ Yes ☐ No Test 2 — in my control? ☐ Yes ☐ No Test 3 — holds if they don't change?
☐ Yes ☐ No

UNIT 4 · LESSON STRAND · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

SCENARIO 2 · MARCUS (CARD R4-B) — DIFFICULT PERSON / GRACE

WHEN ___

I FEEL ___ BECAUSE ___

GOING FORWARD, I WILL ___

Test 1 — self-respect? ☐ Yes ☐ No Test 2 — in my control? ☐ Yes ☐ No Test 3 — holds if they don't change?
☐ Yes ☐ No

SCENARIO 3 · NADIA (CARD R4-C) — DIGITAL CONFLICT

WHEN ___

I FEEL ___ BECAUSE ___

GOING FORWARD, I WILL ___

Test 1 — self-respect? ☐ Yes ☐ No Test 2 — in my control? ☐ Yes ☐ No Test 3 — holds if they don't change?
☐ Yes ☐ No

PART 2 · PERSONAL APPLICATION · PRIVATE

Is this a situation where a limit is the right tool — or one involving ongoing harm where safety comes first?

☐ A limit is the right tool ☐ Safety first — this is not a limit problem

WHEN ___

I FEEL ___ BECAUSE ___

GOING FORWARD, I WILL ___

MY FOUR-TOOL FRAMEWORK · YEAR-END REFLECTION

My most reliable regulation strategy: The hardest phase in my recovery arc: The repair step I find
hardest: My limit formula for a recurring situation: The most important thing the strand taught me:

Giving the Benefit of the Doubt

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 3
OBJECTIVE	Students practice charitable interpretation as a deliberate cognitive habit.
CASEL FOCUS	Social Awareness: charitable interpretation · Responsible Decision-Making
VOCABULARY	interpretation, charitable, doubt, assume, generous, default
MATERIALS	Journals · WS9 Pause Practice · Anchor chart · Scenario cards

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

“We extend grace and mercy in actions. Today: extending grace in our minds — before any action. The pause between something happening and how you read it is where grace lives.”

1

Define Charitable Interpretation

2–10 MIN

Choosing the kinder read of someone's behavior when you don't know all the facts. Not naive. A deliberate choice when there are multiple possible explanations.

2

The Pause Practice (WS9)

10–18 MIN

Four steps: (1) NOTICE the assumption forming. (2) PAUSE before acting. (3) ASK what other explanations might fit. (4) CHOOSE the most charitable one consistent with what you know.

3

Scenario Practice

18–28 MIN

Apply the four-step pause practice. Note: charitable interpretation does not apply to ongoing harmful patterns.

4

Personal Reflection

28–35 MIN

Journal: When have I assumed the worst about someone — and been wrong? What would charitable interpretation have looked like?

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the journal: a student who genuinely cannot recall a single instance of being wrong about someone may be in an environment where assuming the worst has been protective. This is data about their context.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

UNIT 4 · LESSON 3 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

SCENARIO CARD 4-E · GIVING THE BENEFIT OF THE DOUBT

THE SITUATION Maya passed Imani in the hall and didn't say hi. Imani's first thought: "She's mad at me." Then she remembered: Maya had a math test that morning. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What was Imani's first interpretation? What charitable interpretation became available when she paused?

SCENARIO CARD 4-F · GIVING THE BENEFIT OF THE DOUBT

THE SITUATION When Liam's group project partner missed three meetings in a row, Liam was furious — until he found out the partner's grandmother had died. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Was Liam's anger reasonable given what he knew? What does charitable interpretation require us to admit about what we know — and what we don't?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: "Charitable interpretation is _____. It is not naive because _____." **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students struggled with the concept? Some have learned to assume the worst as a protective pattern.

WORKSHEET · WS9

The Pause Practice — Four Steps

Unit 4, Lesson 3

Architecture of Grace · Grades 3–5 · Reproducible for classroom use · School of Life Foundation

Charitable interpretation is the deliberate practice of pausing before reading someone's behavior, and choosing the kinder explanation when multiple are possible.

EXAMINE YOUR OWN PATTERN

Think of a situation this week where you assumed something negative. What did you assume?

What other explanations might fit?

What would have changed if you had paused first?

Small Acts, Big Difference — Grace Gap Assignment Launch

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 4
OBJECTIVE	Students launch the Grace Gap Field Assignment — identifying one absence of grace in their environment and committing to one concrete, recurring micro-action over five school days.
CASEL FOCUS	Responsible Decision-Making: applied grace · Social Awareness: identifying need
VOCABULARY	grace gap, micro-action, field, recurring, identify
MATERIALS	WS8 Grace Gap Field Assignment · Anchor chart · Journals

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"For weeks we have been talking about grace. Today you take it out into the world. This is the most important assignment of the year."

1

Define the Grace Gap

2–10 MIN

A grace gap is a place where grace is missing — could be in your classroom, hallway, family, neighborhood, online. Where could one small act of grace make a difference?

2

Identify YOUR Grace Gap (WS8 Part 1)

10–22 MIN

Students identify a specific gap they have noticed. Be concrete. Not 'be nicer to people.' Specific: 'The new student who sits alone.' 'The student who never gets called on.' 'The lunch monitor whose name nobody knows.'

3

Commit to a Micro-Action (WS8 Part 2)

22–32 MIN

Choose one concrete, recurring action over five school days. Write it as: 'Every day for five days, I will ____.' Small, sustainable, specific.

4

Closing — Do Not Debrief Today

32–37 MIN

"You will return in two weeks for the debrief. Until then — just do the work. Notice what happens. Notice what is hard."

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the gap identification: a student who chooses something far too large ('end racism', 'fix bullying') may be avoiding the personal commitment of a small specific action. Refocus: 'What is one small, concrete thing in your daily life?'

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 4-G · SMALL ACTS, BIG DIFFERENCE

THE SITUATION Maya noticed the cafeteria worker named Ms. Linda greets every student who says hi to her — but most kids barely look up. Maya's grace gap: thanking Ms. Linda by name every day for a week.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS Why does Maya's micro-action matter even though it is small? What is the difference between this and a one-time gesture?

SCENARIO CARD 4-H · SMALL ACTS, BIG DIFFERENCE

THE SITUATION James noticed a kid in his class who never raises his hand. James's grace gap: making one specific positive comment about that kid's contribution every day for five days — even something small.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS What might shift for the other kid? What might shift for James?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: Write your grace gap in one sentence: "My grace gap is _____. My micro-action is _____." Sign it.

TEACHER REFLECTION CRITICAL: Do NOT debrief in L4. Minimum 5 full school days before L6 debrief. Note any students whose gaps reveal something significant about their relational world.

WORKSHEET · WS8

Grace Gap Field Assignment

Unit 4, Lesson 4

Architecture of Grace · Grades 3–5 · Reproducible for classroom use · School of Life Foundation

THIS IS THE MOST IMPORTANT ASSIGNMENT OF THE YEAR

You are not writing about grace. You are doing it. Five school days. One small, repeated action. **Do not skip a day. Do not change your action. Do not tell anyone you are doing this.** Just do it. We will debrief in Lesson 6 — five school days from now.

PART 1 · IDENTIFY YOUR GRACE GAP

Look around your school, your family, your team, your neighborhood. Where is grace MISSING — not because anyone is bad, but because nobody has chosen to fill it?

My Grace Gap is:

Why does this gap matter? Who does it affect?

UNIT 4 · LESSON 4 · THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

PART 2 · COMMIT TO A MICRO-ACTION

Choose ONE concrete, repeatable action you will do every school day for five days. Specific. Small. Sustainable.

EVERY SCHOOL DAY FOR FIVE DAYS, I WILL:

WEEKLY REFLECTION LOG

Note one observation each day. What happened? What did you notice in yourself? In them?

DAY 1

DAY 2

DAY 3

DAY 4

DAY 5

Signature _____ Date _____

Grace with Hard People

DURATION	35–40 min · Week 5
OBJECTIVE	Students articulate strategies for extending grace to people who are difficult — without becoming a doormat.
CASEL FOCUS	Relationship Skills: extending grace from strength · Social Awareness: distinguishing difficult from unsafe
VOCABULARY	difficult, hard, unsafe, distance, dignity
MATERIALS	Anchor chart (Grace vs. Doormat from L1) · Journals · Scenario cards

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Reference the Grace vs. Doormat anchor chart from L1. “We said grace is not the same as letting people treat you badly. Today we look at the hardest case: how do you extend grace to someone who is genuinely difficult — without becoming the doormat?”

1

Difficult vs. Unsafe

2–10 MIN

DIFFICULT = hard to be around, sometimes unkind, can be navigated with care. UNSAFE = repeatedly causes harm, threatens your wellbeing, requires distance and adult support. Grace applies to difficult. NOT to unsafe. Adult support and limits apply to unsafe.

2

Strategies for Grace with Difficult People

10–20 MIN

(1) Extend the benefit of the doubt — once. (2) Limit your exposure rather than your kindness. (3) Refuse to retaliate without becoming a doormat. (4) Hold dignity — yours and theirs.

3

Scenario Practice

20–30 MIN

Walk through scenarios where grace is the right call vs. distance is the right call. Use the limit formula from the strand lesson when needed.

4

Journal

30–37 MIN

Is there a difficult person in your life? What would extending grace look like — without losing yourself?

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the journal: a student who describes someone who sounds clearly unsafe (not just difficult) — repeated harm, fear, isolation — needs a private check-in. The lesson's strategies are not the right tool for unsafe relationships.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 4-I · GRACE WITH HARD PEOPLE

THE SITUATION Tina has a relative who makes critical comments at every family gathering. Her mom always says 'just ignore her.' But Tina dreads every visit. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is this difficult or unsafe? What would grace from strength look like? What limit might Tina need?

SCENARIO CARD 4-J · GRACE WITH HARD PEOPLE

THE SITUATION Devon has a teammate who sulks loudly whenever Devon plays well. Devon is starting to play worse on purpose to keep the peace. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What did Devon give up to keep the peace? Is what Devon is doing grace — or doormat? What would grace from strength look like instead?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: "One difficult person I can extend grace to from strength is _____. One thing I will NOT give up is _____."

TEACHER REFLECTION Which students seemed to confuse difficult and unsafe? This distinction is critical and may need follow-up.

Grace Gap Field Assignment — Class Debrief

DURATION	40 min · Week 6
OBJECTIVE	Students debrief their five-day Grace Gap field assignment and articulate what grace as a practice (not a feeling) actually requires.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness: reflection on practice · Social Awareness: impact recognition
VOCABULARY	debrief, practice, sustain, observe, witness
MATERIALS	Students bring WS8 (completed) · Journals · Anchor chart

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

"Five school days ago you committed to a small act of grace. Today is the day we talk about what happened. Whatever happened — including 'nothing visible' — is real data."

1 Pair Debrief — WS8 Reflection Logs 2–15 MIN

In pairs, students share their five-day reflection logs. "What did you do? What did you notice in yourself? In the other person?" Listen first. No advice.

2 Whole-Class Pattern Naming 15–25 MIN

Without naming the recipient, students share what they noticed. Patterns to draw out: (1) Grace is often invisible to the recipient. (2) Grace changes the giver more than the receiver. (3) Five days is harder than expected. (4) Grace requires no thanks.

3 The Big Insight 25–35 MIN

"Most of you noticed: nothing visible happened. The world did not transform. The person you chose may not have even noticed. AND — you noticed something about yourself. That is what grace as a practice is. It changes you whether or not anyone sees it."

4 Closing 35–40 MIN

"Who will continue past today? Raise your hand if you are committing to one more week." Acknowledge: most who try this will continue. The practice has its own gravity.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 6 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the pair debrief: any student who reports the grace gap was rejected aggressively or who experienced backlash needs a private check-in. Some grace gaps reveal toxic dynamics. Adjust counsel if needed.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During whole-class sharing: a student who reports they did not do the assignment — note honestly. Do not shame. Some students have contexts where this assignment exposed something hard to navigate. Note for individual follow-up.

GRADE 3

GRADES 4 — 5

SCENARIO CARD 4-K · GRACE GAP FIELD ASSIGNMENT

THE SITUATION Maya thanked Ms. Linda by name every day for a week. By Day 5, Ms. Linda was visibly lighter. Maya noticed she felt more grounded all day after that small interaction. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** What changed for Ms. Linda? What changed for Maya? What is the curriculum's claim about grace and the giver?

SCENARIO CARD 4-L · GRACE GAP FIELD ASSIGNMENT

THE SITUATION James made a positive comment about a quieter classmate every day. The classmate never said anything in response. James started to wonder if it was working. **DISCUSSION QUESTIONS** Is the absence of visible response evidence the practice is failing? What might be happening that James cannot see?

EXIT TICKET

Journal: "Grace is a practice — not a feeling — because _____. The most important thing the field assignment taught me is _____." **TEACHER REFLECTION** Which students continued past Day 5 spontaneously? Which struggled to sustain? This is data about character formation in real time.

Community Charter & Year-End Celebration ★ ELEVATED

DURATION	45 min · Week 7
OBJECTIVE	Students retrieve and read their U2 future-self letters, co-create a class community charter, and close the year with reflection on growth across all four units.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Awareness · Social Awareness · All four CASEL competencies (synthesis)
VOCABULARY	charter, community, growth, year, witness, celebrate
MATERIALS	Sealed letters from U2 L7 · Journals · Chart paper · All Unit anchor charts displayed

SAFETY CHECK — COMPLETE BEFORE DELIVERING

Counselor on standby recommended. · Lesson scheduled Mon–Wed of final week only. · Reflection Pass pre-positioned. · Some students may find the future-self letter activating — past-self holding present-self carries emotional weight. Do NOT collect or read letters. Honor privacy.

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Display all anchor charts from all four units. “Look at what we built. Twenty-eight lessons. Four units. Look at the visual record of nine months of brave honest work. Today we close it. And we open something else.”

1 Retrieve Future-Self Letters 2–15 MIN

Distribute the sealed letters students wrote at U2 L7 — back in October. “Your past self wrote this for you. Read it privately. Take your time.” Allow 8 full minutes of silence. Do not collect. Honor the privacy.

2 Community Charter Co-Creation 15–25 MIN

“On chart paper, we are writing the agreements for who this class has been. Not aspirational — actual. What do we have that we want to name?” Students contribute. Teacher records. Sign at the bottom — every student. This is the year’s record.

3 Year-End Reflection — Pair Share 25–35 MIN

“Two questions. Take turns. (1) How are you different from who you were in September? (2) What is one thing you are taking with you?” Pairs share. No reporting back.

4

Closing Circle

35–43 MIN

Each student names one word for what they are taking with them. No comments. No judgment. Just the word. Teacher closes: “You are the architects of your own grace. The work continues. You know how now.”

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the future-self letter reading: any student who appears emotionally overwhelmed — tears, withdrawal, sudden silence — may be experiencing the weight of who they were. Receive this. Some students will find their past-self's letter heartbreaking.

IN-LESSON SCAN

During the closing circle: any student who cannot name a word, or whose word is markedly negative ('exhausted', 'nothing'), may be signaling something important about their year. Do not press in front of the group. Note for follow-up.

GRADE 3**GRADES 4 — 5****EXIT TICKET**

Journal: Final journal entry of the year: “Who I am at the end of fifth/fourth/third grade is _____. Who I am becoming is _____.” **TEACHER REFLECTION** This is the last day. There is no next lesson. Sit in what you saw across nine months. Write your own teacher reflection privately — it belongs to no one but you.

END OF YEAR

Teacher Close-Out Note

You taught a curriculum that asked students to do honest interior work. They did it. So did you. Some of what you witnessed this year will stay with you. Some of what you witnessed should not stay with you alone — debrief with your counselor, your colleagues, your own support web. The students who grew the most this year may not be the students who said the most. Trust what you saw. **Before the next school year:** review the post-assessment data with your counselor. Identify any students whose post-assessment patterns warrant a warm hand-off to next year's teacher. **And:** you taught grace this year. Extend it to yourself for the parts that did not go the way you wanted. Every part of this curriculum applies to you, too.

— School of Life Foundation

SECTION THREE

Assessment Suite

Grades 3–5 · Pilot Year

3.1 Assessment Overview & Administration Guide

The Architecture of Grace Assessment Suite contains five instruments relevant to Grades 3–5 delivery. This section contains Instruments B, E, F, and G — all materials needed for the pilot year.

▲ AI INSTRUMENT DISCLOSURE

This instrument was developed by large language models (LLMs). It is an unvalidated working-draft tool for the pilot year. No licensed psychometricians, clinical professionals, or educational measurement specialists participated in instrument design. **Do not use for high-stakes decisions** — including teacher performance evaluation, student placement, referral, or public claims of programme efficacy — without independent professional review by a licensed educational measurement specialist.

INSTRUMENTS IN THIS SECTION

B	Written student self-report · 16 items · Likert	Pre: before U1L1 · Post: after U4L7	Self-reported growth across all four unit constructs
E	Administrator observation checklist	Once per semester per teacher	Fidelity monitoring during classroom observation
F	Administrator protocol · 3 checkpoints	September / January / May–June	Building-level programme health monitoring
G	Family perception survey · Anonymous	After U2 (mid-year) + after U4 (year-end)	Family awareness and perception

DATA COLLECTION TIMELINE

Week 1 of school (before U1L1)	Instrument B (pre)	Classroom teacher. Store by Student ID code only — never by name.
End of Unit 2 (mid-year)	Instrument G (Family Survey)	Distributed by teacher. Returned to building administrator. Anonymous.
September / January / May–June	Instrument F (Administrator Protocol)	Building principal or district coordinator. Three checkpoints.
Once per semester per teacher	Instrument E (Fidelity Checklist)	Instructional coach or building principal during observation.
Final week of school (after U4L7)	Instrument B (post)	Same classroom teacher. Return pre alongside post.
End of Unit 4 (year-end)	Instrument G (Family Survey — year-end)	Distributed by teacher. Anonymous.

3.2 Instrument B — Student Self-Assessment (Pre/Post)

Student Self-Report · Written · Grades 3–5 · 16 Items · 4-Point Likert Scale

▲ AI INSTRUMENT DISCLOSURE

This instrument was developed by large language models (LLMs). It is an unvalidated working-draft tool for the pilot year. No licensed psychometricians, clinical professionals, or educational measurement specialists participated in instrument design. **Do not use for high-stakes decisions** — including teacher performance evaluation, student placement, referral, or public claims of programme efficacy — without independent professional review by a licensed educational measurement specialist.

ADMINISTRATION NOTES

- Administer before Unit 1 Lesson 1 (pre) and after Unit 4 Lesson 7 (post).
- Read each item aloud for students who need reading support.
- Tell students: “There are no right or wrong answers. This is just for you and me to understand how the year is going.”
- Collect and store pre-assessments privately. Return alongside the post so students can see their change.
- Do not review or discuss answers before instruction begins.
- Store by Student ID code only — never by student name. See Instrument H for FERPA compliance guidance.

Student Self-Assessment

Circle one: BEGINNING OF YEAR / END OF YEAR

Name (optional): _____ Grade: _____ Date: _____

Directions: For each sentence, circle the number that feels most true for you right now.

SECTION 1 — KNOWING YOURSELF

1. I know things about myself that other people don't always see. 1 2 3 4
2. I know the difference between “I did something wrong” (guilt) and “I am a bad person” (shame). 1 2 3 4
3. When I make a mistake, I think of it as an “Oops” — not as proof that I'm bad. 1 2 3 4
4. I have some control over how I respond when things go wrong, even if I can't control what happened. 1 2 3 4

SECTION 2 — BEING KIND TO YOURSELF

5. I know what self-compassion means — being kind to yourself the way you'd be kind to a friend. 1 2 3 4
6. When I make a mistake, I try to make it right instead of just feeling terrible about myself. 1 2 3 4
7. I can say sorry in a way that I really mean — naming what I did and making a repair. 1 2 3 4
8. I know that I can “put down” heavy feelings instead of carrying them around all the time. 1 2 3 4

SECTION 3 — EMPATHY & FORGIVING OTHERS

9. I understand that forgiving someone doesn't mean they didn't hurt me or that I have to be friends with them again. 1 2 3 4

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

10. When someone hurts my feelings, I can try to think about what they might have been going through.1 2 3 4
11. I know that my story — what happened to me — doesn't have to be the whole me.1 2 3 4
12. I know what it means to give someone “the benefit of the doubt.”1 2 3 4

SECTION 4 — GRACE & GENEROSITY

13. I know what grace means — choosing to be kind to someone even when I don't have to.1 2 3 4
14. I practice small acts of kindness — things that cost me a little but matter to someone else.1 2 3 4
15. I can be kind to people who are difficult without being a pushover.1 2 3 4
16. I think this class has been a place where people try to be kind and fair to each other.1 2 3 4

OPEN RESPONSE PROMPTS · OPTIONAL

WHAT IS ONE THING YOU KNOW ABOUT YOURSELF NOW THAT YOU DIDN'T KNOW AT THE BEGINNING OF THE YEAR?

DESCRIBE A TIME YOU MADE A MISTAKE AND HANDLED IT WELL. WHAT DID YOU DO?

WHAT DOES FORGIVENESS MEAN TO YOU? CAN YOU GIVE AN EXAMPLE?

3.3 Instrument E — Teacher Fidelity Observation Checklist

Used by Building Principals, Instructional Coaches, Curriculum Directors · Minimum Once Per Semester

PURPOSE: Instrument E provides a structured observation protocol for administrators conducting informal walk-throughs and formal fidelity observations. First observation window: Weeks 3–5 of Unit 1 (informal). Second observation window: Weeks 3–5 of Unit 3 (formal).

OBSERVATION HEADER

Observer: _____ **Teacher:** _____ **Date:** _____ **Unit/**
Lesson: _____ **Grade Band:** _____ **Type:** ☐ Informal ☐ Formal

LESSON STRUCTURE & SEQUENCE

- ☐ Opening Review delivered (2 min, structured bridge from prior lesson).
- ☐ Lesson follows scripted time blocks (within ±5 minutes).
- ☐ All required steps completed before exit ticket.
- ☐ Anchor charts visible and referenced during lesson.

VOCABULARY & CURRICULUM LANGUAGE

- ☐ Teacher uses curriculum vocabulary precisely (“inner critic,” “guilt vs. shame,” “grace”).
- ☐ Students use curriculum vocabulary in their own speech.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

☐ Cross-unit references made (Unit 1 → Unit 2 connections drawn explicitly).

EMOTIONAL CLIMATE & HOLDING

- ☐ Tone is warm, steady, non-judgmental.
- ☐ Silence is held (not rushed) at moments designed for it.
- ☐ No student is shamed for the content of their response.
- ☐ Students appear regulated and engaged — neither flooded nor checked out.

DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL READINESS

- ☐ Teacher knows the disclosure protocol verbatim.
- ☐ Crisis resources are posted (988, Crisis Text Line) where required.
- ☐ Counselor coordination is in place for any risk-flagged lessons.
- ☐ Reflection Pass available where required.

EQUITY & ACCESSIBILITY

- ☐ All students have access to the lesson content (reading support, IEP accommodations, ELL supports).
- ☐ Examples and scenarios reflect the cultural diversity of the class.
- ☐ Equity context (where curriculum requires it) is delivered with care.

FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

- ☐ Family Connection note is sent home weekly (or at appropriate cadence).
- ☐ Curriculum vocabulary is shared with families so they can reinforce at home.

OBSERVATION NOTES:

3.4 Instrument F — Administrator Monitoring Protocol

Used by Building Principals or District Coordinators · Three Checkpoints · Programme Health

Three checkpoints across the year. Document any concerning patterns and convene a coordination meeting with the teacher and counselor to address.

SEPTEMBER CHECKPOINT · PRE-IMPLEMENTATION READINESS

When: Before Unit 1 Lesson 1 ☐ Counselor identified, briefed, and calendar blocked for all risk-flagged lessons. ☐ Teacher PD complete — including disclosure protocol training. ☐ Materials inventory confirmed (anchor charts, worksheets, mentor texts). ☐ Family communication letter sent home before Unit 1. ☐ Crisis resources posted in classroom. ☐ Pre-assessment (Instrument B) scheduled for Week 1.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

JANUARY CHECKPOINT · MID-YEAR PROGRAMME HEALTH

When: End of Unit 2 / start of Unit 3 ☐ Instrument E (Fidelity) completed at least once. ☐ Instrument G (Family Survey) distributed and returns reviewed. ☐ Teacher debrief held — counselor included. ☐ Any disclosure events reviewed (with appropriate confidentiality). ☐ Coordination meeting with counselor for Unit 3 planning. ☐ Identify students with elevated emotional load entering Unit 3.

MAY–JUNE CHECKPOINT · YEAR-END SYNTHESIS

When: After Unit 4 Lesson 7 ☐ Post-assessment (Instrument B) administered. ☐ Pre/post comparison reviewed at class level. ☐ Year-end Instrument G (Family Survey) distributed. ☐ Teacher year-end debrief — review patterns, growth, lessons learned. ☐ Identify students for warm hand-off to next year's teacher. ☐ Review what worked and what needs adjustment for Year 2.

3.5 Instrument G — Family Engagement Survey

Anonymous · Distributed Mid-Year (after Unit 2) and Year-End (after Unit 4)

DISTRIBUTION INSTRUCTIONS

- Distribute via the school's standard family communication channel (paper home, parent portal, email).
- Anonymous returns only — never collect names or identifying information.
- Returns go to the building administrator, not the classroom teacher.
- Report returns to teacher in aggregate only.
- Do NOT use individual responses for teacher evaluation.

Confidential

Anonymous · Mid-Year and Year-End

Thank you for participating. Your responses help us understand how the Architecture of Grace curriculum is supporting your child.

Circle one: MID-YEAR / YEAR-END Grade level of child: _____

1. My child has come home talking about the curriculum or what they are learning.1 2 3 4
2. I have noticed my child using new vocabulary (e.g., "inner critic," "guilt vs shame," "grace") at home.1 2 3 4
3. My child seems more able to handle mistakes without becoming destabilized.1 2 3 4
4. My child has demonstrated more self-compassion or self-kindness this year.1 2 3 4
5. My child has talked with me about a hurt or conflict using new tools.1 2 3 4
6. I support the curriculum's content and approach.1 2 3 4
7. I would like more information about specific topics (please specify in open response).1 2 3 4

OPEN RESPONSE · OPTIONAL

WHAT IS ONE THING YOU HAVE NOTICED AT HOME THIS YEAR THAT YOU CONNECT TO THE CURRICULUM?

IS THERE ANYTHING ABOUT THE CURRICULUM YOU WOULD LIKE TO KNOW MORE ABOUT?

ANYTHING ELSE YOU WOULD LIKE THE SCHOOL TO KNOW?

3.6 Scoring & Interpretation Guide

INSTRUMENT B SCORING

Scoring: 1 = 1 pt, 2 = 2 pts, 3 = 3 pts, 4 = 4 pts. Maximum composite score = 64. Compare pre and post totals per student and per class. **Class-level:** Items where 50%+ of students score 1–2 at post indicate areas needing reinforcement in Year 2. **Individual:** Students scoring 1 on all Unit 2 or Unit 3 items at post may benefit from counselor awareness. This is a screening signal, not a diagnostic finding.

SCORE RANGE INTERPRETATION

16–32 (Low)	Student self-perception suggests limited awareness of key constructs. Flag for counselor awareness. Consider differentiated support.
33–48 (Developing)	Student self-perception is developing. Review which sections score lowest for targeted reinforcement.
49–58 (Progressing)	Student self-perception is solid. Pre/post comparison is the most meaningful data point.
59–64 (Strong)	Student self-reports strong alignment with all constructs. Pre/post comparison will show whether this was pre-existing or growth.

VALIDITY CAVEAT — REQUIRED LANGUAGE FOR BOARD PRESENTATIONS

This is an original unvalidated instrument measuring self-reported perception aligned to curriculum constructs. Do not use for placement, referral, or high-stakes purposes. **Board presentations:** “Students self-report higher levels of self-awareness, self-compassion, and understanding of forgiveness by year-end — based on an original curriculum-aligned perception measure.”

3.7 Instrument H — Pilot Year Data Protocol

For District Assessment Coordinators · All Grade Bands · Pilot Year

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

PURPOSE: Instrument H is the district-level guide to collecting, storing, analyzing, and (optionally) submitting data from the Architecture of Grace pilot year. It covers the full collection timeline, FERPA and mandatory reporting compliance, effect size benchmarks, equity analysis guidance, and recommended validated supplementary instruments for districts that wish to build a more rigorous evidence base.

▲ SCOPE OF THIS PROTOCOL

The pre/post student surveys are original, unvalidated instruments measuring self-reported perception. They are appropriate for programme-level reflection and improvement. They are not appropriate for high-stakes claims about student outcomes, teacher effectiveness, or programme efficacy without additional validation by a qualified educational measurement specialist.

SECTION 1 — DATA COLLECTION TIMELINE

Week 1 of school (before U1L1)	Grade-appropriate pre-assessment	Classroom teacher. Store by Student ID code only — never by name.
End of Unit 2 (mid-year)	Family Engagement Survey	Distributed by teacher. Returned to building administrator. Anonymous.
September / January / May–June	Administrator Monitoring Protocol	Building principal or district coordinator. Three checkpoints.
Once per semester per teacher	Fidelity Observation Checklist	Instructional coach or building principal during lesson observation.
Final week (after U4L7)	Grade-appropriate post-assessment	Same classroom teacher. Return pre alongside post for student self-comparison.
End of Unit 4 (year-end)	Family Engagement Survey	Distributed by teacher. Anonymous.
After post-assessment is collected	Calculate gain scores & complete pilot data summary	District Assessment Coordinator. Aggregate by grade band — no individual student data.
Optional — June deadline	Submit aggregate anonymised data to School of Life Foundation	Voluntary. Contributes to ESSA Tier 2 evidence base. No individual data submitted.

SECTION 2 — FERPA & MANDATORY REPORTING COMPLIANCE**FERPA REQUIREMENTS**

Student ID codes: Match pre and post assessments by a de-identified Student ID code — never by student name. The key connecting ID codes to student names must be stored separately and securely. Storage: All completed assessment instruments stored in a password-protected digital system or locked physical location. Access limited to the classroom teacher and district assessment coordinator. Sharing: No individual student data is shared with parents, other teachers, administrators, or the School of Life Foundation. Only aggregate, anonymised data is compiled for programme review. Year-end disposition: Pre and post assessments are returned to students at year-end, or destroyed securely. They are not retained in the student's permanent academic record. 18-year-old student rights: Under FERPA, students who have turned 18 hold their own educational records rights. For Books 4 and 5, student consent (not parental) is required for any records sharing. This applies to all 9–12 instruments.

SECTION 3 — EFFECT SIZE BENCHMARKS

The following benchmarks are provided for districts that wish to assess whether observed pre/post gains are educationally meaningful. These are guidance values for programme reflection — not performance thresholds.

$d < 0.2$	Negligible	Pre/post change is within normal variation. No strong signal of curriculum impact at the construct level. Review delivery fidelity.
$d \geq 0.2$	Small	Modest signal. Students are moving in the right direction on self-report measures. Consistent with low-intensity SEL exposure.
$d \geq 0.3$	Target threshold	The pilot year target for Architecture of Grace. Consistent with Tier 2 ESSA evidence expectations for SEL programmes.
$d \geq 0.5$	Moderate	Strong signal for a self-report measure. Indicates meaningful programme impact is likely if delivery fidelity is confirmed.
$d \geq 0.8$	Large	Very strong signal. Uncommon in self-report SEL instruments without clinical intervention. Warrants validation with external measure.

Calculating d : $d = (\text{Mean Post} - \text{Mean Pre}) / \text{Pooled Standard Deviation}$. Use the composite score (sum of all items) for the calculation. Calculate separately by grade band — do not combine K–2 and 9–12 data.

SECTION 4 — EQUITY ANALYSIS

Aggregate data alone may mask meaningful disparities. After calculating overall gain scores, disaggregate by the following subgroups where data is available. No student should be identifiable from reported data.

ELL / English Language Learner status	Comparable pre/post gain to non-ELL peers. Lower gain may indicate scaffolding gaps.
Students with IEP / 504 plans	Comparable access and engagement. Lower gain warrants review of accommodation implementation.
Race / Ethnicity	No systematic gap in gain scores by racial/ethnic group. Differential outcomes warrant curriculum equity review.
Grade level (within a band)	Comparable gains across Grades 3/4/5, 6/7/8, or 9/10/11/12. Significant variance by grade may indicate pacing mismatch.
Teacher (where multiple teachers deliver)	Comparable gains across classrooms. Significant variance warrants fidelity review for lower-gain classrooms.

SECTION 5 — RECOMMENDED VALIDATED SUPPLEMENTARY INSTRUMENTS

For districts seeking externally validated measures to supplement the Architecture of Grace pre/post surveys, the following instruments are recommended. These are independent of the School of Life Foundation and require separate licensing.

DESSA-3 (Devereux Student Strengths Assessment)	K–12	Social-emotional competence across 8 subscales. Teacher-rated. ESSA evidence-based. Provides validated external benchmark for self-compassion and relationship skills constructs.
SSIS-SEL (Social Skills Improvement System)	K–12	CASEL-aligned SEL competencies. Both teacher-rated and student self-report versions. Covers all five CASEL domains addressed in this curriculum.
Neff SCS-SF (Self-Compassion Scale – Short Form)	Grades 7–12	Validated 12-item self-report measuring the three components of self-compassion (Neff, 2003). Directly aligned to Unit 2 constructs across all grade bands.
Rosenberg Self-Esteem Scale	Grades 6–12	10-item validated self-report. Not a direct curriculum measure, but provides external validity check on identity and self-worth constructs from Units 1 and 4.
BASC-3 BESS (Behavioral and Emotional Screening System)	K–12	Brief universal screener for behavioural and emotional risk. Can identify students who may need Tier 2 or Tier 3 support beyond this Tier 1 curriculum.

SECTION 6 — VOLUNTARY DATA SUBMISSION TO SCHOOL OF LIFE FOUNDATION

WHAT IS SUBMITTED — AND WHAT IS NOT

Eligible to submit: Aggregate, anonymised pre/post gain score data at the grade-band level. Total N (number of students assessed). Delivery fidelity summary. Family survey aggregate results. No individual student data. No teacher-identified data. Never submitted: Individual student names, ID codes, or scores. Teacher names or classroom-level data. Any data that could identify a student, family, or educator. What submission does: Contributes to the Tier 2 (Moderate Evidence) ESSA pathway for the Architecture of Grace curriculum. Helps the School of Life Foundation improve instruments, implementation support, and equity guidance across the pilot cohort. Submission is voluntary. It has no bearing on continued access to the curriculum, district support, or licensing.

SECTION FOUR

Reference & Compliance

Implementation, Legal, Clinical, and Family Materials

4.1 The Framework · A Framing Essay

Architecture of Grace was designed as a thirteen-year sequence — a K–12 curriculum where every grade builds on the last. This book is the second story of the building.

An architect designing a building does not begin with the wallpaper. They begin with the load. What weight will this structure need to carry across its full lifespan? Where does the load concentrate? What needs to be reinforced now so the upper floors can hold what they will hold?

Social-emotional learning curricula often begin with the wallpaper. They begin with what is visible — the kindness poster, the feelings wheel, the affirmation jar. These are not wrong. But if the structural work is not done first, the wallpaper hangs over uncertain joists.

The Architecture of Grace begins with the structural work. Book 1, K–2, lays the foundation: the language of feelings, the language of mistakes, the early grammar of self-compassion. Book 2 — this book — adds the second story. Students at Grades 3–5 are still small, and they are also no longer small. They are old enough to recognize shame, to internalize an inner critic, to feel the weight of a hurt that goes unacknowledged. They are not yet old enough to carry that weight alone.

Book 2 is what they need. It teaches them that their hurt is real. It teaches them the difference between a mistake and a flaw. It teaches them that they are more than their worst moment. It teaches them that forgiveness — given to themselves and given to others — is not weakness, not forgetting, not pretending. It is a choice they get to make on their own terms, in their own time, for their own peace.

And it teaches them grace. Grace as a posture. Grace as a practice. Grace as an architecture they can grow into.

"We are not training students to be nice. We are training them to hold themselves and each other with honesty and care." — School of Life Foundation

4.2 Why We Build

Across the country, social-emotional learning has expanded rapidly — and unevenly. Many curricula are skill-rich and structure-thin: a strong activity here, a strong worksheet there, but no coherent through-line across the year, and no through-line across grade bands. Students arrive in fifth grade having met the same kindness poster four years in a row.

The Architecture of Grace is the through-line. Each unit answers a question the previous unit raised. Each grade band assumes what the prior grade band built. The vocabulary is consistent. The anchor charts are cumulative. By the time a student finishes Book 5 in twelfth grade, they have spent thirteen years inside one coherent psychological architecture — an architecture that takes seriously the work of becoming a person who is honest with themselves, kind to themselves, repairing with others, and choosing generosity as a deliberate practice.

This is the architecture. This is why we build.

4.3 Full Counselor Integration Calendar

Required Counselor Coordination · Architecture of Grace · The Framework · Grades 3–5

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

August — Before School Year Starts	Full curriculum orientation	Counselor receives a physical copy of the 3–5 grade-band book. Reads the Teacher Implementation Guide, Part II (Legal & Clinical Compliance), and the disclosure protocol (Types 1–4) before the PD day. Attends the half-day PD as a required participant.
Before Unit 1 Lesson 1	Pre-launch briefing with teacher	Counselor and delivering teacher meet in person to: (1) review the disclosure protocol; (2) confirm counselor availability for the four mandatory lesson dates; (3) review the Reflection Pass protocol; (4) establish referral language.
Unit 1 — All Lessons	Awareness only	No on-site requirement. Counselor briefed that Unit 1 is in progress. The guilt/shame distinction lesson (U1 L5) may prompt students to seek out the counselor independently.
Before U2 L5 — Letting Go: A Practice	Advance notice 1 week	Counselor confirms availability to be reached on the day this lesson runs. No pre-break scheduling.
U2 L6 — When Self-Forgiveness Feels Impossible ★★	On-site or immediately available, full lesson	AFSP Safe Messaging Guidelines apply. Crisis resources must be posted visibly: 988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline · Crisis Text Line (text HOME to 741741).
Before U3 L3 — Forgiveness Is Not the Same as Trust ★★	On-site or immediately available, full lesson	Most likely lesson to surface disclosures about ongoing unsafe relationships. Before this lesson: teacher and counselor identify 1–2 students they are watching.
January — Mid-Year Session (Required)	Mid-year debrief	Counselor presents anonymized observations on student wellbeing; counselor and teacher build a shared monitoring plan for Unit 3.
Unit 4 — All Lessons	Awareness only	No on-site requirement. Unit 4 carries significantly lower disclosure risk.
After U4 L7 — Year-End Celebration	Year-end debrief	Counselor and teacher debrief the year. Future-self letters opened — counselor on standby in case any student's letter surfaces material requiring support.

WHAT THE COUNSELOR MUST KNOW BEFORE YEAR START

The four mandatory lesson dates. Both on-site lessons (U2 L6 and U3 L3) and both advance-notice lessons (U2 L5 and U3 L5) must be on the counselor's calendar before Unit 1 Lesson 1 is delivered.

AFSP Safe Messaging compliance — U2 L6. Do not use the words “committed suicide” — use “died by suicide.” Do not describe methods, means, or locations.

The Reflection Pass. The 3–5 alternative to requiring written or verbal participation. If a student's use becomes a pattern, counselor follow-up is warranted.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

Journal Privacy Protocol. At 3–5, student journals are private instructional materials — not educational records. If a journal entry raises a mandatory reporting concern and the student shares it voluntarily, the counselor is contacted that day.

The communication channel. Before Unit 1 Lesson 1, teacher and counselor establish the specific, reliable channel for same-day communication.

Teacher wellbeing. Teachers who hold significant emotional material across a full school year are not immune to its effects. The mid-year session includes a direct teacher wellbeing check-in.

SEE ALSO

The Family Grace Audit (Section 4.7.A) is distributed to families twice in the school year — at the year-start with the Pre-Year Letter, and at the year-end after Unit 4 Lesson 7 along with the Final Reflection (4.7.B) and Closing Words (4.7.C). The audit is private; counselors do not collect it and do not ask about its contents. Its purpose is to give families the same vocabulary and reflection structure their child is using in class.

4.4 Teacher Troubleshooting Guide

Common Implementation Challenges · Read this before Lesson 1. Return to it when you need it.

"MY STUDENTS WON'T WRITE IN THEIR JOURNALS. THEY LEAVE THE PAGE BLANK OR WRITE ONE SENTENCE."

This is the most common Year 1 challenge, particularly at Grade 3. Two causes: (1) Journaling feels like a test. Repeat early and often: "This is never graded. I will not read it without your permission. It is yours." Walk away from journal time. Do not circulate to read over shoulders. (2) The prompt is too open. Pre-structure with sentence frames for the first three to four weeks until journaling becomes habitual.

"A STUDENT CRIED DURING A LESSON AND THE CLASS DIDN'T KNOW HOW TO RESPOND."

This is correct engagement, not a crisis. Acknowledge it quietly — move to the student, say one sentence at a level only they can hear: "Something is coming up for you. That's okay." Then address the room without naming the student: "When something real lands in a room, sometimes the room goes quiet. That's the lesson working. Keep writing."

"STUDENTS KEEP DEFLECTING WITH JOKES WHEN DISCUSSIONS GET REAL."

Humor is a developmentally appropriate defense at upper elementary. The student using humor most aggressively is often the student with the most to protect. Do not suppress it. Name the pattern without naming the student: "Sometimes when we get close to something real, the room gets funny. That's human. We can hold both."

“A PARENT CONTACTED THE SCHOOL OBJECTING TO THE FORGIVENESS CONTENT — THEY SAY THEIR CHILD SHOULD NOT HAVE TO FORGIVE SOMEONE WHO HURT THEM.”

This parent is correct, and the curriculum agrees. The Architecture of Grace never requires forgiveness. State this clearly and immediately — it will de-escalate most objections on the spot. If the parent wants to review materials, the Tier 1 opt-out process provides a physical copy within 5 school days. The family is never wrong to protect their child.

“A STUDENT OBJECTED PUBLICLY TO A FORGIVENESS LESSON.”

This student is correct, and saying so out loud took courage. Affirm it immediately: “You are absolutely right. This curriculum does not require forgiveness. What we are looking at today is what forgiveness looks like for people who choose it — not whether anyone has to.”

“I FEEL EMOTIONALLY DRAINED AFTER DELIVERING UNIT 2 AND UNIT 3.”

This is real, and it matters. You are holding the emotional weight of 25 to 30 students. Required: use the Teacher Reflection prompt after every lesson; brief your school counselor after any lesson that produced a significant disclosure; identify one restorative practice for high-intensity lesson days. Teacher depletion is the most underaddressed implementation risk in this curriculum.

“I HAVE A STUDENT WHO SEEMS COMPLETELY UNMOVED BY EVERYTHING.”

Complete emotional flatness during SEL work is worth noting. It may be: (a) a student who has learned to be entirely defended; (b) a student in active crisis who is dissociated; or (c) a student who genuinely processes internally. Flat affect with task compliance (option c) is not a concern. Flat affect with withdrawal (a or b) warrants a counselor conversation.

“I ACCIDENTALLY DELIVERED A HIGH-RISK LESSON ON A DAY WHEN THE COUNSELOR WAS UNAVAILABLE.”

First: this is why the scheduling rules exist. For now: document what occurred, note any student responses that raised concern, and contact the school counselor the next day with your notes. If a disclosure occurred that you are uncertain about, treat it as Type 3 and follow the mandatory reporting protocol.

“A STUDENT HANDED ME THEIR JOURNAL OPEN TO A PAGE THAT RAISED A SERIOUS CONCERN.”

This is a voluntary disclosure. Stop what you are doing. Receive it with calm: “Thank you for showing me this. I’m really glad you did.” Then follow the four-step protocol: acknowledge without probing; stabilize; assess whether this requires immediate counselor contact; contact the counselor the same day. Document what you saw. You do not retain the journal.

4.5 Inclusive Delivery Guide • IEP / SpEd / ELL Matrix

For Special Education Coordinators, ELL Coordinators, Instructional Coaches, and Administrators.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)
UNIVERSAL INCLUSIVE DESIGN PRINCIPLES

Journaling with drawing accepted throughout. Drawing is explicitly accepted as a full alternative. Scribing is permitted. No journal entry is graded or viewed without student permission.

Reflection Pass. Allows any student to opt out of a specific written or verbal activity without leaving the room or drawing peer attention. Pre-positioned before every high-risk lesson.

Sentence frames in every lesson. Five or more frames per lesson, progressing in complexity across units. Home-language frame completion is permitted.

Scenario cards and physical anchors. Scenario cards make abstract concepts concrete. Physical anchors communicate meaning non-verbally.

No required public disclosure. No lesson requires students to share personal emotional content with the group. Journals are private.

Partner and small-group discussion. Reduces social risk of whole-class participation. Sentence frames are provided for every discussion prompt.

NOTES TO COORDINATORS

Special Education Coordinators. At 3–5, the primary built-in SpEd accommodations are: journaling with drawing accepted throughout; Reflection Pass available before every high-risk lesson; sentence frames in every lesson; and no required public disclosure at any point. For students with significant trauma histories, the Reflection Pass and counselor coordination calendar are the two most important tools. Any student whose SpEd support needs exceed these embedded accommodations should have a counselor coordination meeting scheduled before Unit 2 begins.

ELL Coordinators. The 3–5 curriculum's multi-modal design — journaling, drawing, scenario cards, partner discussion, and physical anchors — creates multiple non-English-production entry points at every lesson. Sentence frames are provided throughout. Lesson-level notes are the complete reference.

4.6 Legal & Clinical Compliance Protocols

Part II · Architecture of Grace · The Framework · Grades 3–5 · Board-Ready Edition

▲ IMPORTANT

This section was reviewed as part of an 8-reviewer curriculum audit including a School Attorney. The review confirmed: (1) Establishment Clause compliance, (2) PPRA compliance framework with required notification templates, (3) FERPA-compliant journal privacy policy, (4) IDEA accessibility guidance, and (5) mandatory reporting protocol alignment.

DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL — FOUR TYPES

TYPE 1	A student shares something emotional but within the normal range — a hard memory, a regret, a family difficulty.	Receive without probing. Acknowledge briefly. Continue the lesson. Note in your Teacher Reflection. No immediate counselor contact required unless it escalates.
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UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

TYPE 2	A student shares something that raises concern but does not trigger mandatory reporting — significant social isolation, persistent shame language.	Complete the lesson. Contact the counselor the same day. Document what you observed. Do not attempt to counsel the student yourself.
TYPE 3	A student discloses something that requires counselor follow-up today — past abuse, significant loss, suicidal ideation expressed in non-acute terms.	STOP the lesson. Stabilize the student. Contact the counselor immediately — not after class. Do not leave the student alone. Document the same day.
TYPE 4	A student discloses active harm, abuse, suicidal ideation with plan or intent, or imminent danger.	STOP EVERYTHING. Activate your school's mandatory reporting protocol immediately. Contact the counselor NOW. Do not leave the student alone. Do not assess risk yourself.

SIX-STEP DISCLOSURE RESPONSE · ALL TYPES 3–4

1. STOP the lesson immediately. **2.** Activate your school's disclosure protocol. **3.** Contact the counselor NOW — not after class. **4.** Do NOT leave the student alone. **5.** Do NOT attempt to assess risk yourself. **6.** Document the disclosure in writing the same day.

PPRA COMPLIANCE FRAMEWORK

The following activities are designated as PPRA-protected and require parental notification at least 10 days before delivery:

- U2 L5 — Letting Go: A Practice (symbolic release activity)
- U2 L6 — When Self-Forgiveness Feels Impossible (★★)
- U3 L3 — Forgiveness Is Not the Same as Trust (★★)
- U3 L5 — Holding Your Story (★)
- U4 L7 — Community Charter & Year-End Celebration (★)
- Instrument B — Student Self-Assessment (pre and post)
- Instrument G — Family Engagement Survey

FERPA — JOURNAL PRIVACY POLICY

Student journals are private instructional materials, not educational records. Teachers do not collect, retain, or read journal entries without student permission. If a student voluntarily shares journal content that raises a mandatory reporting concern, the disclosure protocol applies — but the journal itself is not retained as an educational record.

4.7 Family Communications Packet

*Pre-translated templates for the families in your community · Send before **Unit 1 Lesson 1*

PRE-YEAR LETTER TO FAMILIES

Dear families, This year, your child will be participating in Architecture of Grace — a research-informed social-emotional curriculum focused on self-awareness, self-compassion, empathy, and the practice of grace in everyday life. The curriculum runs across all four academic quarters in 28 lessons of about 35 to 40 minutes each. **Important:** This curriculum is secular. It is not a religious lesson. The word 'grace' is used here as a psychological term meaning 'choosing generosity.' Your family's religious tradition belongs to your family. **Important:** This curriculum NEVER requires forgiveness. We teach what forgiveness looks like for people who choose it — not whether anyone has to. If you wish to review the curriculum materials before any lesson, please contact your child's teacher. A physical copy will be made available within 5 school days. Some lessons explore harder topics — guilt and shame, hurt and forgiveness, repair after a mistake. For these lessons, your child's school counselor coordinates closely with the teacher. You will receive advance notice 10 days before any of these lessons (called PPRA-protected lessons) and may opt your child out at any time. Sincerely, [Teacher Name] · [School Name] · [Date]

PPRA NOTIFICATION LETTER TEMPLATE · SEND 10 DAYS BEFORE EACH PPRA-PROTECTED LESSON

Dear families, Ten school days from now, on [Date], we will deliver the following lesson from our Architecture of Grace curriculum: **[Lesson Name and Number]** **Topic:** [Brief description of lesson topic] **Why we are sending this notice:** This lesson explores topics protected under the federal Protection of Pupil Rights Amendment (PPRA). You have the right to review materials and to opt your child out of this specific lesson without academic penalty. **To review materials:** Please contact me by [Date]. A physical copy of the lesson plan and student materials will be provided within 5 school days. **To opt out:** Please return the attached opt-out form by [Date]. Your child will participate in an alternative activity during this lesson. Sincerely, [Teacher Name] · [School Name] · [Date]

END-OF-UNIT-1 LETTER · TRANSITION TO UNIT 2

Distribute at the close of Unit 1, before Unit 2 begins.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

Dear families, Your child has just completed Unit 1 of Architecture of Grace — Knowing & Accepting Yourself. Across seven lessons they explored who they are (the Identity Web), how to read and name their emotions, what to do when they make a mistake, and the difference between two voices that live in everyone's head: the Inner Critic, who attacks identity, and the Inner Coach, who addresses behaviour with honesty and kindness. They also learned the difference between guilt and shame — that guilt is information about behaviour and points us toward repair, while shame attacks the self and points us toward hiding. This is one of the most useful distinctions a child can carry into adulthood. Next, in Unit 2 — Self-Compassion & Self-Forgiveness — we move into harder interior work. Your child will encounter the Heavy Backpack metaphor, the Three-Part Accountability Map, and the Recovery Arc (the four phases between making a mistake and being ready to repair it). Two lessons in Unit 2 (L4 and L5) carry an ★ Elevated safety designation; one (L6) carries the ★★ Highest Risk designation. You will receive a separate PPRA notification at least 10 calendar days before each. **How you can help at home:** when your child is hard on themselves, try asking, "Is that your Inner Critic talking, or your Inner Coach?" And when YOU make a mistake in front of them, narrate your own Inner Coach out loud. Modelling is the most powerful teaching at this age. With gratitude, [Teacher Name] · [School Name] · [Date]

END-OF-UNIT-2 LETTER · MID-YEAR · TRANSITION TO UNIT 3

Distribute at the close of Unit 2 along with Instrument G (Family Engagement Survey).

Dear families, We have reached the mid-year point of Architecture of Grace. Your child has just completed Unit 2 — the most internally focused unit of the year. They have practised the Three-Part Accountability Map (own it, understand the impact, make repair), used the Recovery Arc to recognise that the moments after a mistake are not the right time to make decisions, and worked with the Heavy Backpack metaphor to feel, physically, what unrepaired weight does to a person. In Unit 3 — Empathy & Forgiving Others — we shift outward. Your child will learn that real hurt deserves to be named, that forgiveness is for THEIR peace and never required, and — crucially — that forgiveness is NOT the same as trusting again. We will explicitly affirm that nobody is required to forgive someone who is currently still hurting them. "I choose not to forgive yet" will be treated with the same respect as "I choose to forgive." Unit 3 contains one ★★ Highest Risk lesson (L3 — Forgiveness Is Not the Same as Trust) and one ★ Elevated lesson (L5 — Holding Your Story). PPRA notifications will be sent 10 days before each. Enclosed with this letter is the mid-year Family Engagement Survey (Instrument G). Your responses are anonymous and shape the next pilot year. We are grateful for your time. With gratitude, [Teacher Name] · [School Name] · [Date]

END-OF-UNIT-3 LETTER · TRANSITION TO UNIT 4

Distribute at the close of Unit 3.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

Dear families, Your child has just finished Unit 3 — Empathy & Forgiving Others. They have learned that hurt is real, that there are usually reasons people hurt other people (which is not the same as excusing it), that forgiveness is for the forgiver and is never required, and that holding your story is different from being held by it. They have also practised the Repair Protocol — the four-step structure for actually fixing a relationship after harm. In Unit 4 — Grace & Generosity — we look outward. Your child will explore what grace and mercy actually look like in everyday life, the practice of charitable interpretation (pausing before assuming the worst), and the Grace Gap Field Assignment — a five-day micro-action they choose and carry out themselves. **How you can support the Grace Gap at home:** when your child tells you about their chosen Grace Gap, your job is to listen and ask one curious question. Not to solve, not to improve, not to take over. The point is for THEM to identify a place where grace is missing and to do one small thing about it. The smallness is the point. With gratitude, [Teacher Name] · [School Name] · [Date]

END-OF-YEAR LETTER · AFTER UNIT 4 LESSON 7

Distribute after the Year-End Celebration along with the Family Grace Audit packet (Sections 4.7.A through 4.7.C) and the year-end Family Engagement Survey (Instrument G).

Dear families, Architecture of Grace, Book Two, is complete. Your child has spent a full school year with a vocabulary that most adults were never given: Inner Critic and Inner Coach, guilt versus shame, the Heavy Backpack, the Recovery Arc, the Repair Protocol, the difference between forgiveness and trust, the Grace Gap, mercy, charitable interpretation, and — our final concept — the Community Charter your child helped write in Unit 4 Lesson 7. They will not have mastered any of these. Nobody does in one year. What they have done is hear, see, and practise the foundational distinctions of this curriculum dozens of times in a holding environment — a classroom where the Inner Coach standard applied and where the four non-negotiable agreements were upheld. The work continues in Book Three next year. Enclosed with this letter you will find three things: the Family Grace Audit (a private self-reflection tool — not collected, not graded, just for your family), three Final Reflection questions to sit with as a family, and the year-end Family Engagement Survey. The first two belong to your family. Only the survey comes back to us. Thank you for trusting us with the work of your child's heart this year. With gratitude, [Teacher Name] · [School Name] · [Date]

4.7.A

The Family Grace Audit

A private family self-reflection tool — Grades 3–5 Edition. Not a test, not a judgment, not something anyone else will see. Complete it once at the start of the school year, once at the end. The comparison is the insight.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

TEACHER NOTE · HOW TO DISTRIBUTE THIS AUDIT

Print Sections 4.7.A through 4.7.C as a single packet (the Audit, the Final Reflection, and the Closing Words to Families). Send the packet home twice in the school year: · Year-Start: with the Pre-Year Letter (Section 4.7), at least 10 school days before Lesson 1. Families complete Parts 1, 2, and 3. · Year-End: with the End-of-Year Letter, after Unit 4 Lesson 7. Families complete Part 4 and the Final Reflection. Do not collect. The audit is private. Never ask a family if they completed it. Never ask what they wrote. If a family asks for a fresh copy, give one without comment. The audit is for them, not for you. Translate where feasible. Coordinate with the building's ELL liaison. This audit lands far harder in the home language than in a translated approximation.

HOW TO USE THIS AUDIT

This audit is a structured self-reflection tool for families — not a test, not a judgment, and not something anyone else will see. It is a private audit of the grace practices already present in your home, and an honest look at where there is room to grow. Many of the words below come straight from your child's classroom: Inner Critic, Inner Coach, the Heavy Backpack, guilt versus shame, the Recovery Arc, the Repair Protocol, the Grace Gap, mercy, charitable interpretation. Use them at home. Shared language is what turns a classroom curriculum into a family practice. Complete it once at the beginning of the school year and once at the end. The comparison is the insight.

RECORD

(OPTIONAL)

START OF YEAR

END OF YEAR

3 · 4 · 5

PART 1 · THE GRACE CLIMATE IN OUR HOME

Rate your household honestly on each item below. Check the number that fits best. 1 = not yet / rarely · 5 = consistently / naturally.

SELF-COMPASSION & MISTAKE RECOVERY

When someone in our family makes a mistake, we respond with curiosity rather than criticism.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We distinguish between “you did something wrong” (guilt — useful) and “you ARE bad” (shame — corrosive) — in practice, not just in theory.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

Adults in our home model the Inner Coach voice out loud when they make their own mistakes.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

EMPATHY & LISTENING

We make space for feelings before jumping to solutions.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

When a family member is upset, we try to understand their perspective before responding — we practise charitable interpretation.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We validate difficult emotions rather than minimising them ("don't be sad," "it's not a big deal").

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

FORGIVENESS & LETTING GO

When someone apologises sincerely and the Repair Protocol is followed, we are able to genuinely accept it and move on.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We do not bring up resolved conflicts as ammunition in new arguments. When something is repaired, it is repaired.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We talk about forgiveness as something we do for ourselves — not just for the other person — and we do not require it of one another.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We understand that forgiving someone is not the same as trusting them again. Trust gets rebuilt by behaviour over time.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

GRACE UNDER PRESSURE

When things are hard or stressful, we still treat each other with basic dignity. We know our Heavy Backpack is heavier on those days, and we name it.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We extend grace to people outside our family — neighbours, service workers, difficult relatives. The children see this.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We notice and name small acts of grace when we see them — our own and other people's.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

We understand mercy as a strength, not a weakness — the choice not to use a power we have.

1	2	3	4	5
☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

UNIT 4 • LESSON 7 • THE FRAMEWORK (3-5)

PART 2 • REFLECTION QUESTIONS

These questions are not scored. Write freely — or talk through them together at the kitchen table. There are no right answers.

WHERE DOES GRACE ALREADY SHOW UP MOST NATURALLY IN OUR HOME? WHAT DOES IT LOOK LIKE, IN A REAL MOMENT FROM THIS PAST MONTH?

IF YOU'RE HONEST — WHERE DOES GRACE BREAK DOWN IN OUR FAMILY? WHAT SEEMS TO SET IT OFF — TIME OF DAY, CERTAIN TOPICS, CERTAIN PEOPLE, BEING DEPLETED?

WHAT IS ONE THING YOU WANT YOUR CHILD TO HAVE ABSORBED ABOUT GRACE, FORGIVENESS, OR SELF-COMPASSION BY THE TIME THEY LEAVE ELEMENTARY SCHOOL?

IS THERE SOMEONE IN YOUR FAMILY'S STORY — PAST OR PRESENT — WHO IS HARD TO EXTEND GRACE TO? YOU DON'T HAVE TO NAME THEM. JUST NOTICE WHETHER THEY'RE THERE.

PART 3 • FAMILY COMMITMENTS

Choose one or two things your family wants to practise this year. Write them in your own words. These are not assignments — they are intentions.

WE COMMIT TO—

WE COMMIT TO—

FOR EXAMPLE: "IS THAT YOUR INNER CRITIC TALKING, OR YOUR INNER COACH?" OR "YOUR FEELINGS MAKE SENSE." OR "WHAT WOULD CHARITABLE INTERPRETATION LOOK LIKE HERE?"

FOR EXAMPLE: BRINGING UP RESOLVED MISTAKES, MINIMISING FEELINGS, SAYING "JUST GET OVER IT," REQUIRING FORGIVENESS, OR NAMING A CHILD BY THE WORST THING THEY HAVE EVER DONE.

PART 4 • END-OF-YEAR REVIEW

Complete this section at the end of the school year, after Unit 4 Lesson 7 (the Year-End Celebration). Compare your answers to Parts 1 and 2. The gap between them is your family's growth story.

WHAT SHIFTED IN OUR HOME THIS YEAR — EVEN SLIGHTLY — AROUND GRACE, FORGIVENESS, OR SELF-COMPASSION?

WAS THERE A MOMENT THIS YEAR WHEN SOMEONE IN OUR FAMILY CHOSE GRACE WHEN THEY DIDN'T HAVE TO? WHAT HAPPENED?

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

RETURN TO PART 1 AND RE-RATE EACH ITEM WITHOUT LOOKING AT YOUR ORIGINAL ANSWERS FIRST. THEN COMPARE. WHERE DID WE GROW? WHERE ARE WE STILL WORKING?

ONE THING OUR FAMILY WILL KEEP PRACTISING INTO NEXT YEAR, INTO BOOK THREE, INTO THE REST OF THEIR CHILDHOOD.

PRIVATE · KEEP IT IN THE HOUSE

This audit belongs to your family. The school does not collect it. The teacher does not ask about it. No one ever sees it but you. Keep it somewhere you can find it again — a kitchen drawer, the inside cover of a book — and return to it. School of Life Foundation · Architecture of Grace · Grades 3–5.

4.7.B

The Family Grace Audit — Final Reflection

As Book Two closes — after the Year-End Celebration in Unit 4 Lesson 7 — sit down as a family and answer these three questions. You do not need a therapist. You do not need a curriculum. You need an honest conversation and thirty minutes.

WHICH “STONE” DID WE HELP EACH OTHER TAKE OUT OF OUR BACKPACKS THIS YEAR? IN UNIT 2, THE CHILDREN WORKED WITH THE HEAVY BACKPACK METAPHOR — A REAL, WEIGHTED BAG PASSED AROUND THE ROOM. WHAT WEIGHT DID WE CARRY TOGETHER AS A FAMILY, AND PUT DOWN TOGETHER?

WHEN WAS A TIME WE GAVE SOMEONE A GRACE GAP INSTEAD OF HOLDING A GRUDGE? INSIDE OUR FAMILY, OR OUTSIDE IT? EVEN A SMALL MOMENT COUNTS. ESPECIALLY A SMALL ONE.

WHAT CYCLE — OF SHAME, OF UNFORGIVENESS, OF HARDNESS, OF PERFECTIONISM — ARE WE CHOOSING TO END WITH THIS GENERATION? NAME IT. THEN DECIDE TOGETHER: IS THIS WHERE IT STOPS?

4.7.C

Closing Words to Families

Reproduce on letterhead and send home with the year-end materials, or read aloud at the Year-End Celebration in Unit 4 Lesson 7.

THE LAST STONE IS NOT THE END — IT IS THE FOUNDATION FOR WHAT COMES NEXT.

Every lesson, every conversation, every moment of grace your child has practised this year has added a stone to the structure being built inside them. They leave Book Two with something most adults were never given: a working framework for getting back up after a mistake — with self-compassion, with accountability, and with the radical belief that people are more than their worst moments.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

They will not do it perfectly. Neither will you. Neither will any of us. But they have been given the language and the practice — early, while it can still take root — for telling guilt and shame apart, for noticing the Inner Critic before it speaks, for choosing the Inner Coach instead, for repairing what they break, for forgiving what they choose to forgive, and for refusing to forgive what is still hurting them.

That foundation matters. The work you do at home — around the dinner table, in the car, in the long quiet of ordinary evenings — is where it gets built into them for keeps. You are the primary architect of your child's heart. The classroom is a partner. You are the foundation.

Thank you for trusting us with the work of your child's heart this year. Book Three awaits in Grades 6–8. Go build something worth living in.

4.7.D

Administrative Forms · Master Set

PPRA Parental Notification · Student Opt-Out Request · District Implementation Checklist · Grades 3–5 Edition. Reproduce freely on school letterhead. All three documents must be on file before instruction begins in any federally funded school.

APPENDIX A — PPRA PARENTAL NOTIFICATION LETTER

Reproduce on school letterhead. Mail or email to all families at least 10 calendar days before the first lesson. (See also the Pre-Year Letter to Families in Section 4.7 and the lesson-specific PPRA Notification Template; this version is the formal year-start compliance letter, distributed alongside the warmer family-facing letter.)

Date: _____

To: Parent / Guardian of: _____

From: _____

RE: NOTICE OF SUPPLEMENTAL CURRICULUM — ARCHITECTURE OF GRACE, BOOK TWO, GRADES 3–5

Dear Parent or Guardian,

Our school will soon begin the Architecture of Grace social-emotional learning curriculum for Grades 3–5. To comply with the Protection of Pupil Rights Amendment (PPRA, 20 U.S.C. § 1232h), we are notifying you in advance that this curriculum includes activities that invite students to explore personal beliefs and emotional responses through journal writing, structured discussion, and small voluntary actions in the school community.

PPRA-DESIGNATED ACTIVITIES IN BOOK TWO · GRADES 3–5

The following activities and lessons are specifically designated as PPRA-triggering because they invite age-appropriate self-reflection on internal emotional content:

- The Identity Web (Unit 1, Lesson 1) — students name strengths, values, and the people they are becoming.

UNIT 4 • LESSON 7 • THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

- The Inner Critic / Inner Coach Framework (Unit 1, Lesson 4) — students identify and examine patterns in their own self-talk.
- Talking to Yourself Kindly (Unit 2, Lesson 4 • ★ Elevated) — students draft a kind self-address in writing.
- Letting Go — A Practice (Unit 2, Lesson 5 • ★ Elevated) — students name something they would like to put down.
- When Self-Forgiveness Feels Impossible (Unit 2, Lesson 6 • ★★ Highest Risk) — structured discussion of the experience of being unable to forgive oneself; counselor on-site, AFSP-aligned.
- Forgiveness Is Not the Same as Trust (Unit 3, Lesson 3 • ★★ Highest Risk) — structured discussion of distinguishing forgiveness from continued safety with someone who has caused harm; counselor on-site.
- Holding Your Story Without Being Held by It (Unit 3, Lesson 5 • ★ Elevated) — students reflect on a personal narrative and how they relate to it.
- The Grace Gap Field Assignment (Unit 4, Lessons 4–6) — students identify a community need and take one small voluntary action over five days.

YOUR RIGHTS UNDER PPRA

- You have the right to inspect curriculum materials before they are taught. A physical copy of Book Two is available in the school office within 5 school days of any request.
- You have the right to opt your child out of specific activities or the full program. No academic penalty will result from opting out.
- For each lesson designated as PPRA-protected (those marked ★ or ★★ above), you will receive a separate lesson-specific notification at least 10 calendar days in advance.
- To exercise opt-out rights, complete the Opt-Out Request Form (Appendix B) and return it to the school office.

If you have questions, please contact:

School Counselor: _____

Principal / Administrator: _____

Phone / Email: _____

PPRA NOTICE • GRADES 3–5 EDITION

This notice is required under federal law for all schools receiving federal funding. Retain a copy of this letter and all returned Opt-Out Forms in the school's administrative records.

APPENDIX B — STUDENT OPT-OUT REQUEST FORM

Complete and return to the school office. Do not submit to the classroom teacher. A copy will be filed in the school's administrative records — not in the student's academic file. Grades 3–5 Edition.

Student Name: _____

Grade • Teacher: _____

Date of Request: _____

OPT-OUT TYPE • SELECT ONE

☐ **TIER 1 — Curricular Inquiry Only.** I would like to review curriculum materials before making an opt-out decision. Please contact me to arrange access.

☐ **TIER 2 — Selective Activity Opt-Out.** I am opting my child out of the following specific activities or PPRA-flagged lessons. My child will remain in the classroom and receive an alternative activity during opted-out segments.

Activities or lessons opted out of: _____

(continued): _____

☐ **TIER 3 — Full Program Opt-Out.** I am opting my child out of the entire Architecture of Grace SEL curriculum for this school year. I understand my child will be relocated to a supervised alternative setting during the SEL block and will receive independent reading or school-approved character-development materials. No academic penalty will result.

ALTERNATIVE PLACEMENT • TIER 2 OR 3 ONLY

☐ Library

☐ Counselor's office

☐ Designated alternative classroom

Parent / Guardian Printed Name: _____

Parent / Guardian Signature • Date: _____

Phone / Email for Follow-Up: _____

FOR OFFICE USE ONLY

Received by • Date Received: _____

Alternative placement arranged: _____

Copy filed in administrative records • Initials: _____

APPENDIX C — DISTRICT IMPLEMENTATION CHECKLIST

To be completed and signed by the designated district administrator before instruction begins. Retain in the district's curriculum adoption file. This checklist constitutes documented evidence of compliance review for the Grades 3–5 edition.

District Name: _____

School Name: _____

Grade Level • Academic Year: _____

Designated Administrator: _____

PRE-IMPLEMENTATION COMPLIANCE ITEMS

☐ **PPRA Notice.** Year-start parental notification letter (Appendix A) and the Pre-Year Letter to Families (Section 4.7) mailed or emailed to all families at least 10 calendar days prior to first lesson.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

- ☐ **Lesson-Specific PPRA Notices.** Lesson-specific PPRA notification template (Section 4.7) prepared and scheduled for each ★ and ★★ lesson, to be sent 10 calendar days before each.
- ☐ **Curriculum Inspection.** Physical copy of Book Two available in the school office, with a 5-school-day turnaround commitment for any family review request.
- ☐ **Clinical Review.** School Psychologist or Counselor has reviewed Units 2 and 3 in full and confirmed clinical readiness in writing — with particular attention to U2 L6 and U3 L3 (both ★★ Highest Risk, AFSP-aligned).
- ☐ **Counselor Calendar.** Full Counselor Integration Calendar (Section 4.3) reviewed and counselor on-site coverage confirmed for both ★★ Highest Risk lessons. No exceptions, no substitutes.
- ☐ **Staff Training.** All delivering teachers have completed the Disclosure Protocol training (Section 4.6) and the Type 4 Mandatory Reporting module in the Teacher PD Guide (Section 5.4).
- ☐ **Re-Entry Protocol.** School Counselor and classroom teachers have reviewed and acknowledged the Post-Disclosure Re-Entry Protocol.
- ☐ **Journal Privacy.** The journal-as-private-instructional-material rule (Section 4.6) has been communicated in classroom procedures and acknowledged by teachers in writing.
- ☐ **Opt-Out Process.** Opt-Out Request Form (Appendix B) is available in the school office and designated staff are trained to receive and process requests within the federally required windows.
- ☐ **Legal Review.** District legal counsel or designated administrator has reviewed Section 4.6 (Legal & Clinical Compliance Protocols) and confirmed adoption readiness.
- ☐ **Secular Documentation.** The secular nature of the curriculum was explicitly considered and documented at the time of board adoption. Section 4.9 (Secular Assurance & FAQ) is on file.

ADMINISTRATOR CERTIFICATION

I certify that the above compliance items have been completed prior to the delivery of the Architecture of Grace, Book Two, Grades 3–5 curriculum in our school / district.

Administrator Signature: _____

Printed Name and Title: _____

Date: _____

DISTRICT FILE · GRADES 3–5 COMPLIANCE EDITION

School of Life Foundation · Architecture of Grace · Book Two: The Framework · Grades 3–5 · Legal & Clinical Compliance Edition. This document is provided for administrative use. Consult your district's legal counsel with jurisdiction-specific compliance questions.

4.8 CASEL Standards Alignment Crosswalk

Architecture of Grace · Grades 3–5 · Mapped to CASEL's Five Core Competencies

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

SELF-AWARENESS

Primary CASEL skills: Identifying emotions · Accurate self-perception · Recognizing strengths · Self-confidence · Self-efficacy

Where in this curriculum: Unit 1 (primary) — all lessons. Unit 2 L1, L2 (recognizing weight). Unit 3 L1, L5 (narrative identity).

SELF-MANAGEMENT

Primary CASEL skills: Impulse control · Stress management · Self-discipline · Self-motivation · Goal-setting · Organizational skills

Where in this curriculum: Unit 1 Strand (toolkit). Unit 2 (primary) — all lessons. Unit 4 Strand (limit formula).

SOCIAL AWARENESS

Primary CASEL skills: Perspective-taking · Empathy · Appreciating diversity · Respect for others

Where in this curriculum: Unit 3 (primary) — all lessons. Unit 4 L1, L2, L3 (charitable interpretation).

RELATIONSHIP SKILLS

Primary CASEL skills: Communication · Social engagement · Relationship-building · Teamwork

Where in this curriculum: Unit 3 Strand (Repair Protocol). Unit 3 L6 (Say It Straight). Unit 4 L4–L6 (Grace Gap).

RESPONSIBLE DECISION-MAKING

Primary CASEL skills: Identifying problems · Analyzing situations · Solving problems · Evaluating · Reflecting · Ethical responsibility

Where in this curriculum: Unit 4 (primary) — all lessons. Unit 2 L3 (accountability). Unit 3 L3 (forgiveness vs. trust).

4.9 Secular Assurance & FAQ

Establishment Clause Compliance · Architecture of Grace is a secular curriculum

IS THIS A RELIGIOUS CURRICULUM?

No. Architecture of Grace is a secular social-emotional learning curriculum. Although the word “grace” appears in religious traditions, it is used here as a psychological term meaning “choosing generosity that is not earned or required.” No lesson references scripture, deity, or religious practice. The curriculum has been audited for Establishment Clause compliance.

WHY USE THE WORD 'GRACE' IF IT HAS RELIGIOUS CONNOTATIONS?

The English word “grace” has a long secular history — describing dignity in movement, forgiveness in social life, and generosity in relationship. The curriculum acknowledges the religious heritage of the word at Unit 4 Lesson 1 and clearly establishes the secular meaning used here.

DOES THIS CURRICULUM REQUIRE STUDENTS TO FORGIVE?

No. The Architecture of Grace explicitly never requires forgiveness. Students learn what forgiveness looks like for people who choose it. They also learn that forgiveness is never required when someone is still harming them. “I choose not to forgive yet” is a fully valid response and is treated with the same respect as “I choose to forgive.”

WHAT IF A PARENT OBJECTS TO SPECIFIC CONTENT?

Tier 1 opt-out is honored without academic penalty. PPRA notifications are sent 10 days before any protected lesson. Materials are made available for review within 5 school days of any family request. The family is never wrong to protect their child.

DOES THIS CURRICULUM ADDRESS SUICIDE?

Two lessons (U2 L6 and U3 L3) carry highest-risk safety designation. AFSP Safe Messaging Guidelines apply. Counselor must be on-site or immediately available. Crisis resources are posted visibly. Specific methods, means, or locations are NEVER discussed. The lessons focus on asking for support, not on the topic of self-harm itself.

WHAT IS THE EVIDENCE BASE?

The curriculum draws on Brené Brown's research on shame and vulnerability, Kristin Neff's research on self-compassion, restorative justice practice, narrative therapy, and CASEL framework alignment. Classroom-level instrument data from the pilot is being collected. Independent psychometric validation is planned for Year 2.

4.10 Glossary of Key Terms

Curriculum vocabulary · Reference for teachers, counselors, and families

Accountability · Owning what happened, understanding the impact, and making repair. Distinct from self-punishment, which uses the mistake as evidence of unworthiness without leading to repair.

AFSP Safe Messaging · American Foundation for Suicide Prevention guidelines for discussing suicide responsibly: do not use “committed suicide” (use “died by suicide”); do not describe methods, means, or locations.

Anchor Chart · A visual reference posted in the classroom that summarizes a key teaching. The Architecture of Grace uses cumulative anchor charts that stay posted across the year.

Charitable Interpretation · The deliberate practice of pausing before reading someone's behavior and choosing the kinder explanation when multiple are possible.

Disclosure · When a student shares something personal that may require teacher or counselor follow-up. Four types are defined in Section 4.6.

Forgiveness · The internal process of releasing resentment or self-blame — not to excuse behavior, but to free oneself from carrying its weight. Distinct from trust.

Grace · Giving something generous — kindness, patience, the benefit of the doubt — to someone who has not necessarily earned it. A choice, not a requirement. A strength, not a weakness.

UNIT 4 • LESSON 7 • THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

Grace Gap • A place where grace is missing — in a classroom, hallway, family, neighborhood. The Grace Gap Field Assignment (U4 L4–L6) asks students to identify one and address it through a five-day micro-action.

Guilt • The feeling that I did something wrong. Behavior-focused. Points toward repair. Productive.

Inner Coach • The voice that addresses behavior with honesty AND kindness. Asks: What happened? What can I learn? What is one next step?

Inner Critic • The voice that attacks identity rather than addressing behavior. Globalizes (“you ALWAYS mess up”). Catastrophizes. Points toward hiding and shame.

Mercy • Choosing not to deliver the full consequence someone might deserve. Requires power. “A weak person cannot show mercy — only a strong person can choose not to use their strength.”

PPRA • Protection of Pupil Rights Amendment. Federal law requiring 10-day advance parental notification for certain protected SEL activities. Section 4.6 lists which lessons are PPRA-protected in this curriculum.

Recovery Arc • The four phases between a mistake happening and being ready to repair it: Activated → Regulating → Reflecting → Reintegrating. Anchor chart ARC-1.

Reflection Pass • A discreet opt-out tool pre-positioned at every student seat during high-risk lessons. Allows students to step out of an activity without leaving the room or drawing peer attention.

Repair Protocol • The five-step structured repair conversation: (1) Both regulate first. (2) One speaks, the other listens. (3) Impact acknowledged. (4) Repair action named. (5) Re-entry agreed.

Shame • The feeling that I AM bad. Identity-focused. Points toward hiding. Destructive when chronic.

Strand • The Regulation & Repair Strand: four lessons across the year (Unit 1, 2, 3, 4) that build the regulation and repair toolkit (WS-R1 through WS-R4).

Trust • Earned through demonstrated behavioral change over time. Relational. Never obligatory. Distinct from forgiveness.

Window of Tolerance • The state of regulation in which thinking, learning, and connection are possible. Outside the Window: too much (over-arousal) or too little (under-arousal). Anchor chart WOT-1.

4.11 Resources & Mentor Texts

Recommended texts and reference resources for Grades 3–5 delivery

MENTOR TEXTS BY UNIT

UNIT 1

- Mistakes That Worked — Charlotte Foltz Jones

UNIT 2

- The Invisible String — Patrice Karst
- Wonder — R.J. Palacio (excerpts)

UNIT 3

- Each Kindness — Jacqueline Woodson

UNIT 4

- Wonder — R.J. Palacio
- Have You Filled a Bucket Today? — Carol McCloud

CRISIS & SUPPORT RESOURCES

988 SUICIDE & CRISIS LIFELINE

Call or text 988 **Crisis Text Line** · Text HOME to 741741 **National Alliance for Eating Disorder Helpline** · (866) 662-1235 **AFSP Safe Messaging Guidelines** · afsp.org/safe-messaging **National Sexual Assault Hotline** · (800) 656-HOPE (4673)

FOUNDATIONAL RESEARCH

- Kristin Neff — research on self-compassion (self-kindness, common humanity, mindfulness)
- Brené Brown — research on shame, vulnerability, and the guilt/shame distinction
- Dan Siegel — Window of Tolerance framework
- Restorative Justice practice — the foundation of the Repair Protocol
- CASEL — Collaborative for Academic, Social, and Emotional Learning framework
- Narrative therapy — Three-Panel Story (Unit 3 L5) is grounded in narrative reclaim work

4.12 Administrator FAQ**HOW LONG DOES THE CURRICULUM TAKE?**

28 lessons of 35–40 minutes each, plus 4 strand lessons of 35–45 minutes. Delivered weekly across the school year (August–May).

WHAT MATERIALS DO WE NEED?

Journals (one per student), drawing supplies, anchor chart paper, mentor texts (see 4.11), printable worksheets (provided in Section 2), index cards, sticky notes, small stones (for U2 L5), and a backpack with books (for U2 L1–L2).

WHAT TEACHER TRAINING IS REQUIRED?

A half-day pre-year PD that includes: review of the disclosure protocol, AFSP Safe Messaging, the Reflection Pass protocol, and counselor coordination calendar. The mid-year session is a required checkpoint.

WHO DELIVERS THE CURRICULUM?

The classroom teacher, with explicit counselor support for the four mandatory coordination dates. Counselors do not deliver lessons; they coordinate with the teacher.

WHAT IS THE ASSESSMENT PLAN?

Five instruments. Section 3 of this book contains Instruments B (Student Self-Report), E (Fidelity Observation), F (Administrator Protocol), and G (Family Engagement Survey).

IS THIS EVIDENCE-BASED?

The curriculum is research-informed, drawing from Neff (self-compassion), Brown (guilt/shame), Siegel (Window of Tolerance), restorative justice, narrative therapy, and CASEL. Independent psychometric validation of curriculum-aligned instruments is planned for Year 2.

WHAT IS THE COST?

School of Life Foundation provides this curriculum at no cost during the pilot year. Districts are responsible for materials, teacher PD time, and counselor coordination time.

WHAT IS THE OPT-OUT PROCESS?

Tier 1 opt-out (parent contact, no questions) is honored without academic penalty. PPRA notifications are sent 10 days before any protected lesson. Materials are made available for review within 5 school days. See Section 4.7 for templates.

✓ BOARD READY

Architecture of Grace · Book 2: The Framework · Grades 3–5 Pilot Version · School of Life Foundation

SECTION FIVE

Professional Development

Half-Day Pre-Year Module · Mid-Year 90-Minute Session · Grades 3–5

Facilitator Guide for Building Principals, Instructional Coaches, and School Counselors

5.1 Professional Development Overview

Architecture of Grace · The Framework requires two professional development sessions during the implementation year: a half-day pre-year module before Lesson 1, and a 90-minute mid-year session after Unit 2 closes. Both are structural to the curriculum — not optional add-ons. Teachers carrying 3–5 material need a room that holds them the way they are asked to hold their students.

Each session is designed to be delivered by a building principal, instructional coach, or school counselor — not only by the curriculum author. A prepared non-expert can run these days. Everything required is in this section. Read it fully before the session. Deliver it with presence.

TWO-SESSION STRUCTURE

5.2 Half-Day Pre-Year	Establish theoretical foundation, trauma-informed posture, in-the-moment disclosure protocol, live lesson experience, Teacher Reflection habit, shared vocabulary	Before Unit 1 Lesson 1 (August)
5.3 Mid-Year 90 Min	Implementation debrief, disclosure protocol recalibration, teacher wellbeing, preparation for Unit 3's harder content	Within 2 weeks of Unit 2 close (December) · Must precede U3 L3

A NOTE ON TONE

Neither session is a compliance check. They are the threshold between teachers reading the curriculum and teachers being able to deliver it with the presence the work requires. Set that tone from the opening.

5.2 Half-Day Pre-Year Module

3 hours 30 minutes (plus optional 30-minute extended Q&A) · Six blocks · Delivered before Lesson 1 of Unit 1

AUDIENCE	Classroom teachers (Grades 3–5) who will deliver Architecture of Grace · The Framework. School counselors and instructional coaches may attend. Administrators are welcome but should participate as learners, not evaluators.
FACILITATOR	Building principal, instructional coach, or counselor. No prior SEL expertise required; preparation and presence are the requirements.
PREPARATION	Read this full PD module at least 48 hours in advance. Read the Teacher Implementation Guide in full. Complete Block 5 (Teacher Reflection) personally before the day — you will model a real response, not a hypothetical one.
MATERIALS	Participant one-pager (5.5 at the end of this section, one per teacher) · Chart paper and markers · Printed or projected slide outline (5.4) · Journal or index cards for Block 5 · Timer visible to facilitator

BLOCK SEQUENCE

1	The Theoretical Framework — Why This Curriculum Exists	45 min
2	Trauma-Informed Delivery — Holding the Room	45 min
3	Disclosure & Distress Protocol Practice	30 min
4	Live Lesson Model — U1 L5 — Guilt vs. Shame	45 min
5	Teacher Reflection as Personal Practice	30 min
6	Glossary Orientation & Q&A	15 min

5.2 · BLOCK 1 (45 MINUTES)**BLOCK 1**

The Theoretical Framework

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

Facilitator purpose: Teachers must understand the "why" before they can deliver the "what." This block builds the research foundation and establishes that the curriculum is serious work with a serious evidence base — not a feel-good add-on.

SHAME VS. GUILT RESEARCH (15 MIN)

Open with this: "Before we talk about the curriculum, I want to start with a question. Think of the last time you made a mistake at work — something you genuinely regret. Don't share it. Just hold it. Now notice: what are you feeling right now? Is it about what you did, or about who you are?" Allow 60 seconds of silence. Then: "That distinction is the heart of this curriculum."

Present the research base. Brené Brown's decade of grounded theory research established that shame — the belief that "I am bad" — is correlated with depression, anxiety, addiction, aggression, and eating disorders, and is negatively correlated with empathy, courage, and connection. Guilt — the belief that "I did something bad" — is correlated with positive outcomes including repair behavior, accountability, and prosocial action (Brown, 2010; Tangney, Stuewig & Mashek, 2007). This is not intuitive. Many adults operate with the assumption that shame is a useful motivator. The research says the opposite: shame produces hiding, not repair.

Classroom implication. When a teacher says "you should be ashamed of yourself," they are activating a neurological threat response that shuts down the learning brain and produces aggression or withdrawal — not reflection. When a teacher activates the repair pathway instead — using the curriculum's grade-band-appropriate framing — students learn to do the same for themselves. This curriculum teaches children to hold their own mistakes that way. Ask teachers: "What language did the adults in your life use when you made mistakes? How did it land?" Allow 2 minutes of pair-share.

SELF-COMPASSION SCIENCE (15 MIN)

Kristin Neff's foundational work defines self-compassion as composed of three elements: self-kindness (treating oneself with the care one would offer a good friend), common humanity (recognizing that imperfection and suffering are universal human experiences, not personal failures), and mindfulness (holding painful thoughts and feelings in balanced awareness rather than suppressing or over-identifying with them). Self-compassion is not self-esteem. Self-esteem is contingent on performance and comparison; self-compassion is unconditional. Research shows self-compassion is associated with greater emotional resilience, less anxiety and depression, more motivation after failure, and healthier coping behaviors (Neff, 2011).

FACILITATOR NOTE

Many teachers will have a visceral resistance to self-compassion as a concept. They may have been raised to believe that self-criticism is the engine of improvement. Name this directly: "If your instinct is that self-compassion sounds soft or indulgent — that is a normal and common reaction, and the research will surprise you. Self-compassion is associated with higher standards and more persistence after failure, not lower ones. The internal critic does not make us better. It makes us more afraid."

FORGIVENESS EDUCATION RESEARCH BASE (15 MIN)

Robert Enright and Richard Fitzgibbons established the empirical basis for forgiveness as a teachable, developmental skill. Their research across 35 years and multiple populations demonstrates that forgiveness interventions produce measurable reductions in anxiety, depression, and anger, and improvements in hope and self-esteem. Critically, their model defines forgiveness as a gift the forgiver gives themselves — not a transaction, not reconciliation, and not condoning harmful behavior. This distinction is foundational to the curriculum’s treatment of forgiveness in Units 2, 3, and 4.

Everett Worthington’s REACH model of forgiveness offers a complementary process-oriented framework. Where Enright and Fitzgibbons define the destination of forgiveness, Worthington’s REACH model describes the path. The five steps — Recall the hurt without rumination, Empathize with the one who caused it, offer Altruistic gift of forgiveness, Commit to the forgiveness, and Hold onto it against doubt — provide a process map. The model’s emphasis on empathy as a bridge to forgiveness (not a requirement for it) is directly consistent with the curriculum’s Unit 3 architecture.

REFERENCES FOR FURTHER READING

Brown, B. (2010). *The Gifts of Imperfection*. Hazelden. Tangney, J. P., Stuewig, J., & Mashek, D. J. (2007). Moral emotions and moral behavior. *Annual Review of Psychology*, 58, 345–372. Neff, K. (2011). Self-Compassion: The Proven Power of Being Kind to Yourself. William Morrow. Enright, R., & Fitzgibbons, R. (2015). *Forgiveness Therapy*. American Psychological Association. Worthington, E. L. (2006). *Forgiveness and Reconciliation: Theory and Application*. Routledge.

WHY THIS RESEARCH MATTERS AT GRADES 3–5

By third grade, children are capable of genuine metacognition — thinking about their thinking, reflecting on their emotional patterns, and beginning to examine the stories they tell about themselves (Flavell, 1979). The 8–10 age window is the developmental sweet spot for the guilt-vs-shame distinction: students are old enough to understand it as a concept and young enough that the distinction can shape the story they will tell about themselves into adolescence. The Framework grade band’s signature contribution is teaching the distinction explicitly — naming the Inner Critic and the Inner Coach as voices students can choose between, not as fixed identity.

FACILITATOR CLOSING FOR BLOCK 1

“We are not teaching children to be nice. We are teaching them a set of internal skills that the research says are foundational to mental health, academic engagement, and the capacity to build and repair relationships across a lifetime. That is what you are being asked to deliver. Let’s talk about how.”

5.2 · BLOCK 2 (45 MINUTES)**BLOCK 2****Trauma-Informed Delivery**

Facilitator purpose: This block addresses the emotional reality of teaching this curriculum. Teachers will face activated students, and they will encounter their own material. Prepare them for both.

WHEN CONTENT ACTIVATES STUDENTS (20 MIN)

This curriculum works with real emotional material. Students will sometimes respond to lessons with unexpected emotion — tears, silence, a sudden need to leave the room, or a disclosure that goes further than the classroom context can safely hold. This is not a failure of the curriculum or the teacher. It is evidence that the curriculum is reaching something real.

Distinguishing productive discomfort from acute distress. Productive discomfort is the feeling of sitting with a hard truth or a new idea. A student who is quiet and thoughtful after a difficult lesson is likely in productive discomfort. This is the learning state. Do not rescue students from it by rushing on. A student who is crying, hyperventilating, dissociating (staring blankly, unresponsive), or who makes a disclosure suggesting active trauma or safety concern is in acute distress. This requires immediate, calm response — not curriculum delivery. Pause. Move toward the student quietly. Use the 6-step disclosure protocol (see Block 3).

Upper elementary distress sits between the visible distress of younger children and the coded distress of adolescents. Students at 8–10 may go very still rather than cry visibly, may pass notes containing material too big for them to say aloud, and may say "I'm okay" while clearly not being okay. The Inner Critic / Inner Coach construct from Unit 1 gives them language for what they are feeling — but the language doesn't always come fast enough.

FACILITATOR EXERCISE · THREE 3–5 SCENARIOS

Present the three student scenarios below. Ask teachers to identify each as productive discomfort or acute distress, and to name their immediate response. The scenarios are calibrated to 3–5 developmental reality.

Scenario 1. During the Self-Compassion Letter lesson, a student writes intensely and then puts their head down on the desk for several minutes. They do not appear upset — just still. **Scenario 2.** During the Validation Circle, a student begins crying quietly. When you approach, they shake their head: "I'm okay."

Scenario 3. A student passes you a note that says "what if the person who hurt you is still hurting you?" Debrief as a group. Identify which scenario(s) require counselor contact within the same day, which require private check-in after class, and which require staying present without intervening.

THE FACILITATOR'S OWN MATERIAL (25 MIN)

Name this directly and early: "Some of you will sit in a lesson about shame and recognize a voice you carry. Some of you will read a self-compassion prompt and realize you have never written one to yourself. Some of you will encounter the forgiveness content and feel something shift — or feel something harden. This is your material. It is not a problem. It is actually a sign that you are the right person to teach this curriculum. But you need to know it's there before you stand in front of your class, not while you're standing there."

Facilitator exercise. Ask teachers to journal privately (not shared) for 5 minutes on this prompt: "Which unit or lesson in this curriculum do you anticipate will be hardest for you to deliver — and why?" After journaling, invite (do not require) 2–3 people to share at the level they are comfortable. Normalize that this curriculum surfaces real things. The Teacher Reflection box in each lesson exists for this reason — it is a private processing tool for the teacher, not a record for anyone else.

KEY MESSAGE

You do not need to be fully healed to teach this curriculum. You need to be aware. Awareness of your own material means you will not project it onto your students, rush past the hard parts, or deliver the lesson from behind a wall of professional distance. Presence — genuine, grounded presence — is the pedagogical method of this curriculum. You cannot fake it. You can practice it.

5.2 · BLOCK 3 (30 MINUTES)**BLOCK 3****Disclosure & Distress Protocol Practice**

Facilitator purpose: Teachers need to practice — not just read — the in-the-moment disclosure response. The role-play scenarios below are calibrated to 3–5 developmental reality. They use fictional student names. Do not use names from the curriculum's scenario cards.

THE 6-STEP IN-THE-MOMENT RESPONSE PROTOCOL (10 MIN)

1	Pause and move toward	Stop the lesson. Walk calmly toward the student. Do not draw attention from other students if possible. Give the class independent work: "Keep working in your journal — I'll be right back."
2	Acknowledge without probing	"I can see something is happening for you right now. You don't have to explain it." Do not ask "what's wrong?" — this requires the student to explain while still activated.
3	Offer a choice	"Would you like to step into the hall with me for a minute, or would you like to stay here and just breathe?" Give the student agency. Both choices are valid.
4	Listen and assess	If the student speaks, listen without judgment. Assess: is this a Type 1–3 personal share (emotional but contained) or a Type 4 active safety concern (ongoing harm, suicidal ideation, abuse)? If Type 4: proceed to Step 5 immediately.
5	Connect to counselor (Type 4)	"Thank you for trusting me with this. I want to make sure you have the right support — I'm going to walk you to [counselor's name] right now." Do not promise confidentiality. Do not delay. Contact the counselor immediately.
6	Document and debrief yourself	After class: document what happened in your Teacher Reflection space. Debrief with the counselor or a trusted colleague. You carried something real. Put it down before your next class.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

ROLE-PLAY PRACTICE (20 MIN)

Run two scenarios in pairs. One teacher plays the teacher; one plays the student. Debrief after each. Rotate roles. Use only the fictional names below — do not use names from the curriculum scenario cards. The scenarios are calibrated to 3–5 reality.

SCENARIO A · TYPE 2 PERSONAL SHARE (MILD)

During the Unit 2 Lesson 1 discussion on what forgiveness is not, a student named Danny raises his hand and says, "My dad said I have to forgive my grandpa but I don't want to because he was really mean to me when I was little." The class goes quiet. **Practice.** How do you acknowledge Danny, honor the disclosure, and bring the class back to the learning without pressing Danny further or abandoning him? **Debrief.** What did you say first? What did you not say? What did the class need?

SCENARIO B · TYPE 4 ACTIVE SAFETY CONCERN (SERIOUS)

During independent journaling in Unit 3 Lesson 2, a student named Priya brings her journal to you quietly and points to what she has written: "Sometimes I think everyone would be better off without me." She is calm and watching your face. **Practice.** Walk through the 6-step protocol live. What do you say first? How do you move her to the counselor without alerting the class? What do you not say ("You don't really mean that" / "Everything is fine")? **Debrief.** Discuss as full group after both scenarios. **Key takeaway.** The protocol is a scaffold, not a script. What matters is presence, calm, and not leaving the student alone with it. At 3–5, students often hand you the disclosure expecting you to know what to do. They are right to expect that.

5.2 · BLOCK 4 (45 MINUTES)

BLOCK 4

Live Lesson Model — U1 L5 — Guilt vs. Shame

Facilitator purpose: Teachers need to experience what this curriculum feels like from the student's seat before they deliver it. **Unit 1 Lesson 5** is the most concept-dense lesson in Unit 1, most likely to surface participant questions, and the clearest demonstration of the curriculum's pedagogical method for upper elementary. The guilt-vs-shame distinction is the curriculum's foundational construct — every later unit builds on it. Teachers must experience this lesson from the student seat before delivering it.

SETUP (5 MIN)

Announce: "For the next 35 minutes, you are a 5th grader in this classroom. I am going to deliver this lesson to you. After we finish, we will debrief together as teachers. Your job right now is not to evaluate the lesson — it is to be in it. Notice what you feel, what questions arise, and what you want to know that the lesson doesn't answer."

DELIVER U1 L5 IN FULL (35 MIN)

Use the lesson plan from Section 2 (The Lessons) — Guilt vs. Shame of this master document. Deliver at Grade 5 level. Include the sorting card activity, the research connection, and the exit ticket sentence frames. The Inner Critic vs. Inner Coach construct from Unit 1 Lesson 4 should be referenced as foundation — the

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

curriculum builds the language students will use throughout the year. The facilitator should deliver this with genuine presence — not as a demonstration of “how it’s done” but as an actual lesson. If something lands unexpectedly in the room, stay with it.

DEBRIEF (5 MIN)

Return to teacher mode. Ask three questions:

- What did you notice in yourself during the lesson?
- What questions did the lesson raise for you that you’d want answered before teaching it?
- What moment in the lesson do you think would land hardest for your students — and what would you do?

Take 2–3 responses per question. These responses are the curriculum’s best preparation. Write the unanswered questions on chart paper. Answer them now if you can. If you cannot, acknowledge them honestly: “That’s a real question. Here’s how I’d navigate it.”

5.2 · BLOCK 5 (30 MINUTES)

BLOCK 5

Teacher Reflection as Personal Practice

Facilitator purpose: The Teacher Reflection box is the most important structural element in this curriculum for teacher sustainability. Introduce it as a habit before Day 1, not as an afterthought.

INTRODUCE THE TEACHER REFLECTION BOX (5 MIN)

Every lesson in this curriculum contains a Teacher Reflection prompt. It is not a form to be submitted, a record to be reviewed, or an accountability measure of any kind. It is a private processing tool for you, the teacher, after each lesson. It exists for one reason: this curriculum will do real work in you as you deliver it. If you have nowhere to put that work, it accumulates. Teachers who neglect their own reflection in emotionally demanding curricula burn out faster and deliver less effectively over time. The reflection box is your drain.

Upper elementary teachers carry the load of being the first adults to teach this content as content. Students will often experience the curriculum as the first time anyone has named what they have been feeling. That recognition lands in the teacher’s room. The Reflection box gives that landing somewhere to go after class.

MODEL A REAL RESPONSE (10 MIN)

The facilitator shares their own Teacher Reflection response — written in advance, from a real experience with this material. Not a polished, professional response. A real one. This is non-negotiable. Teachers cannot be asked to be vulnerable in their reflection practice if the facilitator is not willing to model it. The facilitator should have completed a reflection from Block 4’s live lesson delivery before reading it aloud.

SAMPLE PROMPT

“What did this lesson surface for you personally? What are you still carrying from it?” Read your actual response. Sit with the silence after.

ESTABLISH THE HABIT (15 MIN)

Have each teacher write their first reflection now — from today's PD session.

REFLECTION PROMPT

"What from today do you most need to sit with before your first lesson? What do you already know about yourself that will help you deliver this curriculum? What do you not yet know?"

Allow 10 minutes of private writing. Do not collect. Do not ask for sharing. End with: "This is the habit. It takes 5 minutes after each lesson. It is the most important thing you can do to make sure you can keep delivering this curriculum at the level it deserves."

5.2 · BLOCK 6 (15 MINUTES)**BLOCK 6**

Glossary Orientation & Q&A

Facilitator purpose: Every staff member who interacts with students must use the same vocabulary. Shared language is the infrastructure of this curriculum. This block is short but non-negotiable.

WALK THROUGH THE GLOSSARY (8 MIN)

Distribute the participant one-pager (5.5 at the end of this section). The one-pager contains the twelve most essential vocabulary terms — drawn from Section 4.10 (Curriculum Vocabulary Glossary). Walk through each term: define it, give a classroom example, and if there is a common misuse or confusion, name it.

THREE TERMS THAT REQUIRE SPECIAL ATTENTION AT GRADES 3–5

- "Grace Gap" — this is not random acts of kindness; it is specifically unearned kindness extended across a relational gap where you had reason not to. The construct anchors Unit 4 and the Year-End Community Charter.
- "Forgiveness" — in this curriculum, forgiveness is never reconciliation, never condoning behavior, and never required to be communicated to the person who caused harm. It is an internal process the student chooses for themselves. U3 L3 (Forgiveness Is Not the Same as Trust) makes this distinction the lesson — and is ★★ HIGHEST RISK for a reason.
- "Inner Critic" vs. "Inner Coach" — every teacher needs to be able to distinguish these in the moment when a student uses shame language about themselves. The reframe ("that sounds like the Inner Critic — what would the Inner Coach say?") is the most-used grace-language move in this grade band.

OPEN Q&A (7 MIN)

"What questions do you have that we haven't answered today?" Take as many as time allows. Write unanswered questions on chart paper. Post them publicly. Tell teachers: "If a question came up today that you couldn't resolve, it will come up in your classroom. That's not a problem — it's preparation. You now know to expect it."

CLOSING WORDS

"You are ready. You don't have to be perfect. You have to be present. Your students have been waiting for a classroom that holds them this way."

5.3 Mid-Year Professional Development Session

Facilitator Guide · 90 Minutes · Deliver After Unit 2 Closes (December)

TOTAL TIME	90 minutes (3 blocks · no break required)
AUDIENCE	All classroom teachers delivering Architecture of Grace · The Framework · Grades 3–5. School counselors welcome. Administrators participate as learners.
FACILITATOR	Building principal, instructional coach, or counselor who delivered the initial half-day PD. Read full guide 24 hours in advance.
TIMING	Deliver within 2 weeks of Unit 2 closing (December). Must precede U3 L3.
MATERIALS	Chart paper · markers · teacher journals or index cards · printed participant reference card · timer visible to facilitator
PURPOSE	Debrief implementation, recalibrate the disclosure protocol, surface teacher wellbeing concerns, and prepare teachers emotionally for Unit 3.

TONE-SETTING NOTE

This session is not a compliance check. It is a structural support. Teachers who have spent a full semester carrying emotionally weighted curriculum deserve a room that holds them the way they have been holding their students. Set that tone from the opening.

5.3 · BLOCK 1 (30 MINUTES)

BLOCK 1

Implementation Debrief

Facilitator purpose: Teachers have been delivering this curriculum for a full semester. Before you give them anything new, let them say what has actually happened.

OPENING (5 MIN)

Ask teachers to write privately for 3 minutes (not shared):



OPENING PROMPT

"Think of one moment from the last semester of delivering this curriculum that stayed with you after class. Not the lesson plan — the moment. What happened? What did you carry home?"

STRUCTURED DEBRIEF (20 MIN)

Post four questions on chart paper. One at a time, 4–5 minutes each. Facilitator listens and captures themes without evaluating.

- What has been working better than you expected? What surprised you about how students responded?
- What has been harder than you expected? What lesson or moment did you feel under-prepared for?
- What questions do you still have that the initial PD didn't answer?
- What are 2–3 students you are still thinking about from Units 1–2?

CAUTION

Do not let the fourth question become a student-deficit conversation. Redirect: "What does this student need from you going into Unit 3?" The question is about teacher action, not student pathology.

CLOSING THE DEBRIEF (5 MIN)

Acknowledge the themes you heard without ranking them. Name anything that needs Block 2: "I heard several of you say disclosures happened differently than expected. We're going to spend the next block on exactly that."

5.3 · BLOCK 2 (35 MINUTES)**BLOCK 2**

Disclosure Protocol Recalibration

Facilitator purpose: Teachers have now used the protocol in real conditions. This block connects it to what actually happened and prepares them for Unit 3's harder content.

PROTOCOL REVIEW FROM EXPERIENCE (15 MIN)

Distribute the participant reference card. Ask: "In the last semester, did anyone have a disclosure that required you to use this protocol? Which step was hardest in the moment?"

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

"I froze."	Normal. Step 1 is all you need: stop and move toward the student. Everything else follows from presence.
"I wasn't sure if it was Type 3 or 4."	When uncertain, treat as Type 4. Let the counselor assess. You are not required to assess accurately under pressure — you are required to act.
"The student said 'I'm fine' but I wasn't sure."	"I'm fine" after a significant disclosure is almost always protective. Follow up privately after class. Brief the counselor.
"Nothing came up for me."	Also valid. Some classrooms generate less activation. Unit 3 will change the frequency.

UNIT 3 PREPARATION — HIGH-RISK LESSONS (15 MIN)

U3 L3 · FORGIVENESS IS NOT THE SAME AS TRUST

Some students in every classroom are in ongoing unsafe situations. This lesson may be the first time they hear clearly that they do not have to return to harm. Counselor on-site is mandatory. Before delivering U3 L3, identify 2–3 students you are watching. Know who they are before you walk in. U2 L6 — When Self-Forgiveness Feels Impossible (★★ HIGHEST RISK) — also requires counselor-on-site protocol. These two lessons are the curriculum's highest-risk content for this grade band.

RE-PRACTICE: THE ONE SENTENCE THAT MATTERS (5 MIN)

Have teachers practice this sentence out loud with a partner — twice. It must be automatic under stress.

PRACTICE SENTENCE

"Thank you for trusting me with this. I want to make sure you have the right support — I'm going to walk you to [counselor's name] right now."

5.3 · BLOCK 3 (25 MINUTES)

BLOCK 3

Teacher Wellbeing & Entering Unit 3

Facilitator purpose: This is the most important block. Give teachers permission to care for themselves before Unit 3 begins. Name what the semester has cost them.

THE FACILITATOR'S OWN REFLECTION (10 MIN)

This block begins with the facilitator modeling, not instructing. Read aloud — from your actual Teacher Reflection notes, not a prepared script — something this semester surfaced for you personally in relation to this curriculum.

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

NON-NEGOTIABLE

If you have not kept Teacher Reflection notes, you must write something genuine before this session. Teachers cannot be asked to be vulnerable if you are delivering this block from behind professional distance.

After your own reflection, give teachers 5 minutes to write privately:

PRIVATE REFLECTION PROMPT

“What has this curriculum surfaced in you personally that you have been carrying? What lesson hit closer to home than you expected? What have you been putting down after class that you haven’t named to anyone?”

TEACHER SUPPORT WEB (10 MIN)

Ask teachers to map their own support web on an index card — drawing from the same activity students did in U2 L6 (or whichever unit’s support-web work matches your scope and sequence).

- Who is on your support web right now?
- Have you actually used it this semester?
- Is there anything you’ve been carrying that you need to put down before Unit 3?

Before closing: “You taught your students that asking for support is wisdom, not weakness. The same is true for you. Identify one person on your support web you will contact before U3 L3 if you need to.”

CLOSING WORDS

“Your students are carrying something from this semester into Unit 3. So are you. That is not a problem — that is what this curriculum does. Go in with your eyes open, your counselor on speed dial, and the knowledge that what you have built in this room over the last five months is already changing things. Unit 3 begins next week. You are ready.”

5.4 Facilitator Slide Outline (Half-Day Module)

No design required. These headings translate directly to slides or chart paper. Add your school logo and colors as desired. The slide outline is calibrated to BOOK TWO — The Framework (Grades 3–5).

UNIT 4 · LESSON 7 · THE FRAMEWORK (3–5)

1	Welcome + Opening Reflection	Opening reflection prompt (see Block 1). Why we're here. What this day is not (a compliance training).
2	Shame vs. Guilt: The Research	Brown (2010), Tangney et al. (2007). Shame = "I am bad." Guilt = "I did bad." Different neural pathways. Different behavioral outcomes. Pair-share.
3	Self-Compassion: Not What You Think	Neff (2011). Three elements. Not self-esteem. Research outcomes. Name the resistance — then address it.
4	Forgiveness Education: The Evidence Base	Enright & Fitzgibbons. What forgiveness is not (reconciliation, condoning, forgetting). What it produces in the research. Why it is teachable.
5	Holding the 3–5 Room: Productive Discomfort vs. Acute Distress	Three 3–5 scenario exercise. What is each? What is your response? Debrief.
6	Your Own Material	Private journal prompt. Optional share. You don't need to be healed. You need to be aware.
7	The 6-Step Disclosure Protocol	Display all 6 steps. Walk through. Do not rush this slide.
8	Role-Play: 3–5 Scenarios	Display scenario text. Pair practice. Full-group debrief. Key distinctions.
9	Live Lesson: U1 L5	Guilt vs. Shame delivered live. Close laptop. Be in the room.
10	Teacher Reflection: Your First Entry	Display the three reflection prompts. 10 minutes private writing. No collection. No share required. This is the habit.
11	Glossary Walk + Q&A	Refer to one-pager. 12 key terms. Special attention to the three identified for Grades 3–5. Open Q&A. Chart unanswered questions.
12	Closing: You Are Ready	"You don't have to be perfect. You have to be present." Distribute one-pager. Send teachers off.

5.5 Participant One-Pager

This single page is the teacher's take-home reference from the PD day. It contains the essential vocabulary and the disclosure protocol in compact form. Print one per teacher (Grades 3–5 edition). Laminate if possible.

12 ESSENTIAL VOCABULARY TERMS

Shame	"I am bad." Self-attack. Hides and harms.
Guilt	"I did something bad." Behavior-focused. Leads to repair.
Internal Critic	The shame voice. Attacks the person, not the behavior.
Compassionate Witness	The kind observer voice. Sees clearly without attacking.
Forgiveness	A gift to yourself. Not reconciliation. Not condoning. Not forgetting.
Grace Gap	Unearned kindness extended across a relational gap. A chosen act, not a reaction.
Self-Compassion	Treating yourself with the care you'd offer a good friend after a mistake.
Oops / Forever	Distinguishing a mistake (Oops) from a permanent identity statement (Forever).
Narrative Identity	The story a person tells about who they are, built from their experiences.
Charitable Interpretation	Choosing the most generous explanation for another's behavior.
Productive Discomfort	The learning edge. Sitting with a hard truth. Do not rescue students from it.
Community Charter	The class's year-end public commitment to grace practices. The culminating artifact.

IN-THE-MOMENT DISCLOSURE PROTOCOL (6 STEPS)

1. Pause. Move toward the student. Give class independent work.
2. "I can see something is happening. You don't have to explain it."
3. Offer a choice: hall or stay and breathe. Both are valid.
4. Listen. Assess: Type 1–3 (contained) or Type 4 (safety concern)?
5. Type 4: "Thank you for trusting me. I'm walking you to [counselor] now." Do not promise confidentiality. Do not delay.
6. Document. Debrief with counselor or colleague. Put it down before your next class.

TEACHER REFLECTION HABIT

After every lesson: 5 minutes. Private. Not collected. Answer one of: What surfaced for me today? What did I want to rush past — and why? What do I want to carry forward?

CLOSING WORDS

"You don't need to be perfectly healed to teach this curriculum. You need to be present and aware. Your students have been waiting for a classroom that holds them this way." **Architecture of Grace · The Framework · School of Life Foundation · James Anthony Ramsden**

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